

**UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
DISTRICT OF NEVADA**

MARK JOSEPH NEJMEH, Plaintiff, v. THERIVA BIOLOGICS, INC., Defendant.	Case No. 3:26-cv-00705 PROPOSED SUPPLEMENTAL INFORMATION PART N PLAINTIFF'S INTERNAL-DISASSEMBLY CONCERN AND THERIVA'S DISCLOSED SEQUENCE
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Part N Plaintiff's Internal-Disassembly Concern and Theriva's Disclosed Sequence

For review before filing

Preliminary statement and relief requested. Plaintiff assembled Parts A through N to place in one organized record Theriva's publicly disclosed reverse splits, warrant and equity financings, capitalization, cash use, debt and contingent obligations, patent and clinical assets, asset licensing, governance and related-person questions, price-volume and news chronology, strategic review, and potential change-of-control mechanics. Plaintiff does not ask the Court to accept his interpretation. He asks the Court to review the following record, weigh the competing explanations, and decide for itself.

Preservation requested. Plaintiff contends that further exercise, issuance, delivery, registration, transfer, or voting of the specifically identified New Warrant Shares could materially alter economic and voting interests before a hearing, and that implementation of any actual shareholder-rights plan could affect whether a transaction proceeds on equal terms. Subject to the findings required by Federal Rule of Civil Procedure 65, Plaintiff therefore requests a temporary stay of those New Warrant mechanics and, if a shareholder-rights plan actually exists or is adopted, a temporary stay of its implementation, triggering, distribution, exercise, or selective waiver pending prompt notice and hearing. These are requests to preserve the status quo while the record is tested, not findings that a rights plan, insider transaction, or wrongful purpose exists.

We now see how premier graduate schools teach leveraged buyouts. But one thing we could not find in the reviewed materials is any instruction teaching incumbent management to disassemble its own public company in preparation for a leveraged buyout or reverse merger.

Purpose. Part M addresses the academic record. This separate Part N states Plaintiff's Theriva-specific concern: could the Company's disclosed sequence reflect internal preparation for a transaction that reduces the stand-alone company and the relative position of existing stockholders? The word "disassemble" is Plaintiff's characterization and inference. It is not a fact established by the present public record. This Part therefore identifies the proved sequence, competing explanations, facts that cut against the inference, and focused records needed to test it.

Scope. This Part incorporates Parts A through M without repeating their complete financing, patent, accounting, relationship, price-volume, debt, valuation, and legal analyses. It adds no party or cause of action, makes no criminal accusation, does not identify an inside buyer, and does not assert that a merger, reverse merger, going-private transaction, asset diversion, active shareholder-rights plan, or agreement to exclude existing stockholders presently exists.

Question to the Court—and, on issues properly tried, the jury

Does the disclosed sequence, viewed as a whole, suggest that Theriva was being disassembled from within in preparation for a possible merger or reverse merger? Theriva said its strategic alternatives may include a reverse merger after it had: (a) formally resized and restructured the Company; (b) reduced its workforce and research spending; (c) licensed SYN-020 and its covered intellectual property to Rasayana for \$300,000 up front plus contingent consideration, even though a 2025 patent concerns alkaline-phosphatase-based oncology treatment and identifies gemcitabine and cancer treatment; (d) stated that it would not fund further SYN-004 development internally without grant or partner funding after a Phase 2b trial that the Company reported met its primary endpoint, while retaining a patent portfolio; and (e) used financings that substantially expanded the share count and warrant overhang. Parts E and G separately model financing alternatives that Plaintiff believes may have raised capital with less dilution. Is this combination only a response to genuine financial constraints, or does it reflect internal preparation for a transaction that may transfer value or control away from existing stockholders? Plaintiff asks the Court—and, if the evidence reaches trial on properly triable issues, the jury—to decide from admissible evidence, not from Plaintiff's belief alone.

Scientific limitation. U.S. Patent No. 12,318,434 concerns alkaline-phosphatase-based oncology treatment and identifies gemcitabine; it does not establish an early-detection diagnostic. The SYN-004 patent family concerns beta-lactamase formulations and treating or preventing antibiotic-related adverse effects, including prevention of *C. difficile* overgrowth or infection. U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103 B1, application No. 15/160,669, was filed May 20, 2016 and issued August 2, 2016. Its summary states that the improved beta-lactamases have therapeutic uses “including the prevention or treatment of CDI and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease.” Prevention is itself a clinically meaningful therapeutic objective: the disclosed approach is intended to prevent or treat CDI and associated disease before or while toxin-driven colon injury develops. *C. difficile* is a bacterium and CDI is an infection that can cause colitis; CDI is not itself an ulcer. The complete patent attached as Exhibit P-7 highlights the patent's exact language. The patent does not use “cure” to characterize SYN-004 or CDI; the word appears in the title of a cited article concerning a duodenal ulcer and *Helicobacter pylori*, not as a statement about the claimed therapy. The Company's July 12, 2016 release announced a Notice of Allowance for that same application before the patent issued, although the reviewed sources did not locate a separate post-issuance company release naming the final patent number. The Company's SEC-filed January 5, 2017 release reported that SYN-004 met the primary endpoint in a randomized, double-blind, placebo-controlled, 412-patient Phase 2b trial: seven confirmed CDI cases occurred in the placebo group and two in the ribaxamase group, a reported 71.4% relative-risk reduction ($p=0.045$). The Company's May 11, 2017 release states that FDA granted Breakthrough Therapy Designation for prevention of CDI based on that trial. Part N uses those precise patent, reported-trial, and regulatory descriptions; it does not characterize SYN-004 as an approved cure. Patent issuance does not itself establish FDA approval or clinical efficacy. The alternative-financing models are counterfactual analyses, not proof that the modeled capital was actually available on the assumed terms. These limitations are part of the question presented.

Potential-value question. A patent grant establishes enforceable patent rights if valid; it does not establish clinical efficacy, a cure, or a dollar valuation. Here, however, the patent estate did not stand alone: the Company also reported a successful Phase 2b primary endpoint and an FDA Breakthrough Therapy Designation for prevention of CDI. Those combined facts permit a focused valuation inquiry. What contemporaneous fair-value analyses, licensing proposals, partnering discussions, market assessments, patent-maintenance decisions, and development budgets existed for SYN-004/ribaxamase? The public record reviewed for this supplement does not establish a reliable dollar value. Published observational research reporting increased CDI risk among patients with pancreatic disease supports a clinical-risk association only; it does not establish that CDI causes pancreatic cancer or that SYN-004 treats pancreatic cancer.

I. Question presented and Plaintiff's inference

- 1. Could the combined sequence—three reverse stock splits since 2018; restoration of 350,000,000 authorized common shares after the 2024 split; repeated equity and warrant financings; a 2025 workforce restructuring; reduced research spending; licensing SYN-020; declining cash and working capital; a large exercisable warrant overhang; increased employee-plan capacity; change-in-control compensation keyed in part to a private-company transaction; and an announced strategic review that expressly includes a merger or reverse merger—reflect deliberate preparation for a transaction rather than only ordinary financing and survival measures?
- 2. Plaintiff believes the sequence could reflect an internal process of reducing the Company as a stand-alone operating enterprise while preserving a public-company platform, clinical assets, authorized equity capacity, and transaction flexibility for a later counterparty. Plaintiff asks whether current stockholders would retain fair economic participation in the existing assets, cash, intellectual property, and any later combined company.
- 3. The same events may also have ordinary explanations: a clinical-stage company can lose money, reduce staff, license a program, issue discounted securities, increase equity compensation, and explore strategic alternatives because it lacks sufficient capital and faces substantial clinical and regulatory risk. The Court should not choose between those explanations from chronology alone. Contemporaneous records, ownership evidence, transaction terms, and testimony are required.

II. Verified disclosed sequence

Date	Verified disclosure	What the fact permits the Court to ask
June 30–Aug. 5, 2021	The Company reported \$74.291 million of cash and cash equivalents at June 30, 2021 and described that amount as cash available to fund clinical programs. Its later 2021 Form 10-K reported a distinct figure: approximately \$79.2 million of public float at June 30, 2021, based on a \$0.60 NYSE American closing price. The same Form 10-K checked “Non-accelerated Filer” and “Smaller Reporting Company,” and the Section 404(b) auditor-attestation box was unchecked.	Cash, market capitalization, and public float are different measures. The \$74.3 million cash balance was not proof that market value or public float was being held below \$75 million. What capital-allocation, public-float, shelf-capacity, and program-funding analyses did the board receive?

Date	Verified disclosure	What the fact permits the Court to ask
Mar. 1–Aug. 2, 2016	Synthetic Biologics announced three USPTO Notices of Allowance covering SYN-004 and prevention of CDI and antibiotic-associated diarrhea. On July 12 it announced U.S. Patent No. 9,376,673 and a Notice of Allowance for application No. 15/160,669. That application issued August 2 as U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103, whose summary refers to “the prevention or treatment of CDI and/or a C. difficile-associated disease.”	What contemporaneous valuation and development plans did the patent estate support, and how were those plans later reassessed? The July release publicized the allowed application before issuance; the reviewed sources did not locate a separate post-issuance release naming No. 9,404,103. A patent documents claimed inventions, not approval or commercial value.
Jan. 5–May 11, 2017	The Company reported that its randomized, double-blind, placebo-controlled 412-patient Phase 2b trial met its primary endpoint, with seven confirmed CDI cases in the placebo group and two in the ribaxamase group—a reported 71.4% relative-risk reduction ($p=0.045$). It later announced FDA Breakthrough Therapy Designation for prevention of CDI based on that trial.	What development, financing, partnering, and valuation plans followed the reported trial result and regulatory designation, and why did those plans change? These events document reported results and regulatory status, not approval or guaranteed efficacy.
Mar. 11–June 30, 2022	The Company completed the VCN acquisition by paying \$4.7 million to Grifols, issuing 26,395,303 pre-split common shares representing 19.99% of the Dec. 14, 2021 outstanding shares, and agreeing to an approximately \$27.8 million VCN research-and-development budgetary commitment plus contingent milestones. The 2022 Form 10-K later reported approximately \$32.7 million of public float at June 30, 2022, based on a reverse-split-adjusted \$2.10 closing price.	What forecasts compared continued SYN-004/SYN-020 development, the VCN acquisition, and other uses of cash? The chronology permits discovery into allocation and valuation; it does not prove that VCN was acquired to reduce public float or market value.
2018, 2022, and Aug. 26, 2024	Theriva's 2025 Form 10-K lists reverse splits of 1-for-35, 1-for-10, and 1-for-25. The 2024 split reduced 25,131,230 outstanding shares to 1,005,249 and reduced authorized common shares from 350,000,000 to 14,000,000; stockholders later approved restoration to 350,000,000.	Why was each split needed, what financing followed, and what alternatives were modeled? Restoration of authorized shares creates capacity; it does not itself prove an issuance plan.
May 8, 2025	The Company sold 1,990,900 common shares, pre-funded warrants for 4,827,280 shares, and accompanying common warrants for 6,818,180 shares. The combined public price was \$1.10 per common share and accompanying common warrant, or \$1.099 per pre-funded warrant and accompanying common warrant. Gross proceeds were about \$7.5 million.	What values were assigned to the common shares and warrants, what less-dilutive alternatives were considered, and what did the board expect the full capitalization effect to be?
Sept. 28–30, 2025	The board approved a plan to “resize and restructure” the Company around business development and licensing, clinical-trial planning, exploratory manufacturing scale-up, limited preclinical work, and regulatory interactions. The Company reduced its workforce by seven employees, or 32%, recorded about \$520,000 in charges, and projected about \$1.8 million in annual compensation-and-benefit savings.	Was the plan solely a cash-conservation measure, or did it also prepare a smaller organization for a transaction? The filing states the Company's rationale but does not answer that broader process question.
Oct. 16–17, 2025	Holders exercised warrants for 8,092,280 shares at a reduced \$0.54 exercise price. In consideration, the Company issued New Warrants for 16,184,560 shares—200% of the exercised amount—at \$0.54. The Company later reported about \$3.9 million of net exercise proceeds.	Who held the securities, what ownership and hedging information was known, why was the 200% replacement selected, and what post-exercise ownership did the board model?
Year ended Dec. 31, 2025	The Company reported approximately \$6.8 million of net ATM proceeds, \$6.7 million of net May-offering proceeds, \$3.9 million of net inducement exercise proceeds, a \$1.7 million Spanish R&D rebate, and a \$1.4 million THERICEL project loan. It ended 2025 with 35,688,350 common shares outstanding.	How were financing proceeds allocated by program and payee, and what cash runway, ownership, and clinical-development alternatives were compared?
Feb. 18, 2026	Theriva granted Rasayana an exclusive worldwide, sublicensable license covering SYN-020 and licensed intellectual property. Rasayana assumed development and commercialization costs. Theriva received \$300,000 up front and retained contingent milestones, royalties, and a percentage of sublicense revenue; Theriva said it did not anticipate additional funds under the agreement during the following twelve months.	What valuation, diligence, funding evidence, conflicts review, development plan, and alternative bids supported the license? Contingent amounts are not cash already received.
Six months ended June 30, 2026	The Company sold 10,204,319 ATM shares for approximately \$2.303 million net. Outstanding shares increased from 35,688,350 at Dec. 31, 2025 to 45,892,668 at June 30, 2026. It used \$5.541 million of operating cash, which it said was primarily related to VCN-01 development.	What price, timing, volume, and alternative-financing analyses governed the ATM sales, and how much financing value reached the operating programs?

Date	Verified disclosure	What the fact permits the Court to ask
Aug. 3, 2026	Stockholders approved issuance of up to 16,184,560 shares upon exercise of the New Warrants and increased the 2020 Stock Plan's share authority from 4,500,000 to 6,500,000. The New Warrants became exercisable at \$0.54 and expire Aug. 3, 2031.	What amounts have since been exercised or granted, who beneficially owns them, and how would exercise or awards affect voting and economic ownership in a transaction? Approval and exercisability do not establish actual issuance.
Aug. 6–11, 2026	Theriva announced that the first patients had been dosed in VIRAGE2. Its Form 10-Q stated that the Company was devoting substantial time and resources to a strategic review that may include a business combination, merger, or reverse merger, but that no definitive timeline or board-approved course of action existed.	What process existed, when did it begin, which alternatives and counterparties were considered, and how would the legacy assets and current stockholders be treated? Continued dosing is evidence against a conclusion that all development stopped.
Aug. 10, 2026	The amended chief-executive employment agreement provided change-in-control vesting and severance. Its definition includes execution of a definitive agreement with a non-listed private operating company for a reverse merger or similar transaction intended to shift board or voting control.	When and why was that transaction-specific language selected, what advice supported it, and were any actual discussions underway? A contingency clause does not prove that such a transaction was agreed.

III. Capitalization and liquidity map

The \$75 million threshold must be applied to the correct measure. The SEC provisions discussed below use public float—the market value of voting and non-voting common equity held by non-affiliates—not cash, total assets, stockholders' equity, or unrestricted market capitalization. Synthetic Biologics reported \$74.291 million of cash but approximately \$79.2 million of public float on the same June 30, 2021 measurement date.

Rule or measure	Below \$75 million public float	\$75 million or more public float	Theriva/Synthetic record and limitation
Cash versus public float	A cash balance below \$75 million does not establish public float below \$75 million.	A cash balance above \$75 million does not establish public float above \$75 million.	At June 30, 2021: cash was \$74.291 million; reported public float was approximately \$79.2 million. They cannot be substituted for one another.
Form S-3 primary shelf capacity	If otherwise eligible, General Instruction I.B.6 limits primary sales in a rolling 12-month period to no more than one-third of public float; derivative securities are included through their underlying shares.	General Instruction I.B.1 permits primary offerings without the I.B.6 one-third cap, subject to the Form's other eligibility and transaction requirements.	Crossing below \$75 million generally narrows—not expands—primary shelf capacity. It does not bar registered financing altogether.
Accelerated-filer status	Public float below \$75 million is one route to non-accelerated status.	From \$75 million to below \$700 million, accelerated status also requires the other Rule 12b-2 conditions and excludes issuers eligible for the low-revenue smaller-reporting-company test.	The 2021 Form 10-K reported \$79.2 million public float but checked non-accelerated filer because the low-revenue/SRC rules can apply above \$75 million.
Smaller reporting company	A company below \$250 million public float can qualify for scaled disclosure; a separate revenue test can extend eligibility to public float below \$700 million.	\$75 million is not the current SRC ceiling. It was the historical public-float threshold before the SEC's amendments effective Sept. 10, 2018.	Synthetic checked SRC in its 2021 Form 10-K. The present record does not show that keeping public float below \$75 million was necessary to retain SRC status.
SOX §404(b) auditor attestation and filing cadence	Non-accelerated filers generally do not provide the Section 404(b) auditor attestation and receive the non-accelerated filing schedule, while management remains responsible for internal-control assessment.	An issuer can be accelerated above \$75 million if all conditions apply, but a low-revenue SRC can remain non-accelerated.	Synthetic's 2021 10-K left the 404(b) attestation box unchecked even though reported public float exceeded \$75 million. No avoidance inference follows from the cash figure alone.

Measure	Filed figure or transparent calculation	Required limitation
Outstanding common shares	2,811,259 at Dec. 31, 2024; 35,688,350 at Dec. 31, 2025; 45,892,668 at June 30 and Aug. 7, 2026. The Dec. 2024-to-Aug. 2026 increase is approximately 16.3 times.	This is share-count expansion, not by itself a measure of loss, manipulation, insider ownership, or proceeds retained.
New Warrant overhang	16,184,560 shares equal 35.3% of the 45,892,668 then-outstanding shares. If all were newly issued with no other change, those warrant shares would be 26.1% of the resulting 62,077,228 shares.	The warrants are material but do not alone constitute majority control. Current exercises, holders, blockers, transfers, and voting arrangements must be proved.
Employee-plan increase	The plan authority increased by 2,000,000 shares, from 4,500,000 to 6,500,000. The incremental 2,000,000 equals about 4.4% of the 45,892,668-share base.	Plan authority is not the same as grants, vesting, exercise, issuance, beneficial ownership, or voting control.

Measure	Filed figure or transparent calculation	Required limitation
Authorized capacity	350,000,000 authorized common shares less 45,892,668 outstanding shares left approximately 304.1 million authorized but unissued shares before accounting for reservations and other commitments.	Authorized capacity is not an issued security, an active poison pill, or proof that the board intends to use all capacity.
Cash and working capital	Cash was \$13.056 million at Dec. 31, 2025, \$11.337 million at June 30, 2026, and approximately \$9.6 million in early Aug. 2026. Working capital declined from about \$7.5 million to \$1.6 million during the first six months of 2026.	Cash burn and a going-concern disclosure show financial pressure; they do not establish that management manufactured the pressure.
Equity and accumulated deficit	Total stockholders' equity declined from \$15.383 million at Dec. 31, 2025 to \$12.187 million at June 30, 2026. Accumulated deficit increased from \$358.710 million to \$363.971 million.	An accumulated deficit is not a cash ledger and cannot identify who received funds. Parts D, E, and I address the cash and balance-sheet trace.
Grifols contingent consideration	At June 30, 2026 the balance sheet reported \$2.650 million current and \$7.169 million non-current contingent consideration, or \$9.819 million in total. The Company separately stated that \$5.0 million had been earned but deferred pending discussions with Grifols.	The \$5.0 million disclosure may overlap the recorded liability and must not be added again without the rollforward and contract. The entire liability was not stated to be immediately payable.

IV. What may support the inference—and what cuts against it

Disclosed circumstance	Plaintiff's permissible question	Competing record or explanation
Repeated splits followed by substantial share issuance and warrant capacity	Was capitalization managed to create a transaction-ready public platform while existing ownership percentages repeatedly contracted?	Splits can preserve exchange listing; equity and warrants can finance a non-revenue clinical-stage company. No public record reviewed proves a hidden ownership agreement.
Workforce reduction and lower R&D	Was the operating organization intentionally reduced before a strategic transaction?	The Company expressly described cash conservation and a narrower development plan. It continued VIRAGE2 and reported that first patients were dosed.
SYN-020 license and no internally funded SYN-004 development	Were existing assets fairly valued, preserved for current holders, and exposed to a genuine market check?	Licensing or partnering can conserve cash and transfer development risk. SYN-020 rights revert upon specified termination events, and Theriva retained contingent economics.
Strategic-review language and transaction-specific change-in-control terms	Were officers preparing for or negotiating an insider-supported transaction while influencing capitalization and asset decisions?	The Form 10-Q expressly said no definitive timeline or board-approved course existed. Compensation provisions commonly address possible transactions and do not establish one.
Cash, working-capital, and contingent-liability pressure	Did earlier financing choices unnecessarily create urgency that could reduce negotiating leverage?	Clinical development consumes cash, outcomes are uncertain, and the Company disclosed substantial going-concern risk. Poor results or poor judgment are not proof of intentional value impairment.
Counterfactual financing analysis in Parts E and G	Could common-only, differently timed, or otherwise less-dilutive financing have preserved more ownership and supplied more development capital?	A what-if model depends on price, volume, shelf capacity, purchaser demand, transaction costs, and market impact. It identifies a discovery question; it does not prove that management could have completed the modeled financing.

V. Findings the present record does not support

- The public materials reviewed do not identify an executed merger or reverse-merger agreement, a buyer, an insider purchasing group, a voting agreement transferring control, a commitment to take the Company private, or an adopted or triggered shareholder-rights plan. The strategic review and employment provisions create questions; they are not substitutes for those missing facts.
- The New Warrants are economically and legally material, but the filed arithmetic does not show that they alone deliver majority control. They equal approximately 35.3% of the then-outstanding share count and approximately 26.1% of the enlarged total if fully exercised with no other change. Ownership blockers, current exercises, holder coordination, other securities, and voting arrangements must be proved rather than assumed.
- The record does not establish intentional value destruction, market manipulation, short selling by any identified holder, asset diversion, a related-party Rasayana transaction, commingling with another issuer, or a criminal or fraudulent

agreement. Those conclusions require admissible evidence of participants, communications, conduct, causation, state of mind where required, and resulting harm.

VI. Focused records needed to test the internal-disassembly concern

Patent-register disclosure gap. Theriva's 2025 Form 10-K reports more than 135 U.S. and foreign patents and more than 50 pending applications, and states that VCN controls more than 50 patents through assignment or exclusive license. The filing names examples rather than a complete patent-by-patent register. The accompanying proposed patent exhibit schedule identifies 53 U.S. issued-grant records located under the Theriva, predecessor Synthetic Biologics, and VCN assignee names, but it is not a current title opinion and does not establish the complete worldwide portfolio. The difference between an aggregate count and an itemized, current register is a disclosure gap to be tested with records; it is not, by itself, proof that any patent was concealed, abandoned, transferred, encumbered, or omitted improperly.

Specific \$74.3 million limitation. The reviewed record does not prove that management selected, preserved, or depleted the June 30, 2021 cash balance to remain below a regulatory market-value threshold, or that VCN was acquired for that purpose. The same-date public-float figure reported in the 2021 Form 10-K was approximately \$79.2 million. Plaintiff requests the contemporaneous analyses below so that purpose, alternatives, and effects can be tested rather than assumed.

- a complete, verified patent-and-application register from January 1, 2016 to the present, organized by program and patent family, identifying every jurisdiction, application and patent number, legal and beneficial owner, chain of title, current status, expiration date, maintenance or annuity status, abandonment or lapse, security interest, assignment, exclusive or nonexclusive license, sublicense, field and territory restriction, reversion right, and transaction in which the right was valued, transferred, or proposed to be transferred;
- the complete patent schedules and chain-of-title materials delivered with the Rasayana license, the VCN acquisition, and the IDIBELL/ICO/Hospital Sant Joan de Deu licenses, together with any later amendments, notices, consents, valuations, maintenance decisions, or proposed dispositions;
- the Company's patent-announcement and investor-relations chronology from January 1, 2016 forward, including the criteria used to issue or withhold a release after allowance, issuance, abandonment, lapse, assignment, licensing, or other material change, and the records concerning application No. 15/160,669, the July 12, 2016 Notice-of-Allowance release, and its August 2, 2016 issuance as U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103;
- all board and committee minutes, written consents, banker materials, management presentations, forecasts, capitalization models, and cash-runway analyses concerning the 2025 restructuring and every financing, warrant inducement, equity-plan increase, asset license, and strategic alternative from January 1, 2024 forward;
- a transaction-process chronology identifying every proposed acquisition, merger, reverse merger, recapitalization, asset sale, license, liquidation, or private-company combination, including when it arose, who proposed it, each counterparty, present status, and reasons for acceptance or rejection;
- all comparisons of common-only ATM financing, warrant financing, debt, grants, licensing, partnering, sale, merger, reverse merger, wind-down, and continued stand-alone development, including projected dilution, voting power, cash runway, fees, and program funding;
- all calculations and presentations from January 1, 2021 through December 31, 2022 concerning cash, market capitalization, public float, Form S-3 General Instructions I.B.1 and I.B.6, accelerated-filer or smaller-reporting-company status, Section 404(b), exchange-listing thresholds, and the expected effect of the VCN acquisition and related share issuance on each measure;
- current transfer-agent and warrant-agent records showing exercises, issuances, beneficial holders, 4.99% or 9.99% blockers, notices to increase blockers, transfers, registration status, and any voting or disposition agreements concerning the New Warrants;
- all valuations, bids, diligence, funding verification, conflict review, development plans, milestone tracking, and sublicense communications concerning Rasayana and SYN-020, together with any alternative proposals;
- all Grifols communications and accounting work papers concerning the earned-but-deferred \$5.0 million milestone, the current and non-current contingent consideration, payment timing, deferral consideration, amendments, waivers, and treatment in any strategic transaction;
- all records concerning treatment of VCN-01, SYN-004, SYN-020 economics, cash, debt, contingent liabilities, patents, licenses, tax credits, and existing stockholders in any proposed transaction, including exchange ratios, rollover interests, contingent-value rights, and post-transaction ownership;
- all conflict questionnaires, related-person analyses, recusals, special-committee records, independent-counsel or valuation engagements, severance calculations, option-acceleration schedules, continuing-employment discussions, and proposed post-transaction board seats; and

- any actual shareholder-rights agreement, board resolution, preferred-stock designation, transfer-agent instruction, or other instrument claimed to operate as a poison pill. If none exists, a sworn statement identifying that fact and the authorized decisionmaker.

VII. Witness sequence and procedural limits

7. Records should come first. A Theriva Rule 30(b)(6) witness can then identify the decisionmakers, custodians, transaction process, capitalization analyses, asset valuations, and financing alternatives. Individual directors, officers, advisers, warrant holders, Rasayana, Grifols, scientists, auditors, or other nonparties should be examined only on specific unresolved subjects for which they possess personal knowledge.
8. Discovery ordinarily follows the Rule 26(f) conference unless a rule, stipulation, or court order authorizes earlier discovery. Any expedited request should identify the urgent issue, specific custodian, narrow time period, and documents needed. Nonparty subpoenas remain subject to Rule 45's relevance, privilege, geographic, and undue-burden protections.
9. This Part is proposed supplemental information, not a self-executing discovery demand or a new emergency motion. District of Nevada Local Rule 7-2(g) requires leave for supplemental briefs, evidence, or authorities. Any injunction must satisfy Rule 65, address the claims actually pleaded, identify a presently threatened act, and be specific in scope and duration.

VIII. Narrow requested treatment

10. If the Court permits this supplemental record and finds it relevant to the existing warrant- and disclosure-related claims, Plaintiff respectfully asks the Court to grant the Rule 65 temporary restraining and preliminary-injunction relief properly requested concerning exercise, issuance, delivery, registration, transfer, or voting of the specifically identified New Warrant Shares, pending a prompt noticed hearing, but only if the Court finds the governing Rule 65 factors satisfied on current evidence of imminent and irreparable harm.
11. Plaintiff also requests preservation of the Section VI records and a sworn status disclosure identifying: (a) New Warrant exercises and shares issued; (b) current outstanding shares; (c) any executed or pending strategic-transaction agreement; (d) whether any shareholder-rights plan, sometimes called a poison pill, exists or is imminent; and (e) the proposed treatment of current stockholders and material legacy assets in any signed transaction, subject to lawful confidentiality protections. If an actual rights-plan instrument is identified, Plaintiff asks the Court to restrain implementation, triggering, distribution, exercise, or selective waiver only through the prompt hearing and only upon the required Rule 65 showing. If no such plan exists, Plaintiff requests preservation and advance notice rather than an injunction against a hypothetical device.
12. Plaintiff does not ask the Court in this Part to find that Theriva has disassembled itself, that an insider takeover exists, or that lawful financing or strategic review is inherently wrongful. Plaintiff asks that the disclosed sequence be tested with the records capable of proving or disproving the inference before irreversible ownership or asset changes occur.

IX. Conclusion

Part M shows that premier business schools teach leveraged buyouts, acquisition, management participation, restructuring, and exit; it did not identify teaching that incumbent managers should secretly impair or disassemble their own public company for a later transaction. Part N identifies why Plaintiff believes Theriva's disclosed sequence may present that different concern. The Company itself disclosed repeated capitalization changes, a formal resizing and restructuring, a 32% workforce reduction, substantial share-count expansion, a 200% replacement-warrant issuance, licensing of SYN-020, no internally funded further development of SYN-004, declining liquidity, transaction-specific change-in-control protection, and an active review that includes a merger or reverse merger. The same record also shows continued VCN-01 development, first patients dosed in VIRAGE2, financing need, going-concern risk, no named buyer, no executed transaction, and no identified active rights plan. The present record therefore supports a focused factual inquiry—not a verdict—into whether the sequence was ordinary corporate survival, reasonable preparation for alternatives, or an internally influenced process that failed to protect the corporation and existing stockholders. Plaintiff respectfully asks the Court to grant only the properly supported, specific Rule 65 relief stated above concerning the identified New Warrant Shares and any actual rights-plan instrument, and respectfully thanks the Court for its consideration.

Source record

1. [Synthetic Biologics Form 10-K for the year ended Dec. 31, 2021 \(public float, filer status, and 404\(b\) check box\)](#)
2. [Theriva Form 10-K for the year ended Dec. 31, 2022 \(June 30, 2022 public float\)](#)
3. [Synthetic Biologics Aug. 5, 2021 second-quarter release \(\\$74.291 million cash\)](#)
4. [Synthetic Biologics Mar. 11, 2022 VCN acquisition release](#)
5. [SEC Form S-3, General Instructions I.B.1 and I.B.6](#)
6. [SEC Accelerated Filer and Large Accelerated Filer Definitions compliance guide](#)
7. [SEC Amendments to the Smaller Reporting Company Definition compliance guide](#)
8. [Theriva Form 10-K for the year ended Dec. 31, 2025](#)
9. [Theriva Form 10-Q for the quarter ended June 30, 2026](#)
10. [Theriva Aug. 3, 2026 annual-meeting Form 8-K](#)
11. [Theriva Aug. 11, 2026 operational and financial release](#)
12. [Theriva May 7, 2025 VIRAGE Phase 2b results](#)
13. [U.S. Patent No. 12,318,434, Alkaline phosphate-based oncology treatments](#)
14. [U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103 B1, Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy](#)
15. [U.S. Patent No. 10,041,056, Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto](#)
16. [U.S. Patent No. 12,274,740, Microbiome protection from oral antibiotics](#)
17. [Synthetic Biologics Jan. 5, 2017 SEC-filed SYN-004 Phase 2b results release](#)
18. [Synthetic Biologics Mar. 1, 2016 SYN-004 patent-allowance release](#)
19. [Synthetic Biologics July 12, 2016 ribaxamase patent-grant release](#)
20. [Synthetic Biologics May 11, 2017 FDA Breakthrough Therapy Designation release](#)
21. [Vaishnavi et al., 2019, pancreatic disease and observed CDI risk \(peer-reviewed article\)](#)
22. [Federal Rule of Civil Procedure 65](#)
23. [Federal Rules of Civil Procedure 26 and 45](#)
24. [District of Nevada Local Rules](#)

Respectfully submitted,

Dated: _____

Signature: _____

Mark Joseph Nejme, Plaintiff, self-represented

**UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
DISTRICT OF NEVADA**

MARK JOSEPH NEJMEH, Plaintiff, v. THERIVA BIOLOGICS, INC., Defendant.	Case No. 3:26-cv-00705 PROPOSED SUPPLEMENTAL INFORMATION PART N—EXHIBITS PUBLICLY IDENTIFIED U.S. PATENT PORTFOLIO AND REQUEST FOR COMPLETE REGISTER
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Proposed Patent Exhibit Schedule and Disclosure-Gap Request

Organizational appendix for review before filing; not a patent-title opinion

Purpose and limitation. This appendix organizes the U.S. issued-grant records located in the reviewed public sources under Theriva Biologics, Inc., its predecessor name Synthetic Biologics, Inc., and its subsidiary VCN Biosciences, S.L. It identifies 53 U.S. issued grants. It does not purport to be the complete worldwide portfolio, a current chain-of-title report, or proof that every listed right remains owned, enforceable, maintained, unencumbered, or commercially valuable. It also does not equate patent language with FDA approval or clinical efficacy.

Why a complete register is still required. Theriva's 2025 Form 10-K reports more than 135 U.S. and foreign patents and more than 50 pending applications and states that VCN controls more than 50 patents through assignment or exclusive license, but it names only examples. Public assignee indexes are useful locating tools, not certified title evidence. A complete answer therefore requires the Company's program-by-program register, assignment records, maintenance records, and every governing license. The gap between aggregate counts and an itemized current register is a question for production and testimony, not proof of concealment.

Ownership categories. An assigned patent and an exclusively licensed patent are different interests. The SYN-004 record is described by Theriva as assigned to Theriva. The SYN-020 record is also described as assigned to Theriva, but the 10-K states that all such patents were exclusively licensed to Rasayana in February 2026. VCN's portfolio includes patents assigned to VCN and patents exclusively licensed from third parties. Those categories are kept separate below.

Exhibit P-1 — What Theriva's 2025 Form 10-K discloses

Portfolio statement	Named examples	What remains unverified publicly
Theriva reports more than 135 U.S. and foreign patents and more than 50 pending applications.	The filing names nine U.S. SYN-004 patents as examples: 8,894,994; 9,587,234; 9,301,995; 9,301,996; 9,290,754; 9,376,673; 9,404,103; 9,464,280; and 9,695,409.	Every patent/application number, jurisdiction, family, current owner, status, expiration, maintenance history, encumbrance, and license term.
SYN-020 is supported by U.S. and foreign patents and applications assigned to Theriva.	The filing describes formulations, medical uses, and manufacture, with expected expiration in 2038–2040, and states all such patents were licensed to Rasayana in February 2026.	The complete Rasayana patent schedule, present chain of title, retained rights, sublicenses, maintenance duties, security interests, valuation, and any later amendment.
VCN controls more than 50 U.S. and foreign patents through assignment or exclusive license and more than 15 pending applications.	The filing names U.S. 10,316,065 as an example and identifies licenses from IDIBELL, ICO, and Hospital Sant Joan de Deu.	Which rights are assigned to VCN versus third-party-owned and licensed; the complete family schedule; current license compliance; royalties; reversion; maintenance; and change-of-control provisions.

Exhibit P-2 — U.S. grants located under Theriva Biologics, Inc. (14)

These are public issued-grant records located under the current company name. Their appearance in an assignee index does not replace an official current title and maintenance review. The 2025 Form 10-K states that the SYN-020 patents were licensed to Rasayana in February 2026.

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, record name, and inventors
P-2.1	U.S. 12,648,987 Alkaline phosphatase agents for treatment of radiation disorders	Filed: Apr. 14, 2023 Issued: June 9, 2026	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12648987
P-2.2	U.S. 12,508,304 Alkaline phosphatase formulations	Filed: June 17, 2024 Issued: Dec. 30, 2025	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Vincent Wachter; J. Blair West; Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12508304
P-2.3	U.S. 12,472,147 Intestinal alkaline phosphatase formulations	Filed: Mar. 17, 2023 Issued: Nov. 18, 2025	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Ray Stapleton; Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia; Steven Hubert; Cristina Freire; James Gubbins Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12472147
P-2.4	U.S. 12,318,434 Alkaline phosphate-based oncology treatments	Filed: May 5, 2020 Issued: June 3, 2025	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Christian Furlan Freguia; Michael Kaleko Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12318434
P-2.5	U.S. 12,274,740 Microbiome protection from oral antibiotics	Filed: Dec. 11, 2023 Issued: Apr. 15, 2025	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12274740
P-2.6	U.S. 12,178,917 Beta-lactamase formulations and uses thereof	Filed: Sept. 28, 2020 Issued: Dec. 31, 2024	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12178917
P-2.7	U.S. 12,048,735 Alkaline phosphatase formulations	Filed: Mar. 29, 2021 Issued: July 30, 2024	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Vincent Wachter; J. Blair West; Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US12048735
P-2.8	U.S. 11,981,899 E. coli-based production of beta-lactamase	Filed: Dec. 1, 2022 Issued: May 14, 2024	Program: SYN-004 / manufacture Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Michael Kaleko; Steven Hubert Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11981899

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, record name, and inventors
P-2.9	U.S. 11,944,669 Method and compositions for inhibiting or preventing adverse effects of oral antibiotics	Filed: Feb. 2, 2023 Issued: Apr. 2, 2024	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly; Vincent John Wachter Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11944669
P-2.10	U.S. 11,883,474 Microbiome protection from oral antibiotics	Filed: Oct. 26, 2022 Issued: Jan. 30, 2024	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11883474
P-2.11	U.S. 11,872,268 Safe and effective beta-lactamase dosing for microbiome protection	Filed: Jan. 10, 2022 Issued: Jan. 16, 2024	Program: SYN-004 / dosing Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Joseph Sliman Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11872268
P-2.12	U.S. 11,654,184 Alkaline phosphatase agents for treatment of radiation disorders	Filed: Mar. 20, 2019 Issued: May 23, 2023	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11654184
P-2.13	U.S. 11,638,699 Intestinal alkaline phosphatase formulations	Filed: Mar. 20, 2019 Issued: May 2, 2023	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Ray Stapleton; Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia; Steven Hubert; Cristina Freire; James Gubbins Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11638699
P-2.14	U.S. 11,608,494 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Dec. 8, 2021 Issued: Mar. 21, 2023	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Theriva Biologics assignee record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11608494

Exhibit P-3 — U.S. grants located under Synthetic Biologics or otherwise tied to the predecessor record (38)

Synthetic Biologics changed its name to Theriva Biologics in October 2022. The entries below preserve the name shown in the public locating source. Some are co-assigned with another institution. No conclusion about current ownership, exclusivity, lapse, abandonment, or encumbrance should be drawn without the official chain of title and maintenance record.

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, public record, and inventors
P-3.1	U.S. 11,542,510 E. coli-based production of beta-lactamase	Filed: May 7, 2021 Issued: Jan. 3, 2023	Program: SYN-004 / manufacture Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Michael Kaleko; Steven Hubert Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11542510
P-3.2	U.S. 11,517,614 Microbiome protection from oral antibiotics	Filed: June 28, 2017 Issued: Dec. 6, 2022	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11517614

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, public record, and inventors
P-3.3	U.S. 11,338,020 Alkaline phosphatase agents for treatment of neurodevelopmental disorders	Filed: Jan. 8, 2019 Issued: May 24, 2022	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11338020
P-3.4	U.S. 11,253,577 Safe and effective beta-lactamase dosing for microbiome protection	Filed: June 4, 2020 Issued: Feb. 22, 2022	Program: SYN-004 / dosing Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Joseph Sliman Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11253577
P-3.5	U.S. 11,236,319 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: July 24, 2020 Issued: Feb. 1, 2022	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Google patent record; 2023 name-change entry Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11236319
P-3.6	U.S. 11,034,966 E. coli-based production of beta-lactamase	Filed: Aug. 27, 2015 Issued: June 15, 2021	Program: SYN-004 / manufacture Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Michael Kaleko; Steven Hubert Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US11034966
P-3.7	U.S. 10,987,410 Alkaline phosphatase formulations	Filed: July 17, 2018 Issued: Apr. 27, 2021	Program: SYN-020 / IAP Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Vincent Wachter; J. Blair West; Michael Kaleko; Christian Furlan Freguia Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10987410
P-3.8	U.S. 10,828,260 Beta-lactamase formulations and uses thereof	Filed: Aug. 24, 2018 Issued: Nov. 10, 2020	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10828260
P-3.9	U.S. 10,792,346 Method and compositions for inhibiting or preventing adverse effects of oral antibiotics	Filed: July 10, 2018 Issued: Oct. 6, 2020	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly; Vincent John Wachter Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10792346
P-3.10	U.S. 10,767,171 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Jan. 24, 2020 Issued: Sept. 8, 2020	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10767171
P-3.11	U.S. 10,736,871 Anti-methanogenic lovastatin analogs or derivatives and uses thereof	Filed: Mar. 31, 2016 Issued: Aug. 11, 2020	Program: Legacy / IBS Record: Cedars-Sinai and Synthetic Biologics co-assignee record Inventor(s): Mark Pimentel; Vince Wachter Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10736871
P-3.12	U.S. 10,709,773 Safe and effective beta-lactamase dosing for microbiome protection	Filed: Mar. 7, 2016 Issued: July 14, 2020	Program: SYN-004 / dosing Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Joseph Sliman Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10709773
P-3.13	U.S. 10,584,326 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: May 16, 2019 Issued: Mar. 10, 2020	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10584326

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, public record, and inventors
P-3.14	U.S. 10,548,955 Carbapenemases for use with antibiotics for the protection of the intestinal microbiome	Filed: Jan. 9, 2018 Issued: Feb. 4, 2020	Program: Microbiome / beta-lactamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10548955
P-3.15	U.S. 10,526,400 Humanized pertussis antibodies and uses thereof	Filed: June 25, 2018 Issued: Jan. 7, 2020	Program: Legacy / pertussis Record: University of Texas System and Synthetic Biologics co-assignee record Inventor(s): Jennifer Maynard; Annalee Nguyen; Eduardo Padlan; Ellen Wagner Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10526400
P-3.16	U.S. 10,336,995 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Aug. 24, 2018 Issued: July 2, 2019	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10336995
P-3.17	U.S. 10,253,306 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: July 27, 2017 Issued: Apr. 9, 2019	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10253306
P-3.18	U.S. 10,105,322 Beta-lactamase formulations and uses thereof	Filed: Oct. 8, 2015 Issued: Oct. 23, 2018	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Andrew Bristol; Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10105322
P-3.19	U.S. 10,087,433 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: May 30, 2018 Issued: Oct. 2, 2018	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10087433
P-3.20	U.S. 10,046,035 Methods and compositions for inhibiting or preventing adverse effects of oral antibiotics	Filed: July 5, 2017 Issued: Aug. 14, 2018	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly; Vincent John Wachter Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10046035
P-3.21	U.S. 10,041,056 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: Jan. 27, 2017 Issued: Aug. 7, 2018	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10041056
P-3.22	U.S. 10,035,846 Humanized pertussis antibodies and uses thereof	Filed: Nov. 18, 2016 Issued: July 31, 2018	Program: Legacy / pertussis Record: University of Texas System and Synthetic Biologics co-assignee record Inventor(s): Jennifer Maynard; Annalee Nguyen; Eduardo Padlan; Ellen Wagner Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10035846
P-3.23	U.S. 10,011,824 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Aug. 10, 2017 Issued: July 3, 2018	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US10011824

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, public record, and inventors
P-3.24	U.S. 9,956,292 Anti-methanogenic compositions and uses thereof	Filed: Aug. 13, 2015 Issued: May 1, 2018	Program: Legacy / IBS Record: Cedars-Sinai and Synthetic Biologics co-assignee record Inventor(s): Mark Pimentel; Ruchi Mathur; Steve Kanzer; Vince Wachter Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9956292
P-3.25	U.S. 9,783,797 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: June 2, 2017 Issued: Oct. 10, 2017	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9783797
P-3.26	U.S. 9,765,320 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: Apr. 26, 2016 Issued: Sept. 19, 2017	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9765320
P-3.27	U.S. 9,744,221 Method and compositions for inhibiting or preventing adverse effects of oral antibiotics	Filed: Dec. 23, 2015 Issued: Aug. 29, 2017	Program: SYN-004 / microbiome Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly; Vincent John Wachter Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9744221
P-3.28	U.S. 9,695,409 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Aug. 24, 2016 Issued: July 4, 2017	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9695409
P-3.29	U.S. 9,587,234 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: Feb. 26, 2016 Issued: Mar. 7, 2017	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9587234
P-3.30	U.S. 9,512,204 Humanized pertussis antibodies and uses thereof	Filed: Mar. 31, 2015 Issued: Dec. 6, 2016	Program: Legacy / pertussis Record: University of Texas System and Synthetic Biologics co-assignee record Inventor(s): Jennifer Maynard; Annalee Nguyen; Eduardo Padlan; Ellen Wagner Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9512204
P-3.31	U.S. 9,464,280 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: July 1, 2016 Issued: Oct. 11, 2016	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9464280
P-3.32	U.S. 9,404,103 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: May 20, 2016 Issued: Aug. 2, 2016	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9404103
P-3.33	U.S. 9,376,673 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Feb. 9, 2016 Issued: June 28, 2016	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9376673
P-3.34	U.S. 9,301,996 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: Apr. 1, 2015 Issued: Apr. 5, 2016	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9301996

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, public record, and inventors
P-3.35	U.S. 9,301,995 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: Oct. 17, 2014 Issued: Apr. 5, 2016	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9301995
P-3.36	U.S. 9,290,754 Beta-lactamases with improved properties for therapy	Filed: Apr. 17, 2015 Issued: Mar. 22, 2016	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Form 10-K and Google patent record; 2023 name-change entry Inventor(s): Michael Kaleko; Sheila Connelly Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9290754
P-3.37	U.S. 9,034,602 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: May 17, 2011 Issued: May 19, 2015	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US9034602
P-3.38	U.S. 8,894,994 Modified beta-lactamases and methods and uses related thereto	Filed: Oct. 7, 2013 Issued: Nov. 25, 2014	Program: SYN-004 / ribaxamase Record: Synthetic Biologics record Inventor(s): Pertti Koski; Ulla Airaksinen; Katja Valimaki Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US8894994

Exhibit P-4 — U.S. grant located under VCN Biosciences, S.L. (1)

Ex.	Patent and title	Dates	Program, public record, and inventors
P-4.1	U.S. 11,000,560 Oncolytic adenoviruses with mutations in immunodominant adenovirus epitopes and their use in cancer treatment	Filed: May 4, 2016 Issued: May 11, 2021	Program: VCN oncolytic-virus platform Record: VCN Biosciences, S.L. assignee record Inventor(s): Ramon Alemany; Raul Gil; Miriam Bazan Link: https://patents.google.com/patent/US1100560

Exhibit P-5 — Disclosed controlled or licensed rights not represented as Theriva-owned

Right	Publicly disclosed ownership/control	Necessary limitation
U.S. Patent No. 10,316,065, Oncolytic adenoviruses for treating cancer	The public patent record identifies IDIBELL and Institut Catala d'Oncologia as assignees. Theriva's 10-K identifies the patent as an example within VCN's assigned-or-exclusively-licensed estate.	Treat as third-party-owned and licensed/controlled unless a later recorded assignment proves otherwise.
Spanish patent P200901201, Oncolytic adenoviruses for treating cancer	The 10-K states VCN obtained an exclusive license from IDIBELL in 2010 and that the patent is co-owned by IDIBELL and ICO.	The license includes royalty, termination, utilization, and maintenance provisions; the full agreement and current compliance must be reviewed.
Spanish patent P200700665 and EP-family priority application 14 38 2162.7	The 10-K describes additional VCN licenses from ICO and IDIBELL/ICO.	Patent-family members, present owners, territories, status, payment duties, and change-of-control terms require the complete schedules and agreements.

Exhibit P-6 — C. difficile patent and company-announcement chronology

Date	Documented event	What it establishes—and does not
Mar. 1, 2016	Synthetic Biologics announced three USPTO Notices of Allowance covering SYN-004-related composition and methods, including prevention of CDI and antibiotic-associated diarrhea.	The Company publicized patent allowances. A notice of allowance is not an issued patent, FDA approval, or proof of value.
July 12, 2016	The Company announced U.S. Patent No. 9,376,673 and a Notice of Allowance for U.S. application No. 15/160,669.	The release identified the allowed application before issuance. It could not yet name the later final patent number.

Date	Documented event	What it establishes—and does not
Aug. 2, 2016	Application No. 15/160,669 issued as U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103 B1. Its summary states that the improved beta-lactamases have uses “including the prevention or treatment of CDI and/or a C. difficile-associated disease.”	This is patent language describing claimed technology. Prevention is a clinically meaningful therapeutic objective, but CDI is an infection that can cause colitis; it is not itself an ulcer. The patent does not call SYN-004 or CDI a “cure.” Its only “Cure” reference is the title of a cited article about a duodenal ulcer and Helicobacter pylori. Patent language is not FDA approval or proof of clinical efficacy.
Post-issuance search	The reviewed Theriva/Synthetic release archive and web sources did not locate a separate company release after August 2, 2016 that names final U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103.	Absence from the reviewed sources is not proof that no communication existed. The Company should identify any release, investor communication, or decision record concerning post-issuance publicity.
Jan. 5 and May 11, 2017	The Company later reported a 412-patient Phase 2b result and FDA Breakthrough Therapy Designation for prevention of CDI.	Those later clinical/regulatory disclosures are separate from patent issuance and do not transform the patent itself into approval.

Exhibit P-7 — Complete C. difficile patent attached separately

The separate Exhibit P-7 PDF reproduces all 52 pages of U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103 B1. Yellow highlighting is limited to the two-line statement on patent page 2 that the improved beta-lactamases have therapeutic uses “including the prevention or treatment of CDI and/or a C. difficile-associated disease.” The exhibit cover explains that the patent does not use “cure” to describe SYN-004 or CDI and that patent language is not a regulatory approval or efficacy finding. No other complete patent is attached; the remaining patent records are supplied by number and public link in this schedule.

Exhibit P-8 — Focused production needed to close the public-record gaps

- a complete patent-and-application register from January 1, 2016 to the present, organized by program and patent family, listing every jurisdiction, application and patent number, owner, beneficial owner, chain of title, inventors, priority, filing, issue, expiration, maintenance or annuity status, terminal disclaimer, lapse, abandonment, revival, security interest, assignment, license, sublicense, field restriction, territory, reversion right, and enforcement or challenge;
- the complete patent schedules, assignment instruments, recorded title documents, maintenance records, and amendments for the Rasayana license, the VCN acquisition, and every IDIBELL, ICO, Hospital Sant Joan de Deu, Cedars-Sinai, and University of Texas agreement reflected in the public record;
- all patent-specific valuations, impairment analyses, sale or license proposals, bidder or counterparty diligence, board or committee materials, and banker presentations used in any financing, restructuring, strategic review, merger, reverse merger, asset transfer, or license analysis;
- a program-by-program reconciliation showing which patents support SYN-004, SYN-020, VCN-01, Albumin Shield, or a discontinued legacy program, and identifying who paid prosecution and maintenance costs and where those costs were recorded; and
- the investor-relations and disclosure-decision record for patent allowances, issuances, lapses, abandonments, assignments, licenses, and sublicenses, including application No. 15/160,669 and U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103.

Requested treatment and evidentiary guardrails

1. Use this schedule only as an organizational index to identified public records. A patent document may be capable of judicial notice for what it says and when it issued, but disputed ownership, maintenance, commercial value, materiality, and scientific effect require proper evidence and, where disputed, testimony.
2. If the Court finds the subject proportional and relevant to the pleaded warrant- and disclosure-related issues, Plaintiff requests production of the focused records above through the ordinary Rule 26 process or a specifically supported expedited order. This appendix is not itself a subpoena, title opinion, or proof of wrongdoing.
3. No adverse inference should be drawn merely because a patent number was not individually named in a Form 10-K, a press release was not located, a patent belongs to a continuation family, or a company used an exclusive license instead of ownership. The requested records are intended to determine the facts.

Source record

1. [Theriva Form 10-K for the year ended Dec. 31, 2025, Intellectual Property and collaboration disclosures](#)
2. [Public assignee index — Theriva Biologics, Inc.](#)
3. [Public assignee index — Synthetic Biologics, Inc., page 1](#)
4. [Public assignee index — Synthetic Biologics, Inc., page 2](#)
5. [Public assignee index — Synthetic Biologics, Inc., page 3](#)
6. [Public assignee index — VCN Biosciences, S.L.](#)
7. [U.S. Patent No. 9,290,754 public patent record](#)
8. [U.S. Patent No. 11,236,319 public patent record](#)
9. [U.S. Patent No. 10,316,065 public patent record](#)
10. [USPTO MPEP § 301, ownership and assignability](#)
11. [U.S. Patent No. 9,404,103 B1 public patent text and downloadable PDF](#)
12. [Synthetic Biologics Mar. 1, 2016 SYN-004 patent-allowance release](#)
13. [Synthetic Biologics July 12, 2016 ribaxamase patent release](#)
14. [Synthetic Biologics Jan. 5, 2017 SEC-filed SYN-004 Phase 2b results release](#)
15. [Synthetic Biologics May 11, 2017 FDA Breakthrough Therapy Designation release](#)

Respectfully submitted,

Dated: _____

Signature: _____

Mark Joseph Nejme, Plaintiff, self-represented

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
DISTRICT OF NEVADA

MARK JOSEPH NEJMEH, Plaintiff, v. THERIVA BIOLOGICS, INC., Defendant.	Case No. 3:26-cv-00705 EXHIBIT P-7
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COMPLETE U.S. PATENT NO. 9,404,103 B1

Beta-Lactamases with Improved Properties for Therapy

The following 52 pages reproduce the complete public patent PDF. On patent page 2 (the twelfth page of the original PDF), yellow highlighting identifies the patent's exact statement that the improved beta-lactamases have uses **“including the prevention or treatment of CDI and/or a C. difficile-associated disease.”**

Accuracy limitation. The patent does **not** use the word “cure” to characterize SYN-004, ribaxamase, CDI, or a C. difficile-associated disease. The word “Cure” appears in the patent's references only as part of the title of a cited article concerning eradication of *Helicobacter pylori* and a duodenal ulcer. That citation is not a claim about SYN-004. Prevention nevertheless is a clinically meaningful therapeutic objective: the claimed approach is intended to prevent or treat CDI and associated disease before or while toxin-driven colon injury develops. C. difficile is a bacterium and CDI is an infection that can cause colitis; CDI is not itself an ulcer. The attached highlight therefore marks the patent's actual CDI language and does not alter it.

Evidentiary limitation. A patent records an issued claim and the applicant-authored specification. It is not FDA approval, proof of clinical efficacy, proof of commercial value, or a judicial finding that the treatment works.

Public source: <https://patents.google.com/patent/US9404103>

Direct public PDF: <https://patentimages.storage.googleapis.com/32/f2/1f/ca42f448d2c2be/US9404103.pdf>



US009404103B1

(12) **United States Patent**
Kaleko et al.

(10) **Patent No.:** **US 9,404,103 B1**
(45) **Date of Patent:** ***Aug. 2, 2016**

(54) **BETA-LACTAMASES WITH IMPROVED PROPERTIES FOR THERAPY**

(71) Applicant: **Synthetic Biologics, Inc.**, Rockville, MD (US)

(72) Inventors: **Michael Kaleko**, Rockville, MD (US);
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(73) Assignee: **Synthetic Biologics, Inc.**, Rockville, MD (US)

(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

This patent is subject to a terminal disclaimer.

(21) Appl. No.: **15/160,669**

(22) Filed: **May 20, 2016**

Related U.S. Application Data

(63) Continuation of application No. 15/019,474, filed on Feb. 9, 2016, now Pat. No. 9,376,673, which is a continuation of application No. 14/689,877, filed on Apr. 17, 2015, now Pat. No. 9,290,754.

(60) Provisional application No. 61/980,844, filed on Apr. 17, 2014, provisional application No. 62/046,627, filed on Sep. 5, 2014.

(51) **Int. Cl.**
C12N 9/86 (2006.01)
A61K 45/06 (2006.01)
A61K 9/00 (2006.01)
A61K 31/54 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **C12N 9/86** (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
None
See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

This invention relates to, in part, compositions of beta-lactamases and methods of using these enzymes in, for example, gastrointestinal tract (GI tract) disorders such as *C. difficile* infection (CDI).

29 Claims, 8 Drawing Sheets

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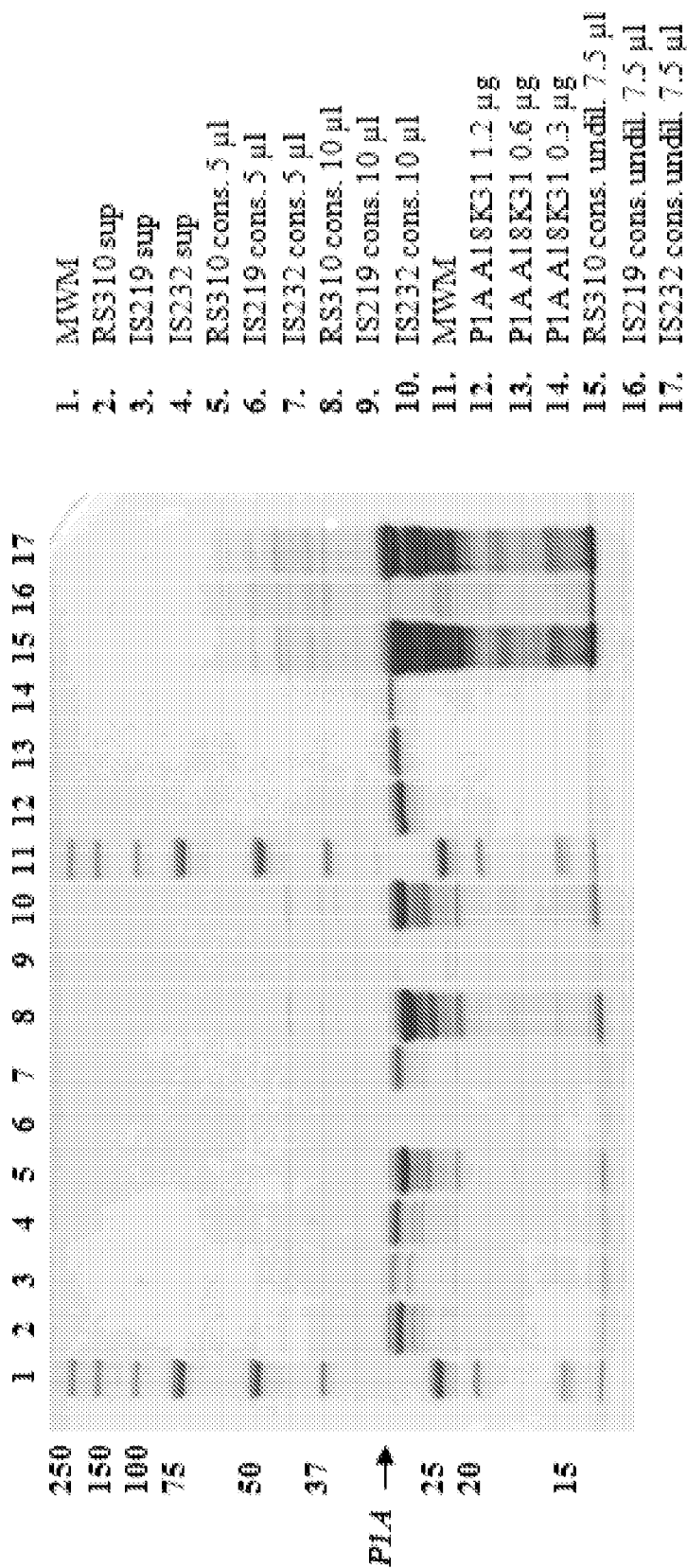


FIG. 1

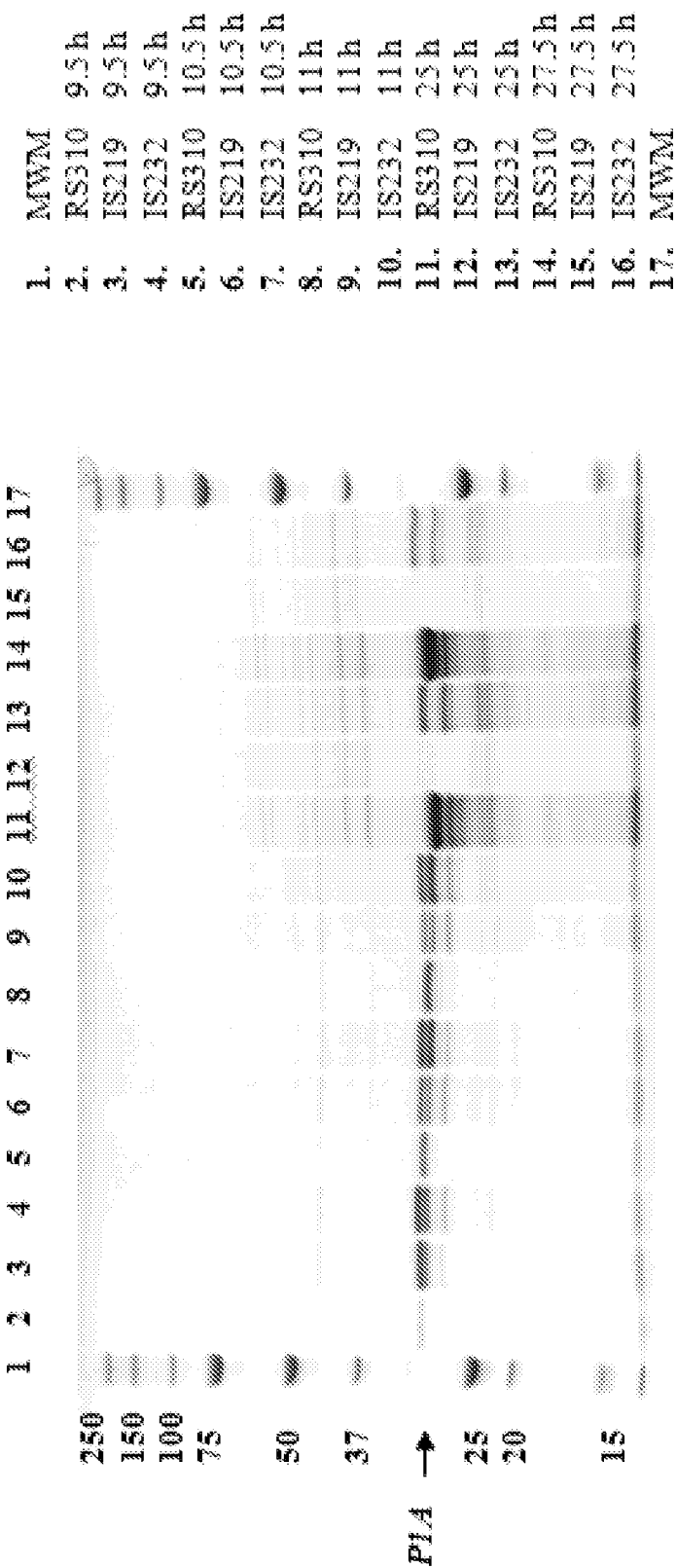


FIG. 2

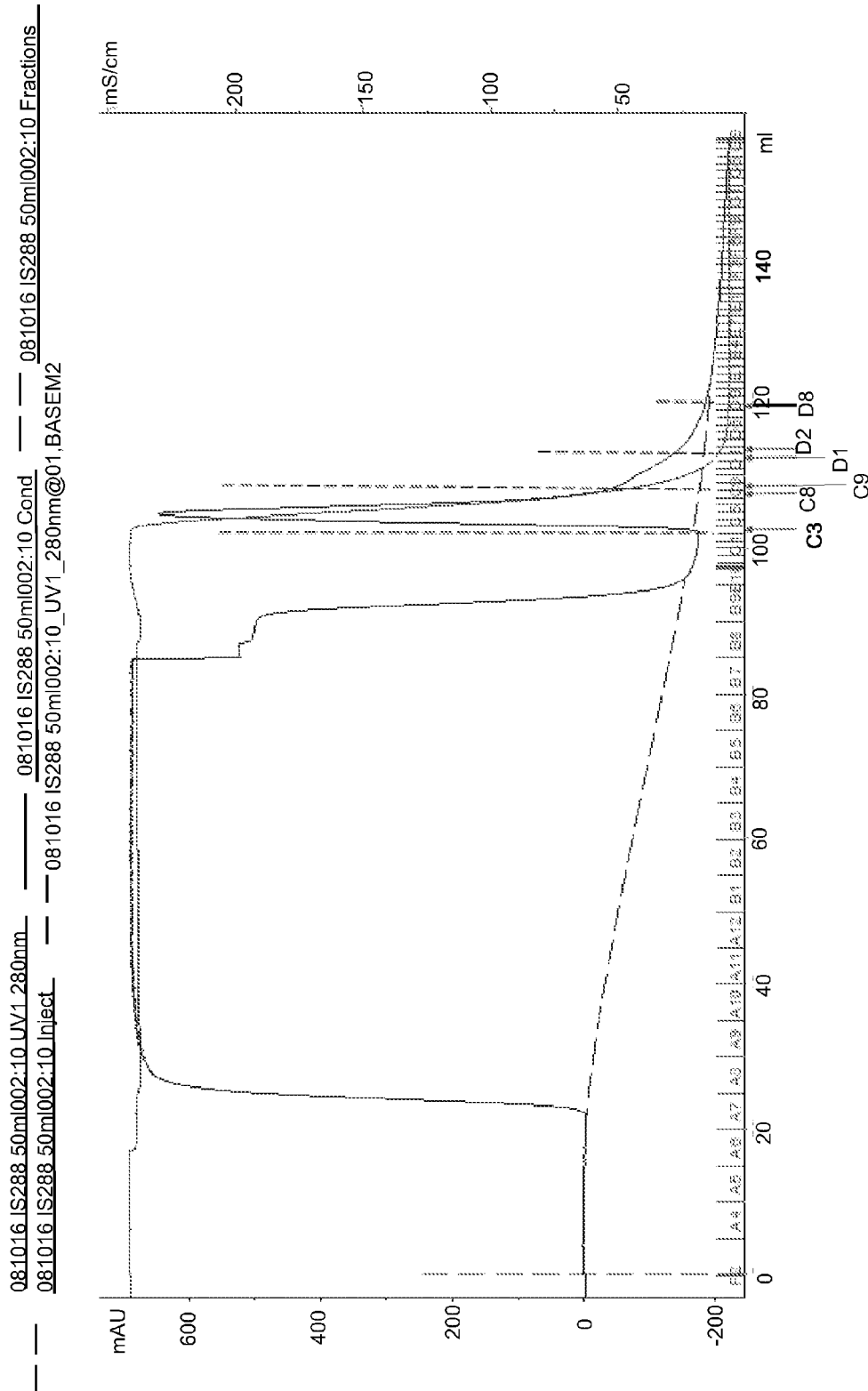


FIG. 3

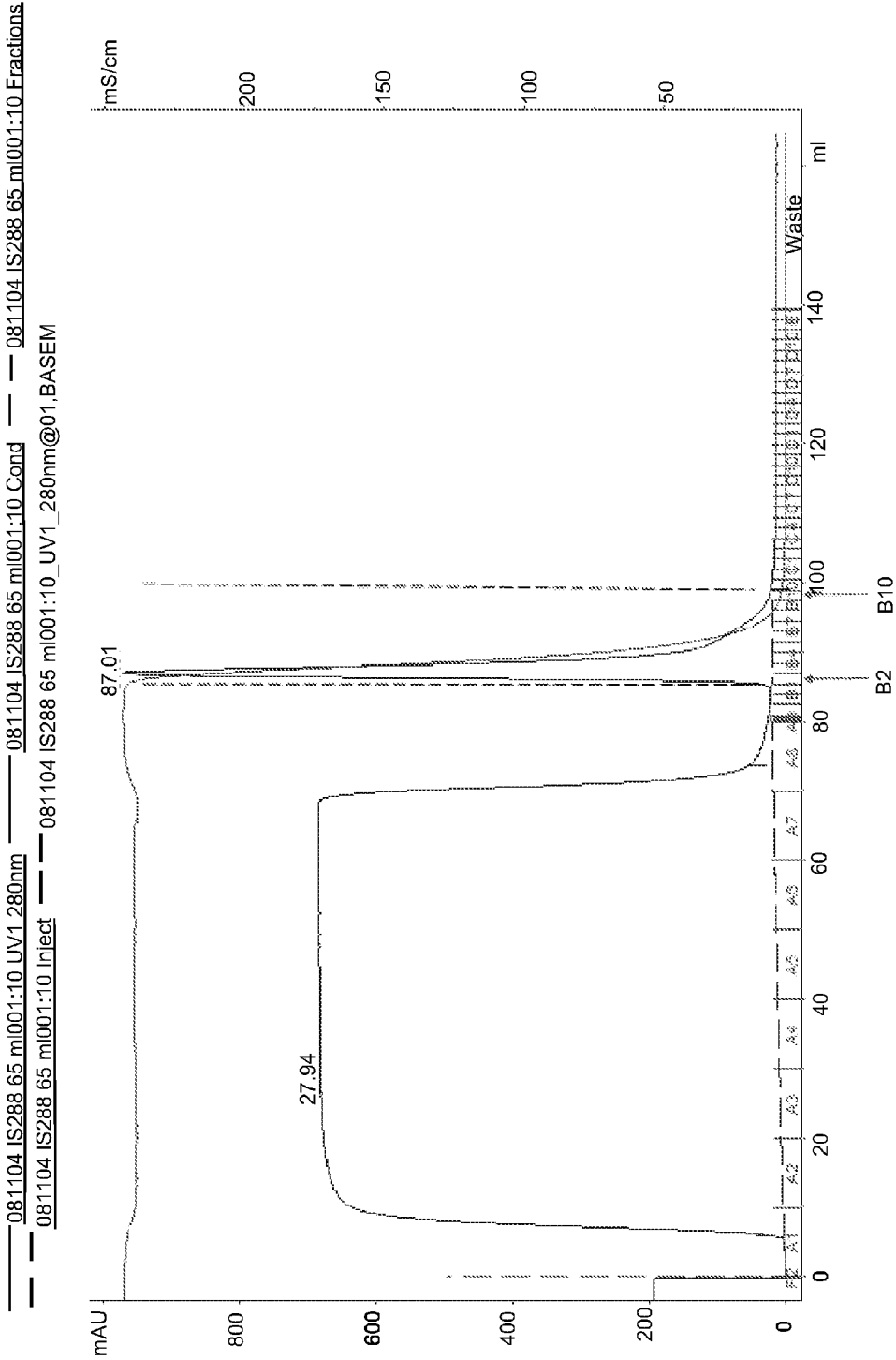


FIG. 4

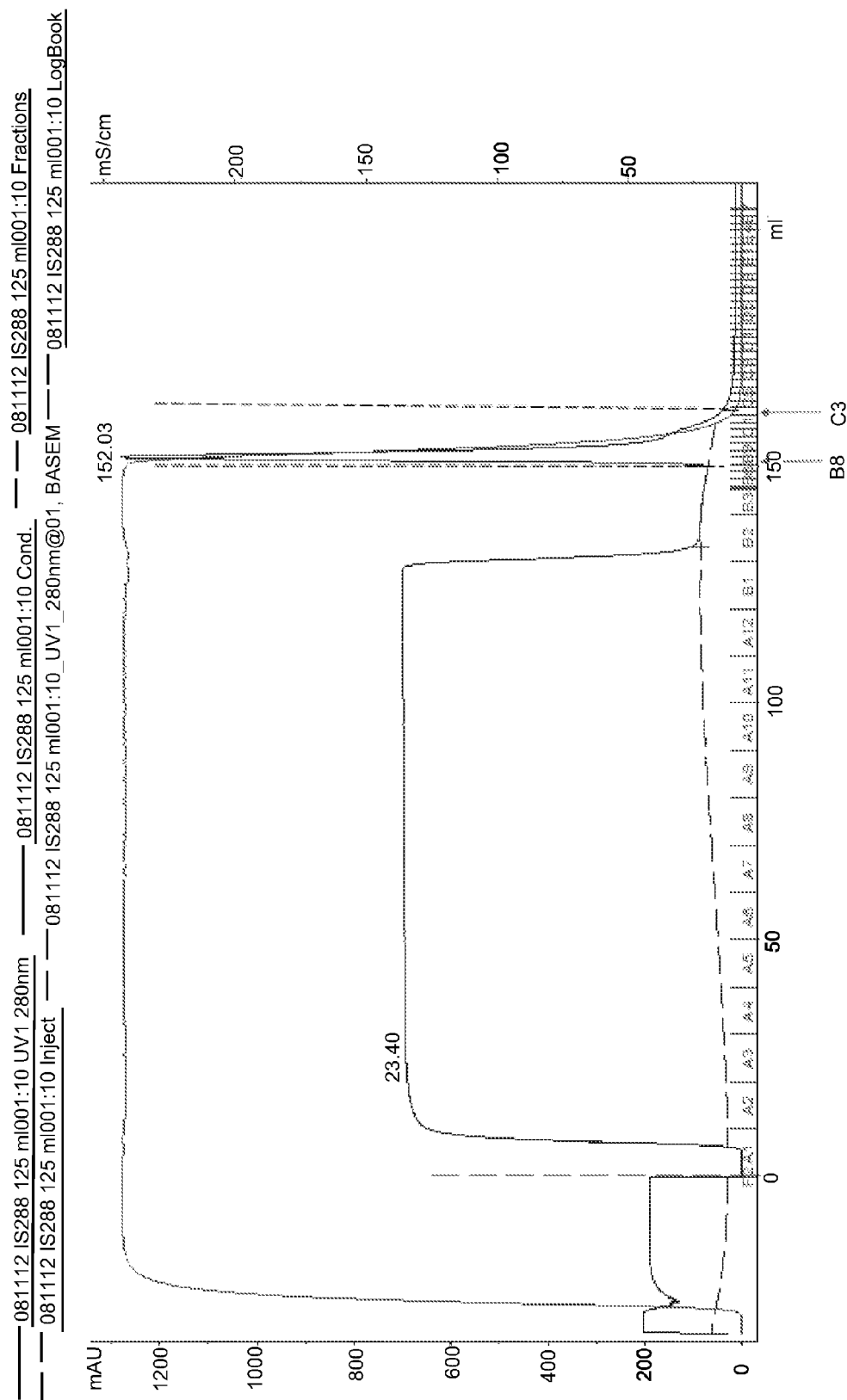


FIG. 5

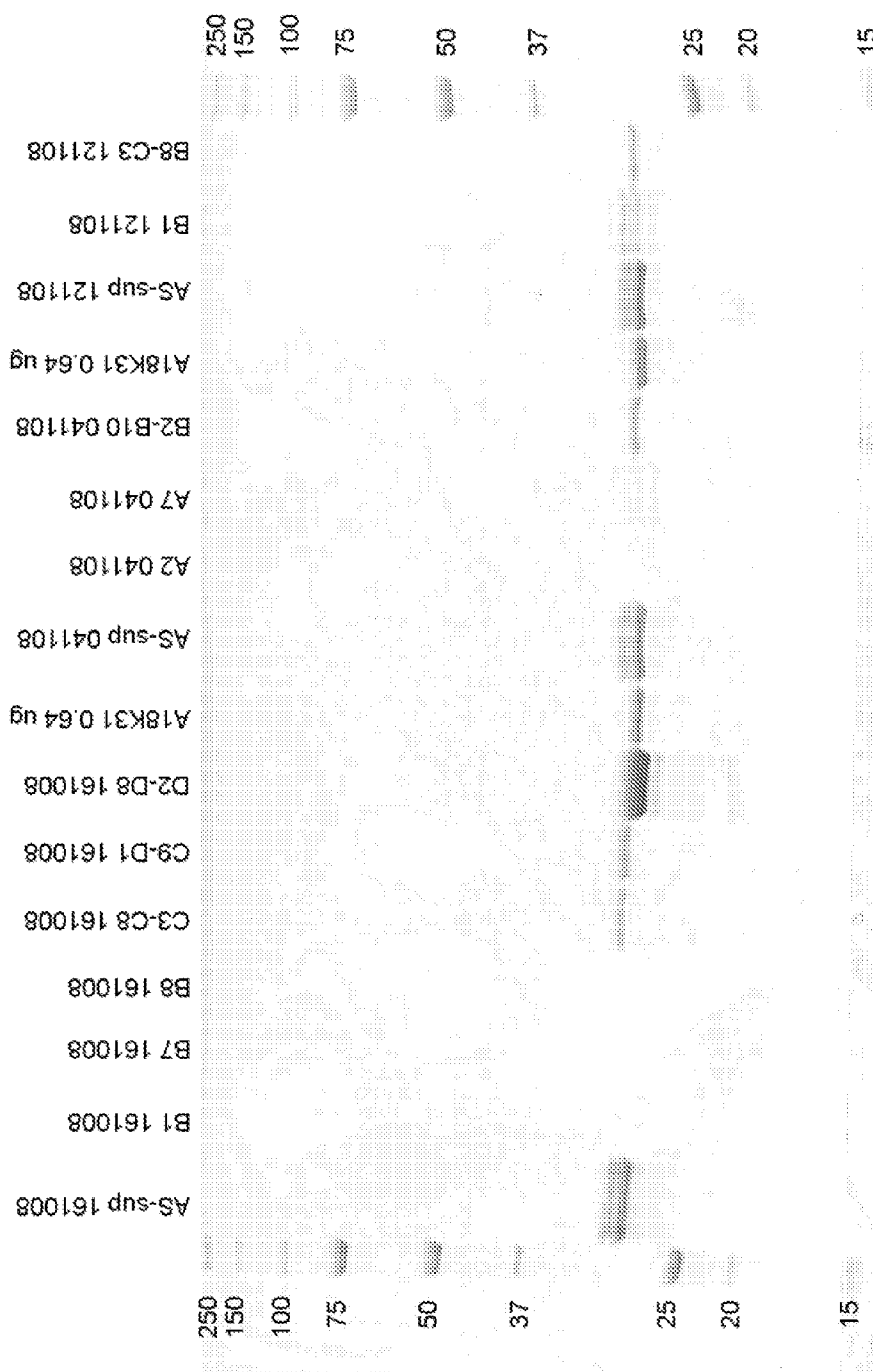


FIG. 6

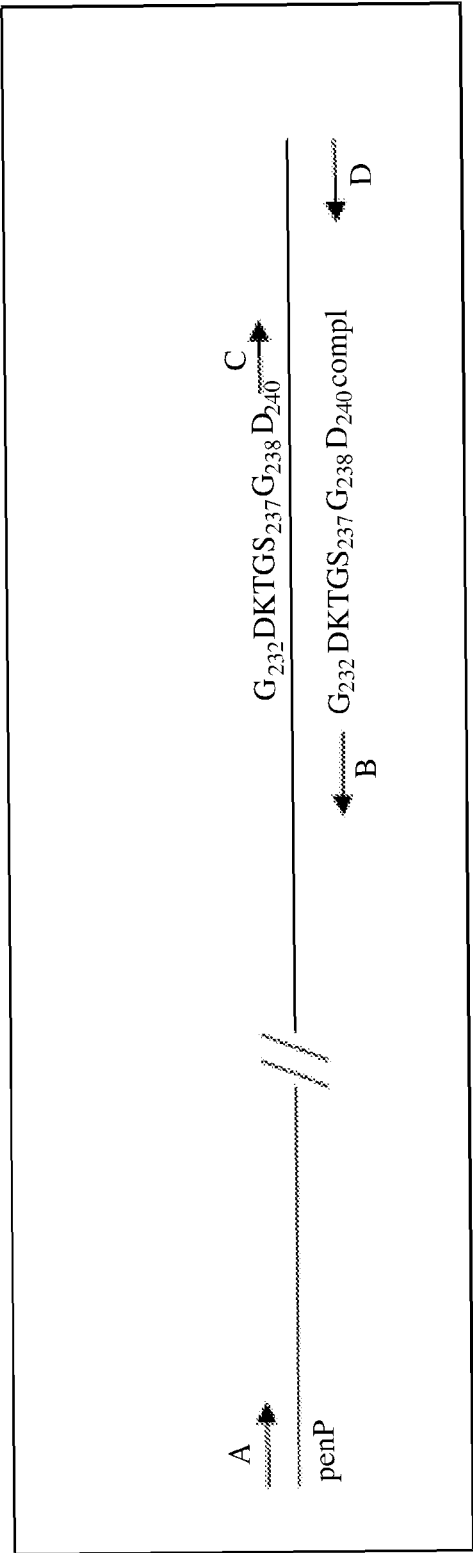


FIG. 7

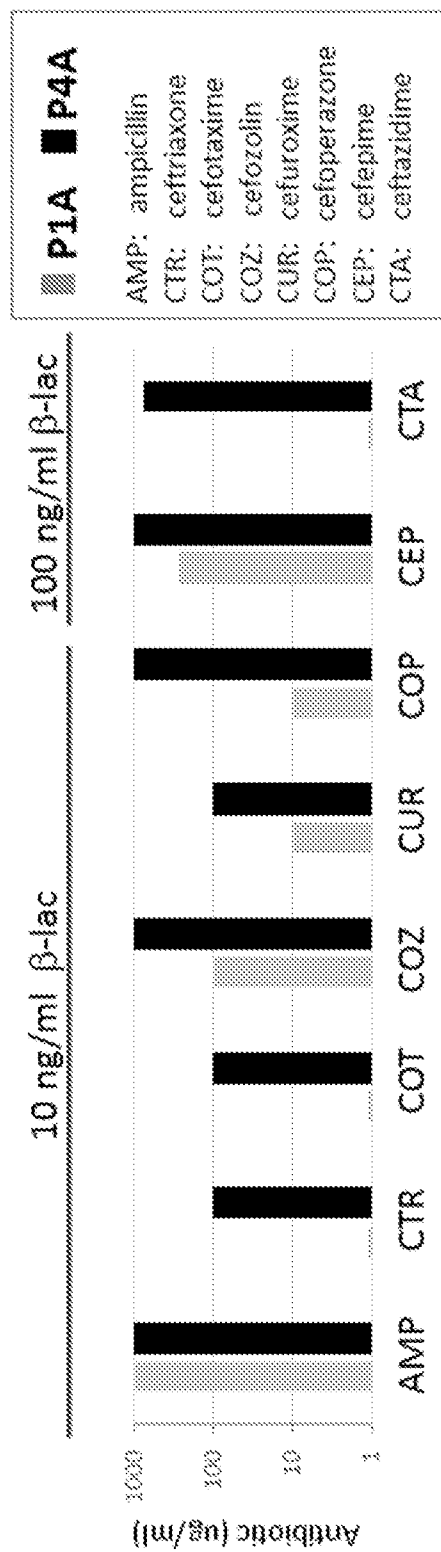


FIG. 8

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BETA-LACTAMASES WITH IMPROVED PROPERTIES FOR THERAPY

RELATED APPLICATIONS

This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/019,474, filed Feb. 9, 2016 and U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/689,877, filed Apr. 17, 2015 (now U.S. Pat. No. 9,290,754) and claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 61/980,844, filed Apr. 17, 2014, and U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/046,627, filed Sep. 5, 2014, both of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

This invention relates to, in part, compositions of beta-lactamases and methods for using these enzymes in, for example, gastrointestinal tract (GI tract) disorders such as *C. difficile* infection (CDI).

BACKGROUND

Humans may be considered to be a “superorganism” which is a conglomerate of mammalian and microbial cells, with the latter estimated to outnumber the former by ten to one. This microbial component, and its microbial genetic repertoire, the microbiome, is roughly 100-times greater than that of the human host. Strikingly, despite this enormous diversity of foreign organisms, the human immune system generally maintains a state of synergy. This is particularly true of the distal GI tract, which houses up to 1000 distinct bacterial species and an estimated excess of 1×10^{14} microorganisms, and appears to be central in defining human host health status. Loss of the careful balance in the microbiome, especially in the GI tract, can lead to various diseases.

However, antibiotic medical treatments, which are needed to treat certain aspects of disease, can induce disruption in the microbiome, including in the GI tract, and lead to further disease. For instance, certain parentally administered beta-lactams like ampicillin, ceftriaxone, cefoperazone, and piperacillin are, in part, eliminated via biliary excretion into the proximal part of the small intestine (duodenum). Residual unabsorbed beta-lactams in the intestinal tract may cause an undesirable effect on the ecological balance of normal intestinal microbiota resulting in, for example, CDI, antibiotic-associated diarrhea, overgrowth of pathogenic bacteria such as vancomycin resistant enterococci (VRE), extended-spectrum beta-lactamase producing Gram-negative bacilli (ESBL), and fungi, and selection of antibiotic-resistance strains among both normal intestinal microbiota and potential pathogen bacteria.

One approach for avoiding or rebalancing the ecological balance of normal intestinal microbiota is the therapeutic use of beta-lactamases, for example, by inactivating excreted or unabsorbed antibiotics in the GI tract, thereby maintaining a normal intestinal microbiota and preventing its overgrowth with potentially pathogenic micro-organisms.

There remains a need for agents and medicaments for the treatment of gastrointestinal tract (GI tract) disorders such as *C. difficile* infection (CDI) which have enzymatic properties that are best suited for these uses.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Accordingly, the present invention provides for beta-lactamases comprising an amino acid sequence that is based on the

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P1A beta-lactamase but containing advantageous mutations that, for example, change substrate specificity and/or activity and provide for therapeutic advantages. For example, such mutants can have at least 70% sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 1 and have one or more mutations at the following Ambler classification positions F33, Q135, G156, A232, A237, A238, S240, T243, R244, S266, and D276. Such beta-lactamases have the ability to hydrolyze both penicillins and cephalosporins and do so with enzymatically desirable characteristics, such as low K_M s and/or high V_{max} s for select antibiotic substrates.

These improved beta-lactamases find uses in a number of therapies, including the prevention or treatment of CDI and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease or other antibiotic-induced adverse effects in the GI tract. For example, the beta-lactamases find use in allowing a patient to undergo antibiotic therapy while being protected against disease that could result from excess antibiotics negatively affecting the microbiome. Such use does not interfere with the systemic utility of the antibiotic. Rather, the beta-lactamases clear out excess antibiotic that may populate parts of the GI tract and, in doing so, prevent the disruption of the microbiota that is linked to the various disease states described herein.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

FIG. 1 shows a 12% Bis-Tris Criterion XT SDS-PAGE (BioRad) gel with concentrated samples (see labels of the samples to the right of the gel) from a 10 g/l glucose *B. subtilis* growth. MWM=molecular weight marker Precision Plus (BioRad), RS310=P1A *B. subtilis* strain and P1A A18K31=P1A reference material. “P1A→” denotes the right size of P1A and the mutant proteins.

FIG. 2 shows a 12% Bis-Tris Criterion XT SDS-PAGE (BioRad) gel with supernatant samples (see labels of the samples to the right of the gel) from a 5 g/l glucose *B. subtilis* growth. 14 μ l of each supernatant was applied on the gel. MWM=molecular weight marker Precision Plus (BioRad), RS310=P1A *B. subtilis* strain and “P1A” denotes the right size of P1A and the mutant proteins.

FIG. 3 shows an elution diagram from a HIC run. The places of collected elution fractions are marked with arrows and black dashed lines (dashed lines farthest to the right) both perpendicular to the X-axis. Flow-through fractions A7-B8 can be easily seen on the diagram. The A_{280} graph is represented with a solid line (top line), conductivity of the eluted solution by a solid line (second line from the top). Sample injection is marked with a dashed line (dashed line farthest to the left) and fractions with multiple solid lines both perpendicular to the X-axis.

FIG. 4 shows an elution diagram from a HIC run. The places of collected elution fractions are marked with arrows and black dashed lines (dashed lines farthest to the right) both perpendicular to the X-axis. Flow-through fractions A1-A8 can be easily seen on the diagram. The A_{280} graph is represented with a solid line (second line from the top), conductivity of the eluted solution by a solid line (top line). Sample injection is marked with a dashed line (dashed line farthest to the left) and fractions with multiple solid lines both perpendicular to the X-axis.

FIG. 5 shows an elution diagram from a HIC run. The places of collected elution fractions are marked with arrows and black dashed lines (dashed lines farthest to the right) both perpendicular to the X-axis. Flow-through fractions A1-B1 can be easily seen on the diagram. The A_{280} graph is represented with a solid line (second line from the top), conductivity of the eluted solution by a solid line (top line). Sample

injection is marked with a dashed line (dashed line farthest to the left) and fractions with multiple solid lines both perpendicular to the X-axis. The section before zero at the X-axis represents the column equilibration with buffer A.

FIG. 6 shows a SDS-PAGE gel of the fractions of the three HIC purifications shown in FIGS. 3-5. AS-sup=ammonium sulphate filtrate used in the particular purification, i.e. starting material for purification. B1 161008, B7 161008, B8 161008, A2 041108, A7 041108, and B1 121108: flow through fractions of each of purifications. C3-C8 161008, C9-D1 161008, D2-D8 161008, B2-B10 041108, and B8-C3 121108: eluted protein peak, pooled fractions. A18K31 P1A: reference material, 0.64 µg/lane.

FIG. 7 demonstrates the SOE (spliced overlap extension) technique. The target amino acids of the B3 β-strand of P1A are so closely situated to each other that all four amino acids can be exchanged using the SOE technique. The region encompassing the exchanges contains 24 nucleotides (8 amino acid codons) and is included in the overlap extension part of two PCR primers. Mutated penP gene is first amplified by PCR in two parts, using primers A+B and C+D. The two PCR products are then combined and amplified using primers A and D, complementary to the 5' and 3' parts of the penP gene. Cloning sites are included in primers A and D. Once the construct is ready, further mutations can be added using the Multi kit. The amino acid sequences encoded by the overlapping primers (B and C) are shown.

FIG. 8 demonstrate antibiotic degradation activity of P1A (left bars) and P4A (right bars). Concentrations of 10 or 100 ng/ml of enzyme are used against the indicated antibiotics. The data are plotted as the highest antibiotic concentration that is degraded by the indicated beta-lactamase (the antibiotic concentrations used were 10, 100, or 1000 µg/ml).

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

The present invention is based, in part, on the discovery of certain mutant beta-lactamase enzymes that have desirable characteristics for use in therapy, including, for example, an ability to hydrolyze one or more of penicillins and cephalosporins.

In some aspects, the present invention provides for beta-lactamases, and pharmaceutical compositions of these beta-lactamases. In various aspects, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions are derived by mutation from SEQ ID NO: 1 (*Bacillus licheniformis* PenP, i.e. P1A). Accordingly, in various aspects, the present invention provides for beta-lactamases, and/or pharmaceutical compositions which are P1A derivatives.

P1A was designed to inactivate parenterally administered penicillin group beta-lactams (e.g. penicillin, amoxicillin, ampicillin and piperacillin) with or without beta-lactamase inhibitors (e.g. tazobactam, sulbactam, clavulanic acid) excreted via biliary system (see International Patent Publications WO 1993/013795 and WO 2008/065247; Tarkkanen, A. M. et al., *Antimicrob Agents Chemother.* 53: 2455, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety). The P1A enzyme is a recombinant form of *Bacillus licheniformis* 749/C small exo beta-lactamase (WO 2008/065247) which belongs to class A and is grouped to subgroup 2a in functional classification. *B. licheniformis* beta-lactamase and its P1A derivative are considered as penicillinases which have high hydrolytic capacity to degrade e.g. penicillin, ampicillin, amoxicillin or piperacillin and they are generally inhibited by active site-directed beta-lactamase inhibitors such as clavulanic acid, sulbactam or tazobactam. However, the P1A enzyme has a limited capacity to inactivate

beta-lactam antibiotics that belong to the cephalosporin or the carbapenem group. Because the employed beta-lactamases possess poor activity to cephalosporins, they cannot be applied in conjunction with parenteral cephalosporin therapy for inactivation of unabsorbed beta-lactam in the small intestinal tract. Therefore, in some embodiments, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the present invention improve upon the properties of P1A, as described herein.

In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess desirable characteristics, including, for example, having an ability to efficiently target a broad spectra of antibiotics. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess desirable enzyme kinetic characteristics. For example, in some embodiments, the beta-lactamases possess a low K_M for at least one cephalosporin, including, for example, a K_M of less than about 500 µM, or about 100 µM, or about 10 µM, or about 1 µM, or about 0.1 µM (100 nM), or about 0.01 µM (10 nM), or about 1 nM. For example, in some embodiments, the beta-lactamases possess a low K_M for at least one penicillin, including, for example, a K_M of less than about 500 µM, or about 100 µM, or about 10 µM, or about 1 µM, or about 0.1 µM (100 nM), or about 0.01 µM (10 nM), or about 1 nM. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess a high V_{max} for at least one cephalosporin, including, for example, V_{max} which is greater than about 100 s⁻¹, or about 1000 s⁻¹, or about 10000 s⁻¹, or about 100000 s⁻¹, or about 1000000 s⁻¹. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess a high V_{max} for at least one penicillin, including, for example, V_{max} which is greater than about 100 s⁻¹, or about 1000 s⁻¹, or about 10000 s⁻¹, or about 100000 s⁻¹, or about 1000000 s⁻¹. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess catalytic efficiency is greater than about 10⁶ M⁻¹s⁻¹ for at least one cephalosporin. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess catalytic efficiency is greater than about 10⁶ M⁻¹s⁻¹ for at least one penicillin. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess the desirable enzyme kinetic characteristics for at least one of either or both of cephalosporins and penicillins. In various embodiments, specific antibiotics (e.g. cephalosporins and penicillins are described herein).

Provided herein is the 263 amino acid sequence of the P1A enzyme (after removal of a 31 amino acid signal sequence and the QASKT (Gln-Ala-Ser-Lys-Thr) pentapeptide at the N terminus, see SEQ ID NO: 3). As described herein, mutations may be made to this sequence to generate the inventive beta-lactamases.

SEQ ID NO: 1

Glu Met Lys Asp Asp Phe Ala Lys Leu Glu Glu Gln
Phe Asp Ala Lys Leu Gly Ile Phe Ala Leu Asp Thr
Gly Thr Asn Arg Thr Val Ala Tyr Arg Pro Asp Glu
Arg Phe Ala Phe Ala Ser Thr Ile Lys Ala Leu Thr
Val Gly Val Leu Leu Gln Gln Lys Ser Ile Glu Asp
Leu Asn Gln Arg Ile Thr Tyr Thr Arg Asp Asp Leu
Val Asn Tyr Asn Pro Ile Thr Glu Lys His Val Asp
Thr Gly Met Thr Leu Lys Glu Leu Ala Asp Ala Ser
Leu Arg Tyr Ser Asp Asn Ala Ala Gln Asn Leu Ile
Leu Lys Gln Ile Gly Gly Pro Glu Ser Leu Lys Lys

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Glu Leu Arg Lys Ile Gly Asp Glu Val Thr Asn Pro
 Glu Arg Phe Glu Pro Glu Leu Asn Glu Val Asn Pro
 Gly Glu Thr Gln Asp Thr Ser Thr Ala Arg Ala Leu
 Val Thr Ser Leu Arg Ala Phe Ala Leu Glu Asp Lys
 Leu Pro Ser Glu Lys Arg Glu Leu Leu Ile Asp Trp
 Met Lys Arg Asn Thr Thr Gly Asp Ala Leu Ile Arg
 Ala Gly Val Pro Asp Gly Trp Glu Val Ala Asp Lys
 Thr Gly Ala Ala Ser Tyr Gly Thr Arg Asn Asp Ile
 Ala Ile Ile Trp Pro Pro Lys Gly Asp Pro Val Val
 Leu Ala Val Leu Ser Ser Arg Asp Lys Lys Asp Ala
 Lys Tyr Asp Asp Lys Leu Ile Ala Glu Ala Thr Lys
 Val Val Met Lys Ala Leu Asn Met Asn Gly Lys.

In some embodiments, SEQ ID NO: 1 may have a Met and/or Thr preceeding the first residue of the sequence. In various embodiments, the Met may be cleaved. As described herein, mutations may be made to the sequence comprising the Met and/or Thr preceeding the first residue to generate the inventive beta-lactamases.

Also provided herein is the 299 amino acid sequence of the P1A enzyme before removal of a 31 amino acid signal sequence and the QASKT (Gln-Ala-Ser-Lys-Thr) pentapeptide at the N terminus as SEQ ID NO: 3:

SEQ ID NO: 3

Met Ile Gln Lys Arg Lys Arg Thr Val Ser Phe Arg
 Leu Val Leu Met Cys Thr Leu Leu Phe Val Ser Leu
 Pro Ile Thr Lys Thr Ser Ala Gln Ala Ser Lys Thr
 Glu Met Lys Asp Asp Phe Ala Lys Leu Glu Glu Gln
 Phe Asp Ala Lys Leu Gly Ile Phe Ala Leu Asp Thr
 Gly Thr Asn Arg Thr Val Ala Tyr Arg Pro Asp Glu
 Arg Phe Ala Phe Ala Ser Thr Ile Lys Ala Leu Thr
 Val Gly Val Leu Leu Gln Gln Lys Ser Ile Glu Asp
 Leu Asn Gln Arg Ile Thr Tyr Thr Arg Asp Asp Leu
 Val Asn Tyr Asn Pro Ile Thr Glu Lys His Val Asp
 Thr Gly Met Thr Leu Lys Glu Leu Ala Asp Ala Ser
 Leu Arg Tyr Ser Asp Asn Ala Ala Gln Asn Leu Ile
 Leu Lys Gln Ile Gly Gly Pro Glu Ser Leu Lys Lys
 Glu Leu Arg Lys Ile Gly Asp Glu Val Thr Asn Pro
 Glu Arg Phe Glu Pro Glu Leu Asn Glu Val Asn Pro
 Gly Glu Thr Gln Asp Thr Ser Thr Ala Arg Ala Leu
 Val Thr Ser Leu Arg Ala Phe Ala Leu Glu Asp Lys
 Leu Pro Ser Glu Lys Arg Glu Leu Leu Ile Asp Trp
 Met Lys Arg Asn Thr Thr Gly Asp Ala Leu Ile Arg
 Ala Gly Val Pro Asp Gly Trp Glu Val Ala Asp Lys
 Thr Gly Ala Ala Ser Tyr Gly Thr Arg Asn Asp Ile

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-continued

Ala Ile Ile Trp Pro Pro Lys Gly Asp Pro Val Val
 Leu Ala Val Leu Ser Ser Arg Asp Lys Lys Asp Ala
 Lys Tyr Asp Asp Lys Leu Ile Ala Glu Ala Thr Lys
 Val Val Met Lys Ala Leu Asn Met Asn Gly Lys

Further, the present invention also provides for additional upstream residues from the first residue of SEQ ID NO: 1 (see, e.g., *JBC* 258 (18): 11211, 1983, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference—including the exo-large and exo-small versions of penP and penP1). Further, the present invention also provides for additional downstream residues from the last residue of SEQ ID NO: 1.

The polynucleotide sequence of P1A (after removal of a 31 amino acid signal sequence and the QAKST pentapeptide at the N terminus) is also provided as SEQ ID NO: 2. As described herein, mutations may be made to this sequence to generate the inventive beta-lactamases (including, taking into account degeneracy of the genetic code).

SEQ ID NO: 2

gagatgaaagatgattttgcaaaacttgaggaacaatttgatgcaaaact
 cgggatctttgcattggatacaggtacaaacggacggtagcgtatcggc
 cggatgagcgttttgcctttgcttcgacgattaaggctttaactgtaggc
 gtgcttttgcaacagaaatcaatagaagatctgaaccagagaataacata
 tacacgtgatgatcttgtaaactacaacccgattacggaagacacgttg
 atacgggaatgacgctcaaagagcttgccgatgcttcgcttcgatatagt
 gacaatgcggcacagaatctcattcttaacaaattggcggacctgaaag
 tttgaaaaaggaaactgaggaagattggtgatgaggtacaaatcccgaaac
 gattcgaaaccagagttaaatgaagtgaatccgggtgaaactcaggatacc
 agtacagcaagagcacttgtcacaagccttcgagcctttgctcttgaaaga
 taaacttccaagtgaataacgcgagcttttaacgattggatgaaacgaa
 ataccactggagacgccttaacccgtgcccgtgtgcccggacggttgggaa
 gtggctgataaaactggagcggcatcatatggaacccggaatgacattgc
 catcatttggccgcaaaaggagatcctgtcgttcttgacgtattatcca
 gcagggataaaaaggacgccaagtatgatgataaacttattgcagaggca
 acaaagggtggaatgaaagccttaaacatgaacggcaataa

Also provided is the polynucleotide sequence of P1A before the removal of a 31 amino acid signal sequence and the QASKT pentapeptide at the N terminus as SEQ ID NO: 4. As described herein, mutations may be made to this sequence to generate the inventive beta-lactamases (including, taking into account degeneracy of the genetic code).

SEQ ID NO: 4

atgattcaaaaacgaaagcggacagtttcgttcagacttgcttattgtg
 cagcgtgttatttgcagtttgccgattacaaaaacatcagcgcaagctt
 ccaagacggagatgaaagatgattttgcaaaacttgaggaacaatttgat
 gcaaaactcgggatctttgcattggatacaggtacaaacggacggttagc
 gtatcgccggatgagcgttttgcctttgcttcgacgattaaggctttaa

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ctgtaggcgtgcttttgcacagaaatcaatagaagatctgaaccagaga
 ataacatatcacgtgatgatcttgtaaacataacccgattacggaaaa
 gcacgttgatacgggaatgacgctcaagagcttgccgatgcttcgcttc
 gatatagtgacaaatgcggcacagaatctcattcttaacaaattggcgga
 cctgaaagtgtgaaaaaggaactgaggaagattggtgatgaggttataaa
 tcccgaaacgattcgaaccagagtttaaatgaagtgaatccgggtgaaactc
 aggataccagtagcagaagagcacttggtcacaaagccttcgagcctttgct
 cttgaagataaaactccaagtgaacacgcgagcttttaacgattggat
 gaaacgaaataaccactggagacgccttaacccgtgccggtgtgccggacg
 gttgggaagtggctgataaaactggagcggcatcatatggaacccggaat
 gacattgccatcatttggccgcaaaaaggagatcctgtcgttcttgcagt
 attatccagcaggataaaaaaggacgccaagtatgatgat aaacttatt
 gcagaggcaacaaaggtggtaatgaaagccttaaacatgaacggcaata
 a

In some embodiments, the invention pertains to mutagenesis of a beta-lactamase (e.g. a class A beta-lactamase) to derive advantageous enzymes (e.g. those that can target a broad spectra of antibiotics). In some embodiments, the invention includes site-directed mutagenesis, random mutagenesis, and/or directed evolution approaches. In some embodiments, mutation design is based on, inter alia, structural data (e.g. crystal structure data, homolog models, etc.) of the following: P1A crystal structure (Knox and Moews, *J. Mol Biol.*, 220, 435-455 (1991)), CTX-M-44 (1BZA (Ibuka et al. *Journal of Molecular Biology* Volume 285, Issue 5 2079-2087 (1999)), 1IYS (Ibuka et al. *Biochemistry*, 2003, 42 (36): 10634-43), 1IYO, 1IYP and 1IYQ (Shimamura et al. 2002 *J. Biol. Chem.* 277:46601-08), *Proteus vulgaris* K1 (1HZO, Nugaka et al. *J Mol Biol.* 2002 Mar. 15;317(1):109-17) and *Proteus penneri* Huga (Liassine et al. *Antimicrob Agents Chemother.* 2002 January;46(1):216-9. 2002), and reviewed in Bonnet, *Antimicrob. Agents Chemother* 48(1): 1-14 (2004) (for CTM-X), the contents of all of these documents are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety). In some embodiments, the present mutations are informed by analysis of structural data (e.g. crystal structure data, homolog models, etc.) of any one of the following beta-lactamases: P1A (see, e.g. U.S. Pat. No. 5,607,671, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference), P2A (see, e.g., WO 2007/147945, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference), P3A (see, e.g., WO 2011/148041, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference), CTX-M-3, CTX-M-4, CTX-M-5, CTX-M-9, CTX-M-10, CTX-M-14, CTX-M-15, CTX-M-16, CTX-M-18, CTX-M-19, CTX-M-25, CTX-M-26, CTX-M-27, CTX-M-32, CTX-M-44, CTX-M-45, and CTX-M-54. Such information is available to one skilled in the art at known databases, for example, Swiss-Prot Protein Sequence Data Bank, NCBI, and PDB.

In some embodiments, the invention pertains to one or more (e.g. about 1, or about 2, or about 3, or about 4, or about 5, or about 6, or about 7, or about 8, or about 9, or about 10, or about 15, or about 20, or about 30, or about 40, or about 50, or about 60, or about 70, or about 80, or about 90, or about 100, or about 110, or about 120, or about 130, or about 140, or about 150) mutations to SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 or

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a sequence with at least 30, 35, 40, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 99.5, 99.8, 99.9% identity to SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 (or about 70%, or about 75%, or about 80%, or about 85%, or about 90, or about 95%, or about 96%, or about 97%, or about 98%, or about 99% identity to SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3). In various embodiments, one or more amino acid of SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 is substituted with a naturally occurring amino acid, such as a hydrophilic amino acid (e.g. a polar and positively charged hydrophilic amino acid, such as arginine (R) or lysine (K); a polar and neutral of charge hydrophilic amino acid, such as asparagine (N), glutamine (Q), serine (S), threonine (T), proline (P), and cysteine (C), a polar and negatively charged hydrophilic amino acid, such as aspartate (D) or glutamate (E), or an aromatic, polar and positively charged hydrophilic amino acid, such as histidine (H)) or a hydrophobic amino acid (e.g. a hydrophobic, aliphatic amino acid such as glycine (G), alanine (A), leucine (L), isoleucine (I), methionine (M), or valine (V), a hydrophobic, aromatic amino acid, such as phenylalanine (F), tryptophan (W), or tyrosine (Y) or a non-classical amino acid (e.g. selenocysteine, pyrrolysine, N-formylmethionine β -alanine, GABA and δ -Aminolevulinic acid. 4-Aminobenzoic acid (PABA), D-isomers of the common amino acids, 2,4-diaminobutyric acid, α -amino isobutyric acid, 4-aminobutyric acid, Abu, 2-amino butyric acid, γ -Abu, ϵ -Ahx, 6-amino hexanoic acid, Aib, 2-amino isobutyric acid, 3-amino propionic acid, ornithine, norleucine, norvaline, hydroxyproline, sarcosine, citrulline, homocitrulline, cysteic acid, t-butylglycine, t-butylalanine, phenylglycine, cyclohexylalanine, β -alanine, fluoramino acids, designer amino acids such as β methyl amino acids, C α -methyl amino acids, N α -methyl amino acids, and amino acid analogs in general).

In illustrative embodiments, inventive mutations include, but are not limited to one or more (e.g. about 1, or about 2, or about 3, or about 4, or about 5, or about 6, or about 7, or about 8, or about 9, or about 10, or about 15, or about 20, or about 30, or about 40, or about 50, or about 60, or about 70, or about 80, or about 90, or about 100, or about 110, or about 120, or about 130, or about 140, or about 150) of the following mutations to SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 or a sequence with at least 30, 35, 40, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 99.5, 99.8, 99.9% identity to SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 (or about 70%, or about 75%, or about 80%, or about 85%, or about 90, or about 95%, or about 96%, or about 97%, or about 98%, or about 99% identity to SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3): Glu1A1a; Glu1Cys; Glu1Asp; Glu1Phe; Glu1Gly; Glu1His; Glu1Ile; Met1Lys; Glu1Leu; Glu1Met; Glu1Asn; Glu1Pro; Glu1Gln; Glu1Arg; Glu1Ser; Glu1Thr; Glu1Val; Glu1Trp; Glu1Tyr; Met2Ala; Met2Cys; Met2Asp; Met2Glu; Met2Phe; Met2Gly; Met2His; Met2Ile; Met1Lys; Met2Leu; Met2Asn; Met2Pro; Met2Gln; Met2Arg; Met2Ser; Met2Thr; Met2Val; Met2Trp; Met2Tyr; Lys3Ala; Lys3Cys; Lys3Asp; Lys3Glu; Lys3Phe; Lys3Gly; Lys3His; Lys3Ile; Lys3Leu; Lys3Met; Lys3Asn; Lys3Pro; Lys3Gln; Lys3Arg; Lys3Ser; Lys3Thr; Lys3Val; Lys3Trp; Lys3Tyr; Asp4Ala; Asp4Cys; Asp4Glu; Asp4Phe; Asp4Gly; Asp4His; Asp4Ile; Asp4Lys; Asp4Leu; Asp4Met; Asp4Asn; Asp4Pro; Asp4Gln; Asp4Arg; Asp4Ser; Asp4Thr; Asp4Val; Asp4Trp; Asp4Tyr; Asp5Ala; Asp5Cys; Asp5Glu; Asp5Phe; Asp5Gly; Asp5His; Asp5Ile; Asp5Lys; Asp5Leu; Asp5Met; Asp5Asn; Asp5Pro; Asp5Gln; Asp5Arg; Asp5Ser; Asp5Thr; Asp5Val; Asp5Trp; Asp5Tyr; Phe6Ala; Phe6Cys; Phe6Asp;

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Phe6Glu; Phe6Gly; Phe6His; Phe6Ile; Phe6Lys; Phe6Leu;
 Phe6Met; Phe6Asn; Phe6Pro; Phe6Gln; Phe6Arg; Phe6Ser;
 Phe6Thr; Phe6Val; Phe6Trp; Phe6Tyr; Ala7Cys; Ala7Asp;
 Ala7Glu; Ala7Phe; Ala7Gly; Ala7His; Ala7Ile; Ala7Lys;
 Ala7Leu; Ala7Met; Ala7Asn; Ala7Pro; Ala7Gln; Ala7Arg;
 Ala7Ser; Ala7Thr; Ala7Val; Ala7Trp; Ala7Tyr; Lys8Ala;
 Lys8Cys; Lys8Asp; Lys8Glu; Lys8Phe; Lys8Gly; Lys8His;
 Lys8Ile; Lys8Leu; Lys8Met; Lys8Asn; Lys8Pro; Lys8Gln;
 Lys8Arg; Lys8Ser; Lys8Thr; Lys8Val; Lys8Trp; Lys8Tyr;
 Leu9Ala; Leu9Cys; Leu9Asp; Leu9Glu; Leu9Phe; Leu9Gly;
 Leu9His; Leu9Ile; Leu9Lys; Leu9Met; Leu9Asn; Leu9Pro;
 Leu9Gln; Leu9Arg; Leu9Ser; Leu9Thr; Leu9Val; Leu9Trp;
 Leu9Tyr; Glu10Ala; Glu10Cys; Glu10Asp; Glu10Phe;
 Glu10Gly; Glu10His; Glu10Ile; Glu10Lys; Glu10Leu;
 Glu10Met; Glu10Asn; Glu10Pro; Glu10Gln; Glu10Arg;
 Glu10Ser; Glu10Thr; Glu10Val; Glu10Trp; Glu10Tyr;
 Glu11Ala; Glu11Cys; Glu11Asp; Glu11Phe; Glu11Gly;
 Glu11His; Glu11Ile; Glu11Lys; Glu11Leu; Glu11Met;
 Glu11Asn; Glu11Pro; Glu11Gln; Glu11Arg; Glu11Ser;
 Glu11Thr; Glu11Val; Glu11Trp; Glu11Tyr; Gln12Ala;
 Gln12Cys; Gln12Asp; Gln12Glu; Gln12Phe; Gln12Gly;
 Gln12His; Gln12Ile; Gln12Lys; Gln12Leu; Gln12Met;
 Gln12Asn; Gln12Pro; Gln12Arg; Gln12Ser; Gln12Thr;
 Gln12Val; Gln12Trp; Gln12Tyr; Phe13Ala; Phe13Cys;
 Phe13Asp; Phe13Glu; Phe13Gly; Phe13His; Phe13Ile;
 Phe13Lys; Phe13Leu; Phe13Met; Phe13Asn; Phe13Pro;
 Phe13Gln; Phe13Arg; Phe13Ser; Phe13Thr; Phe13Val;
 Phe13Trp; Phe13Tyr; Asp14Ala; Asp14Cys; Asp14Glu;
 Asp14Phe; Asp14Gly; Asp14His; Asp14Ile; Asp14Lys;
 Asp14Leu; Asp14Met; Asp14Asn; Asp14Pro; Asp14Gln;
 Asp14Arg; Asp14Ser; Asp14Thr; Asp14Val; Asp14Trp;
 Asp14Tyr; Ala15Cys; Ala15Asp; Ala15Glu; Ala15Phe;
 Ala15Gly; Ala15His; Ala15Ile; Ala15Lys; Ala15Leu;
 Ala15Met; Ala15Asn; Ala15Pro; Ala15Gln; Ala15Arg;
 Ala15Ser; Ala15Thr; Ala15Val; Ala15Trp; Ala15Tyr;
 Lys16Ala; Lys16Cys; Lys16Asp; Lys16Glu; Lys16Phe;
 Lys16Gly; Lys16His; Lys16Ile; Lys16Leu; Lys16Met;
 Lys16Asn; Lys16Pro; Lys16Gln; Lys16Arg; Lys16Ser;
 Lys16Thr; Lys16Val; Lys16Trp; Lys16Tyr; Leu17Ala;
 Leu17Cys; Leu17Asp; Leu17Glu; Leu17Phe; Leu17Gly;
 Leu17His; Leu17Ile; Leu17Lys; Leu17Met; Leu17Asn;
 Leu17Pro; Leu17Gln; Leu17Arg; Leu17Ser; Leu17Thr;
 Leu17Val; Leu17Trp; Leu17Tyr; Gly18Ala; Gly18Cys;
 Gly18Asp; Gly18Glu; Gly18Phe; Gly18His; Gly18Ile;
 Gly18Lys; Gly18Leu; Gly18Met; Gly18Asn; Gly18Pro;
 Gly18Gln; Gly18Arg; Gly18Ser; Gly18Thr; Gly18Val;
 Gly18Trp; Gly18Tyr; Ile19Ala; Ile19Cys; Ile19Asp;
 Ile19Glu; Ile19Phe; Ile19Gly; Ile19His; Ile19Lys; Ile19Leu;
 Ile19Met; Ile19Asn; Ile19Pro; Ile19Gln; Ile19Arg; Ile19Ser;
 Ile19Thr; Ile19Val; Ile19Trp; Ile19Tyr; Phe20Ala;
 Phe20Cys; Phe20Asp; Phe20Glu; Phe20Gly; Phe20His;
 Phe20Ile; Phe20Lys; Phe20Leu; Phe20Met; Phe20Asn;
 Phe20Pro; Phe20Gln; Phe20Arg; Phe20Ser; Phe20Thr;
 Phe20Val; Phe20Trp; Phe20Tyr; Ala21Cys; Ala21Asp;
 Ala21Glu; Ala21Phe; Ala21Gly; Ala21His; Ala21Ile;
 Ala21Lys; Ala21Leu; Ala21Met; Ala21Asn; Ala21Pro;
 Ala21Gln; Ala21Arg; Ala21Ser; Ala21Thr; Ala21Val;
 Ala21Trp; Ala21Tyr; Leu22Ala; Leu22Cys; Leu22Asp;
 Leu22Glu; Leu22Phe; Leu22Gly; Leu22His; Leu22Ile;
 Leu22Lys; Leu22Met; Leu22Asn; Leu22Pro; Leu22Gln;
 Leu22Arg; Leu22Ser; Leu22Thr; Leu22Val; Leu22Trp;
 Leu22Tyr; Asp23Ala; Asp23Cys; Asp23Glu; Asp23Phe;
 Asp23Gly; Asp23His; Asp23Ile; Asp23Lys; Asp23Leu;
 Asp23Met; Asp23Asn; Asp23Pro; Asp23Gln; Asp23Arg;
 Asp23Ser; Asp23Thr; Asp23Val; Asp23Trp; Asp23Tyr;
 Thr24Ala; Thr24Cys; Thr24Asp; Thr24Glu; Thr24Phe;
 Thr24Gly; Thr24His; Thr24Ile; Thr24Lys; Thr24Leu;

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Thr24Met; Thr24Asn; Thr24Pro; Thr24Gln; Thr24Arg;
 Thr24Ser; Thr24Val; Thr24Trp; Thr24Tyr; Gly25Ala;
 Gly25Cys; Gly25Asp; Gly25Glu; Gly25Phe; Gly25His;
 Gly25Ile; Gly25Lys; Gly25Leu; Gly25Met; Gly25Asn;
 Gly25Pro; Gly25Gln; Gly25Arg; Gly25Ser; Gly25Thr;
 Gly25Val; Gly25Trp; Gly25Tyr; Thr26Ala; Thr26Cys;
 Thr26Asp; Thr26Glu; Thr26Phe; Thr26Gly; Thr26His;
 Thr26Ile; Thr26Lys; Thr26Leu; Thr26Met; Thr26Asn;
 Thr26Pro; Thr26Gln; Thr26Arg; Thr26Ser; Thr26Val;
 Thr26Trp; Thr26Tyr; Asn27Ala; Asn27Cys; Asn27Asp;
 Asn27Glu; Asn27Phe; Asn27Gly; Asn27His; Asn27Ile;
 Asn27Lys; Asn27Leu; Asn27Met; Asn27Pro; Asn27Gln;
 Asn27Arg; Asn27Ser; Asn27Thr; Asn27Val; Asn27Trp;
 Asn27Tyr; Arg28Ala; Arg28Cys; Arg28Asp; Arg28Glu;
 Arg28Phe; Arg28Gly; Arg28His; Arg28Ile; Arg28Lys;
 Arg28Leu; Arg28Met; Arg28Asn; Arg28Pro; Arg28Gln;
 Arg28Ser; Arg28Thr; Arg28Val; Arg28Trp; Arg28Tyr;
 Thr29Ala; Thr29Cys; Thr29Asp; Thr29Glu; Thr29Phe;
 Thr29Gly; Thr29His; Thr29Ile; Thr29Lys; Thr29Leu;
 Thr29Met; Thr29Asn; Thr29Pro; Thr29Gln; Thr29Arg;
 Thr29Ser; Thr29Val; Thr29Trp; Thr29Tyr; Val30Ala;
 Val30Cys; Val30Asp; Val30Glu; Val30Phe; Val30Gly;
 Val30His; Val30Ile; Val30Lys; Val30Leu; Val30Met;
 Val30Asn; Val30Pro; Val30Gln; Val30Arg; Val30Ser;
 Val30Thr; Val30Trp; Val30Tyr; Ala31Ala; Ala31Cys;
 Ala31Asp; Ala31Glu; Ala31Phe; Ala31Gly; Ala31His;
 Ala31Ile; Ala31Lys; Ala31Leu; Ala31Met; Ala31Asn;
 Ala31Pro; Ala31Gln; Ala31Arg; Ala31Ser; Ala31Thr;
 Ala31Val; Ala31Trp; Ala31Tyr; Tyr32Ala; Tyr32Cys;
 Tyr32Asp; Tyr32Glu; Tyr32Phe; Tyr32Gly; Tyr32His;
 Tyr32Ile; Tyr32Lys; Tyr32Leu; Tyr32Met; Tyr32Asn;
 Tyr32Pro; Tyr32Gln; Tyr32Arg; Tyr32Ser; Tyr32Thr;
 Tyr32Val; Tyr32Trp; Arg33Ala; Arg33Cys; Arg33Asp;
 Arg33Glu; Arg33Phe; Arg33Gly; Arg33His; Arg33Ile;
 Arg33Lys; Arg33Leu; Arg33Met; Arg33Asn; Arg33Pro;
 Arg33Gln; Arg33Ser; Arg33Thr; Arg33Val; Arg33Trp;
 Arg33Tyr; Pro34Ala; Pro34Cys; Pro34Asp; Pro34Glu;
 Pro34Phe; Pro34Gly; Pro34His; Pro34Ile; Pro34Lys;
 Pro34Leu; Pro34Met; Pro34Asn; Pro34Gln; Pro34Arg;
 Pro34Ser; Pro34Thr; Pro34Val; Pro34Trp; Pro34Tyr;
 Asp35Ala; Asp35Cys; Asp35Glu; Asp35Phe; Asp35Gly;
 Asp35His; Asp35Ile; Asp35Lys; Asp35Leu; Asp35Met;
 Asp35Asn; Asp35Pro; Asp35Gln; Asp35Arg; Asp35Ser;
 Asp35Thr; Asp35Val; Asp35Trp; Asp35Tyr; Glu36Ala;
 Glu36Cys; Glu36Asp; Glu36Phe; Glu36Gly; Glu36His;
 Glu36Ile; Glu36Lys; Glu36Leu; Glu36Met; Glu36Asn;
 Glu36Pro; Glu36Gln; Glu36Arg; Glu36Ser; Glu36Thr;
 Glu36Val; Glu36Trp; Glu36Tyr; Arg37Ala; Arg37Cys;
 Arg37Asp; Arg37Glu; Arg37Phe; Arg37Gly; Arg37His;
 Arg37Ile; Arg37Lys; Arg37Leu; Arg37Met; Arg37Asn;
 Arg37Pro; Arg37Gln; Arg37Ser; Arg37Thr; Arg37Val;
 Arg37Trp; Arg37Tyr; Phe38Ala; Phe38Cys; Phe38Asp;
 Phe38Glu; Phe38Gly; Phe38His; Phe38Ile; Phe38Lys;
 Phe38Leu; Phe38Met; Phe38Asn; Phe38Pro; Phe38Gln;
 Phe38Arg; Phe38Ser; Phe38Thr; Phe38Val; Phe38Trp;
 Phe38Tyr; Ala39Cys; Ala39Asp; Ala39Glu; Ala39Phe;
 Ala39Gly; Ala39His; Ala39Ile; Ala39Lys; Ala39Leu;
 Ala39Met; Ala39Asn; Ala39Pro; Ala39Gln; Ala39Arg;
 Ala39Ser; Ala39Thr; Ala39Val; Ala39Trp; Ala39Tyr;
 Phe40Ala; Phe40Cys; Phe40Asp; Phe40Glu; Phe40Gly;
 Phe40His; Phe40Ile; Phe40Lys; Phe40Leu; Phe40Met;
 Phe40Asn; Phe40Pro; Phe40Gln; Phe40Arg; Phe40Ser;
 Phe40Thr; Phe40Val; Phe40Trp; Phe40Tyr; Ala41Cys;
 Ala41Asp; Ala41Glu; Ala41Phe; Ala41Gly; Ala41His;
 Ala41Ile; Ala41Lys; Ala41Leu; Ala41Met; Ala41Asn;
 Ala41Pro; Ala41Gln; Ala41Arg; Ala41Ser; Ala41Thr;
 Ala41Val; Ala41Trp; Ala41Tyr; Ser42Ala; Ser42Cys;

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Ser42Asp; Ser42Glu; Ser42Phe; Ser42Gly; Ser42His;
 Ser42Ile; Ser42Lys; Ser42Leu; Ser42Met; Ser42Asn;
 Ser42Pro; Ser42Gln; Ser42Arg; Ser42Thr; Ser42Val;
 Ser42Trp; Ser42Tyr; Thr43Ala; Thr43Cys; Thr43Asp;
 Thr43Glu; Thr43Phe; Thr43Gly; Thr43His; Thr43Ile;
 Thr43Lys; Thr43Leu; Thr43Met; Thr43Asn; Thr43Pro;
 Thr43Gln; Thr43Arg; Thr43Ser; Thr43Val; Thr43Trp;
 Thr43Tyr; Ile44Ala; Ile44Cys; Ile44Asp; Ile44Glu;
 Ile44Phe; Ile44Gly; Ile44His; Ile44Lys; Ile44Leu; Ile44Met;
 Ile44Asn; Ile44Pro; Ile44Gln; Ile44Arg; Ile44Ser; Ile44Thr;
 Ile44Val; Ile44Trp; Ile44Tyr; Lys45Ala; Lys45Cys;
 Lys45Asp; Lys45Glu; Lys45Phe; Lys45Gly; Lys45His;
 Lys45Ile; Lys45Leu; Lys45Met; Lys45Asn; Lys45Pro;
 Lys45Gln; Lys45Arg; Lys45Ser; Lys45Thr; Lys45Val;
 Lys45Trp; Lys45Tyr; Ala46Cys; Ala46Asp; Ala46Glu;
 Ala46Phe; Ala46Gly; Ala46His; Ala46Ile; Ala46Lys;
 Ala46Leu; Ala46Met; Ala46Asn; Ala46Pro; Ala46Gln;
 Ala46Arg; Ala46Ser; Ala46Thr; Ala46Val; Ala46Trp;
 Ala46Tyr; Leu47Ala; Leu47Cys; Leu47Asp; Leu47Glu;
 Leu47Phe; Leu47Gly; Leu47His; Leu47Ile; Leu47Lys;
 Leu47Met; Leu47Asn; Leu47Pro; Leu47Gln; Leu47Arg;
 Leu47Ser; Leu47Thr; Leu47Val; Leu47Trp; Leu47Tyr;
 Thr48Ala; Thr48Cys; Thr48Asp; Thr48Glu; Thr48Phe;
 Thr48Gly; Thr48His; Thr48Ile; Thr48Lys; Thr48Leu;
 Thr48Met; Thr48Asn; Thr48Pro; Thr48Gln; Thr48Arg;
 Thr48Ser; Thr48Val; Thr48Trp; Thr48Tyr; Val49Ala;
 Val49Cys; Val49Asp; Val49Glu; Val49Phe; Val49Gly;
 Val49His; Val49Ile; Val49Lys; Val49Leu; Val49Met;
 Val49Asn; Val49Pro; Val49Gln; Val49Arg; Val49Ser;
 Val49Thr; Val49Trp; Val49Tyr; Gly50Ala; Gly50Cys;
 Gly50Asp; Gly50Glu; Gly50Phe; Gly50His; Gly50Ile;
 Gly50Lys; Gly50Leu; Gly50Met; Gly50Asn; Gly50Pro;
 Gly50Gln; Gly50Arg; Gly50Ser; Gly50Thr; Gly50Val;
 Gly50Trp; Gly50Tyr; Val51Ala; Val51Cys; Val51Asp;
 Val51Glu; Val51Phe; Val51Gly; Val51His; Val51Ile;
 Val51Lys; Val51Leu; Val51Met; Val51Asn; Val51Pro;
 Val51Gln; Val51Arg; Val51Ser; Val51Thr; Val51Trp;
 Val51Tyr; Leu52Ala; Leu52Cys; Leu52Asp; Leu52Glu;
 Leu52Phe; Leu52Gly; Leu52His; Leu52Ile; Leu52Lys;
 Leu52Met; Leu52Asn; Leu52Pro; Leu52Gln; Leu52Arg;
 Leu52Ser; Leu52Thr; Leu52Val; Leu52Trp; Leu52Tyr;
 Leu53Ala; Leu53Cys; Leu53Asp; Leu53Glu; Leu53Phe;
 Leu53Gly; Leu53His; Leu53Ile; Leu53Lys; Leu53Met;
 Leu53Asn; Leu53Pro; Leu53Gln; Leu53Arg; Leu53Ser;
 Leu53Thr; Leu53Val; Leu53Trp; Leu53Tyr; Gln54Ala;
 Gln54Cys; Gln54Asp; Gln54Glu; Gln54Phe; Gln54Gly;
 Gln54His; Gln54Ile; Gln54Lys; Gln54Leu; Gln54Met;
 Gln54Asn; Gln54Pro; Gln54Arg; Gln54Ser; Gln54Thr;
 Gln54Val; Gln54Trp; Gln54Tyr; Gln55Ala; Gln55Cys;
 Gln55Asp; Gln55Glu; Gln55Phe; Gln55Gly; Gln55His;
 Gln55Ile; Gln55Lys; Gln55Leu; Gln55Met; Gln55Asn;
 Gln55Pro; Gln55Arg; Gln55Ser; Gln55Thr; Gln55Val;
 Gln55Trp; Gln55Tyr; Lys56Ala; Lys56Cys; Lys56Asp;
 Lys56Glu; Lys56Phe; Lys56Gly; Lys56His; Lys56Ile;
 Lys56Leu; Lys56Met; Lys56Asn; Lys56Pro; Lys56Gln;
 Lys56Arg; Lys56Ser; Lys56Thr; Lys56Val; Lys56Trp;
 Lys56Tyr; Ser57Ala; Ser57Cys; Ser57Asp; Ser57Lys;
 Ser57Phe; Ser57Gly; Ser57His; Ser57Ile; Ser57Glu;
 Ser57Leu; Ser57Met; Ser57Asn; Ser57Pro; Ser57Gln;
 Ser57Arg; Ser57Thr; Ser57Val; Ser57Trp; Ser57Tyr;
 Ile58Ala; Ile58Cys; Ile58Asp; Ile58Glu; Ile58Phe; Ile58Gly;
 Ile58His; Ile58Lys; Ile58Leu; Ile58Met; Ile58Asn; Ile58Pro;
 Ile58Gln; Ile58Arg; Ile58Ser; Ile58Thr; Ile58Val; Ile58Trp;
 Ile58Tyr; Glu59Ala; Glu59Cys; Glu59Asp; Glu59Phe;
 Glu59Gly; Glu59His; Glu59Ile; Glu59Lys; Glu59Leu;
 Glu59Met; Glu59Asn; Glu59Pro; Glu59Gln; Glu59Arg;
 Glu59Ser; Glu59Thr; Glu59Val; Glu59Trp; Glu59Tyr;

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Asp60Ala; Asp60Cys; Asp60Glu; Asp60Phe; Asp60Gly;
 Asp60His; Asp60Ile; Asp60Lys; Asp60Leu; Asp60Met;
 Asp60Asn; Asp60Pro; Asp60Gln; Asp60Arg; Asp60Ser;
 Asp60Thr; Asp60Val; Asp60Trp; Asp60Tyr; Leu61Ala;
 Leu61Cys; Leu61Asp; Leu61Glu; Leu61Phe; Leu61Gly;
 Leu61His; Leu61Ile; Leu61Lys; Leu61Met; Leu61Asn;
 Leu61Pro; Leu61Gln; Leu61Arg; Leu61Ser; Leu61Thr;
 Leu61Val; Leu61Trp; Leu61Tyr; Asn62Ala; Asn62Cys;
 Asn62Asp; Asn62Glu; Asn62Phe; Asn62Gly; Asn62His;
 Asn62Ile; Asn62Lys; Asn62Leu; Asn62Met; Asn62Pro;
 Asn62Gln; Asn62Arg; Asn62Ser; Asn62Thr; Asn62Val;
 Asn62Trp; Asn62Tyr; Gln63Ala; Gln63Cys; Gln63Asp;
 Gln63Glu; Gln63Phe; Gln63Gly; Gln63His; Gln63Ile;
 Gln63Lys; Gln63Leu; Gln63Met; Gln63Asn; Gln63Pro;
 Gln63Arg; Gln63Ser; Gln63Thr; Gln63Val; Gln63Trp;
 Arg64Ala; Arg64Cys; Arg64Asp; Arg64Glu;
 Arg64Phe; Arg64Gly; Arg64His; Arg64Ile; Arg64Lys;
 Arg64Leu; Arg64Met; Arg64Asn; Arg64Pro; Arg64Gln;
 Arg64Ser; Arg64Thr; Arg64Val; Arg64Trp; Arg64Tyr;
 Ile65Ala; Ile65Cys; Ile65Asp; Ile65Glu; Ile65Phe; Ile65Gly;
 Ile65His; Ile65Lys; Ile65Leu; Ile65Met; Ile65Asn; Ile65Pro;
 Ile65Gln; Ile65Arg; Ile65Ser; Ile65Thr; Ile65Val; Ile65Trp;
 Ile65Tyr; Thr66Ala; Thr66Cys; Thr66Asp; Thr66Glu;
 Thr66Phe; Thr66Gly; Thr66His; Thr66Ile; Thr66Lys;
 Thr66Leu; Thr66Met; Thr66Asn; Thr66Pro; Thr66Gln;
 Thr66Arg; Thr66Ser; Thr66Val; Thr66Trp; Thr66Tyr;
 Tyr67Ala; Tyr67Cys; Tyr67Asp; Tyr67Glu; Tyr67Phe;
 Tyr67Gly; Tyr67His; Tyr67Ile; Tyr67Lys; Tyr67Leu;
 Tyr67Met; Tyr67Asn; Tyr67Pro; Tyr67Gln; Tyr67Arg;
 Tyr67Ser; Tyr67Thr; Tyr67Val; Tyr67Trp; Thr68Ala;
 Thr68Cys; Thr68Asp; Thr68Glu; Thr68Phe; Thr68Gly;
 Thr68His; Thr68Ile; Thr68Lys; Thr68Leu; Thr68Met;
 Thr68Asn; Thr68Pro; Thr68Gln; Thr68Arg; Thr68Ser;
 Thr68Val; Thr68Trp; Thr68Tyr; Arg69Ala; Arg69Cys;
 Arg69Asp; Arg69Glu; Arg69Phe; Arg69Gly; Arg69His;
 Arg69Ile; Arg69Lys; Arg69Leu; Arg69Met; Arg69Asn;
 Arg69Pro; Arg69Gln; Arg69Ser; Arg69Thr; Arg69Val;
 Arg69Trp; Arg69Tyr; Asp70Ala; Asp70Cys; Asp70Glu;
 Asp70Phe; Asp70Gly; Asp70His; Asp70Ile; Asp70Lys;
 Asp70Leu; Asp70Met; Asp70Asn; Asp70Pro; Asp70Gln;
 Asp70Arg; Asp70Ser; Asp70Thr; Asp70Val; Asp70Trp;
 Asp70Tyr; Asp71Ala; Asp71Cys; Asp71Glu; Asp71Phe;
 Asp71Gly; Asp71His; Asp71Ile; Asp71Lys; Asp71Leu;
 Asp71Met; Asp71Asn; Asp71Pro; Asp71Gln; Asp71Arg;
 Asp71Ser; Asp71Thr; Asp71Val; Asp71Trp; Asp71Tyr;
 Leu72Ala; Leu72Cys; Leu72Asp; Leu72Glu; Leu72Phe;
 Leu72Gly; Leu72His; Leu72Ile; Leu72Lys; Leu72Met;
 Leu72Asn; Leu72Pro; Leu72Gln; Leu72Arg; Leu72Ser;
 Leu72Thr; Leu72Val; Leu72Trp; Leu72Tyr; Val73Ala;
 Val73Cys; Val73Asp; Val73Glu; Val73Phe; Val73Gly;
 Val73His; Val73Ile; Val73Lys; Val73Leu; Val73Met;
 Val73Asn; Val73Pro; Val73Gln; Val73Arg; Val73Ser;
 Val73Thr; Val73Trp; Val73Tyr; Asn74Ala; Asn74Cys;
 Asn74Asp; Asn74Glu; Asn74Phe; Asn74Gly; Asn74His;
 Asn74Ile; Asn74Lys; Asn74Leu; Asn74Met; Asn74Pro;
 Asn74Gln; Asn74Arg; Asn74Ser; Asn74Thr; Asn74Val;
 Asn74Trp; Asn74Tyr; Tyr75Ala; Tyr75Cys; Tyr75Asp;
 Tyr75Glu; Tyr75Phe; Tyr75Gly; Tyr75His; Tyr75Ile;
 Tyr75Lys; Tyr75Leu; Tyr75Met; Tyr75Asn; Tyr75Pro;
 Tyr75Gln; Tyr75Arg; Tyr75Ser; Tyr75Thr; Tyr75Val;
 Tyr75Trp; Asn76Ala; Asn76Cys; Asn76Asp; Asn76Glu;
 Asn76Phe; Asn76Gly; Asn76His; Asn76Ile; Asn76Lys;
 Asn76Leu; Asn76Met; Asn76Pro; Asn76Gln; Asn76Arg;
 Asn76Ser; Asn76Thr; Asn76Val; Asn76Trp; Asn76Tyr;
 Pro77Ala; Pro77Cys; Pro77Asp; Pro77Glu; Pro77Phe;
 Pro77Gly; Pro77His; Pro77Ile; Pro77Lys; Pro77Leu;
 Pro77Met; Pro77Asn; Pro77Gln; Pro77Arg; Pro77Ser;

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Pro77Thr; Pro77Val; Pro77Trp; Pro77Tyr; Ile78Ala; Ile78Cys; Ile78Asp; Ile78Glu; Ile78Phe; Ile78Gly; Ile78His; Ile78Lys; Ile78Leu; Ile78Met; Ile78Asn; Ile78Pro; Ile78Gln; Ile78Arg; Ile78Ser; Ile78Thr; Ile78Val; Ile78Trp; Ile78Tyr; Thr79Ala; Thr79Cys; Thr79Asp; Thr79Glu; Thr79Phe; Thr79Gly; Thr79His; Thr79Ile; Thr79Lys; Thr79Leu; Thr79Met; Thr79Asn; Thr79Pro; Thr79Gln; Thr79Arg; Thr79Ser; Thr79Val; Thr79Trp; Thr79Tyr; Glu80Ala; Glu80Cys; Glu80Asp; Glu80Phe; Glu80Gly; Glu80His; Glu80Ile; Glu80Lys; Glu80Leu; Glu80Met; Glu80Asn; Glu80Pro; Glu80Gln; Glu80Arg; Glu80Ser; Glu80Thr; Glu80Val; Glu80Trp; Glu80Tyr; Lys81Ala; Lys81Cys; Lys81Asp; Lys81Glu; Lys81Phe; Lys81Gly; Lys81His; Lys81Ile; Lys81Leu; Lys81Met; Lys81Asn; Lys81Pro; Lys81Gln; Lys81Arg; Lys81Ser; Lys81Thr; Lys81Val; Lys81Trp; Lys81Tyr; His82Ala; His82Cys; His82Glu; His82Phe; His82Gly; His82Ile; His82Leu; His82Met; His82Asn; His82Pro; His82Gln; His82Arg; His82Ser; His82Thr; His82Val; His82Trp; His82Tyr; Val83Ala; Val83Cys; Val83Asp; Val83Glu; Val83Phe; Val83Gly; Val83His; Val83Ile; Val83Lys; Val83Leu; Val83Met; Val83Asn; Val83Pro; Val83Gln; Val83Arg; Val83Ser; Val83Thr; Val83Trp; Val83Tyr; Asp84Ala; Asp84Cys; Asp84Glu; Asp84Phe; Asp84Gly; Asp84His; Asp84Ile; Asp84Lys; Asp84Leu; Asp84Met; Asp84Asn; Asp84Pro; Asp84Gln; Asp84Arg; Asp84Ser; Asp84Thr; Asp84Val; Asp84Trp; Asp84Tyr; Thr85Ala; Thr85Cys; Thr85Asp; Thr85Glu; Thr85Phe; Thr85Gly; Thr85His; Thr85Ile; Thr85Lys; Thr85Leu; Thr85Met; Thr85Asn; Thr85Pro; Thr85Gln; Thr85Arg; Thr85Ser; Thr85Val; Thr85Trp; Thr85Tyr; Gly86Ala; Gly86Cys; Gly86Asp; Gly86Glu; Gly86Phe; Gly86His; Gly86Ile; Gly86Lys; Gly86Leu; Gly86Met; Gly86Asn; Gly86Pro; Gly86Gln; Gly86Arg; Gly86Ser; Gly86Thr; Gly86Val; Gly86Trp; Gly86Tyr; Met87Ala; Met87Cys; Met87Asp; Met87Glu; Met87Phe; Met87Gly; Met87His; Met87Ile; Met87Lys; Met87Leu; Met87Asn; Met87Pro; Met87Gln; Met87Arg; Met87Ser; Met87Thr; Met87Val; Met87Trp; Met87Tyr; Thr88Ala; Thr88Cys; Thr88Asp; Thr88Glu; Thr88Phe; Thr88Gly; Thr88His; Thr88Ile; Thr88Lys; Thr88Leu; Thr88Met; Thr88Asn; Thr88Pro; Thr88Gln; Thr88Arg; Thr88Ser; Thr88Val; Thr88Trp; Thr88Tyr; Leu89Ala; Leu89Cys; Leu89Asp; Leu89Glu; Leu89Phe; Leu89Gly; Leu89His; Leu89Ile; Leu89Lys; Leu89Met; Leu89Asn; Leu89Pro; Leu89Gln; Leu89Arg; Leu89Ser; Leu89Thr; Leu89Val; Leu89Tyr; Lys90Cys; Lys90Asp; Lys90Glu; Lys90Phe; Lys90Gly; Lys90His; Lys90Ile; Lys90Leu; Lys90Met; Lys90Asn; Lys90Pro; Lys90Gln; Lys90Arg; Lys90Ser; Lys90Thr; Lys90Val; Lys90Trp; Lys90Tyr; Glu91Ala; Glu91Cys; Glu91Asp; Glu91Phe; Glu91Gly; Glu91His; Glu91Ile; Glu91Lys; Glu91Leu; Glu91Met; Glu91Asn; Glu91Pro; Glu91Gln; Glu91Arg; Glu91Ser; Glu91Thr; Glu91Val; Glu91Trp; Glu91Tyr; Leu92Ala; Leu92Cys; Leu92Asp; Leu92Glu; Leu92Phe; Leu92Gly; Leu92His; Leu92Ile; Leu92Lys; Leu92Met; Leu92Asn; Leu92Pro; Leu92Gln; Leu92Arg; Leu92Ser; Leu92Thr; Leu92Val; Leu92Trp; Leu92Tyr; Ala93Cys; Ala93Asp; Ala93Glu; Ala93Phe; Ala93Gly; Ala93His; Ala93Ile; Ala93Lys; Ala93Leu; Ala93Met; Ala93Asn; Ala93Pro; Ala93Gln; Ala93Arg; Ala93Ser; Ala93Thr; Ala93Val; Ala93Trp; Ala93Tyr; Asp94Ala; Asp94Cys; Asp94Glu; Asp94Phe; Asp94Gly; Asp94His; Asp94Ile; Asp94Lys; Asp94Leu; Asp94Met; Asp94Asn; Asp94Pro; Asp94Gln; Asp94Arg; Asp94Ser; Asp94Thr; Asp94Val; Asp94Trp; Asp94Tyr; Ala95Cys; Ala95Asp; Ala95Glu; Ala95Phe; Ala95Gly; Ala95His; Ala95Ile; Ala95Lys; Ala95Leu; Ala95Met; Ala95Asn;

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Ala95Pro; Ala95Gln; Ala95Arg; Ala95Ser; Ala95Thr; Ala95Val; Ala95Trp; Ala95Tyr; Ser96Ala; Ser96Cys; Ser96Asp; Ser96Glu; Ser96Phe; Ser96Gly; Ser96His; Ser96Ile; Ser96Lys; Ser96Leu; Ser96Met; Ser96Asn; Ser96Pro; Ser96Gln; Ser96Arg; Ser96Thr; Ser96Val; Ser96Trp; Ser96Tyr; Leu97Ala; Leu97Cys; Leu97Asp; Leu97Glu; Leu97Phe; Leu97Gly; Leu97His; Leu97Ile; Leu97Lys; Leu97Met; Leu97Asn; Leu97Pro; Leu97Gln; Leu97Arg; Leu97Ser; Leu97Thr; Leu97Val; Leu97Trp; Leu97Tyr; Arg98Ala; Arg98Cys; Arg98Glu; Arg98Phe; Arg98Gly; Arg98His; Arg98Ile; Arg98Lys; Arg98Leu; Arg98Met; Arg98Asn; Arg98Pro; Arg98Gln; Arg98Ser; Arg98Thr; Arg98Val; Arg98Trp; Arg98Tyr; Tyr99Ala; Tyr99Cys; Tyr99Asp; Tyr99Glu; Tyr99Phe; Tyr99Gly; Tyr99His; Tyr99Ile; Tyr99Lys; Tyr99Leu; Tyr99Met; Tyr99Asn; Tyr99Pro; Tyr99Gln; Tyr99Arg; Tyr99Ser; Tyr99Thr; Tyr99Val; Tyr99Trp; Ser100Ala; Ser100Cys; Ser100Asp; Ser100Glu; Ser100Phe; Ser100Gly; Ser100His; Ser100Ile; Ser100Lys; Ser100Leu; Ser100Met; Ser100Asn; Ser100Pro; Ser100Gln; Ser100Arg; Ser100Thr; Ser100Val; Ser100Trp; Ser100Tyr; Asp101Ala; Asp101Cys; Asp101Glu; Asp101Phe; Asp101Gly; Asp101His; Asp101Ile; Asp101Lys; Asp101Leu; Asp101Met; Asp101Asn; Asp101Pro; Asp101Gln; Asp101Arg; Asp101Ser; Asp101Thr; Asp101Val; Asp101Trp; Asp101Tyr; Asn102Ala; Asn102Cys; Asn102Asp; Asn102Glu; Asn102Phe; Asn102Gly; Asn102His; Asn102Ile; Asn102Lys; Asn102Leu; Asn102Met; Asn102Pro; Asn102Gln; Asn102Arg; Asn102Ser; Asn102Thr; Asn102Val; Asn102Trp; Asn102Tyr; Ala103Cys; Ala103Asp; Ala103Glu; Ala103Phe; Ala103Gly; Ala103His; Ala103Ile; Ala103Lys; Ala103Leu; Ala103Met; Ala103Asn; Ala103Pro; Ala103Gln; Ala103Arg; Ala103Ser; Ala103Thr; Ala103Val; Ala103Trp; Ala103Tyr; Ala104Cys; Ala104Asp; Ala104Glu; Ala104Phe; Ala104Gly; Ala104His; Ala104Ile; Ala104Lys; Ala104Leu; Ala104Met; Ala104Asn; Ala104Pro; Ala104Gln; Ala104Arg; Ala104Ser; Ala104Thr; Ala104Val; Ala104Trp; Ala104Tyr; Gln105Ala; Gln105Cys; Gln105Asp; Gln105Glu; Gln105Phe; Gln105Gly; Gln105His; Gln105Ile; Gln105Lys; Gln105Leu; Gln105Met; Gln105Asn; Gln105Pro; Gln105Arg; Gln105Ser; Gln105Thr; Gln105Val; Gln105Trp; Gln105Tyr; Asn106Ala; Asn106Cys; Asn106Asp; Asn106Glu; Asn106Phe; Asn106Gly; Asn106His; Asn106Ile; Asn106Lys; Asn106Leu; Asn106Met; Asn106Pro; Asn106Gln; Asn106Arg; Asn106Ser; Asn106Thr; Asn106Val; Asn106Trp; Asn106Tyr; Leu107Ala; Leu107Cys; Leu107Asp; Leu107Glu; Leu107Phe; Leu107Gly; Leu107His; Leu107Ile; Leu107Lys; Leu107Met; Leu107Asn; Leu107Pro; Leu107Gln; Leu107Arg; Leu107Ser; Leu107Thr; Leu107Val; Leu107Trp; Leu107Tyr; Ile108Ala; Ile108Cys; Ile108Asp; Ile108Glu; Ile108Phe; Ile108Gly; Ile108His; Ile108Lys; Ile108Leu; Ile108Met; Ile108Asn; Ile108Pro; Ile108Gln; Ile108Arg; Ile108Ser; Ile108Thr; Ile108Val; Ile108Trp; Ile108Tyr; Leu109Ala; Leu109Cys; Leu109Asp; Leu109Glu; Leu109Phe; Leu109Gly; Leu109His; Leu109Ile; Leu109Lys; Leu109Met; Leu109Asn; Leu109Pro; Leu109Gln; Leu109Arg; Leu109Ser; Leu109Thr; Leu109Val; Leu109Trp; Leu109Tyr; Lys110Ala; Lys110Cys; Lys110Asp; Lys110Glu; Lys110Phe; Lys110Gly; Lys110His; Lys110Ile; Lys110Leu; Lys110Met; Lys110Asn; Lys110Pro; Lys110Gln; Lys110Arg; Lys110Ser; Lys110Thr; Lys110Val; Lys110Trp; Lys110Tyr; Gln111Ala; Gln111Cys; Gln111Asp; Gln111Glu; Gln111Phe; Gln111Gly; Gln111His; Gln111Ile;

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Gln111Lys; Gln111Leu; Gln111Met; Gln111Asn;
 Gln111Pro; Gln111Arg; Gln111Ser; Gln111Thr;
 Gln111Val; Gln111Trp; Gln111Tyr; Ile112Ala; Ile112Cys;
 Ile112Asp; Ile112Glu; Ile112Phe; Ile112Gly; Ile112His;
 Ile112Lys; Ile112Leu; Ile112Met; Ile112Asn; Ile112Pro;
 Ile112Gln; Ile112Arg; Ile112Ser; Ile112Thr; Ile112Val;
 Ile112Trp; Ile112Tyr; Gly113Ala; Gly113Cys; Gly113Asp;
 Gly113Glu; Gly113Phe; Gly113His; Gly113Ile; Gly113Lys;
 Gly113Leu; Gly113Met; Gly113Asn; Gly113Pro;
 Gly113Gln; Gly113Arg; Gly113Ser; Gly113Thr;
 Gly113Val; Gly113Trp; Gly113Tyr; Gly114Ala;
 Gly114Cys; Gly114Asp; Gly114Glu; Gly114Phe;
 Gly114His; Gly114Ile; Gly114Lys; Gly114Leu;
 Gly114Met; Gly114Asn; Gly114Pro; Gly114Gln;
 Gly114Arg; Gly114Ser; Gly114Thr; Gly114Val;
 Gly114Trp; Gly114Tyr; Pro115A; Pro115Cys;
 Pro115Asp; Pro115Glu; Pro115Phe; Pro115Gly; Pro115His;
 Pro115Ile; Pro115Lys; Pro115Leu; Pro115Met; Pro115Asn;
 Pro115Gln; Pro115Arg; Pro115Ser; Pro115Thr; Pro115Val;
 Pro115Trp; Pro115Tyr; Glu116Ala; Glu116Cys;
 Glu116Asp; Glu116Phe; Glu116Gly; Glu116His;
 Glu116Ile; Glu116Lys; Glu116Leu; Glu116Met;
 Glu116Asn; Glu116Pro; Glu116Gln; Glu116Arg;
 Glu116Ser; Glu116Thr; Glu116Val; Glu116Trp; Glu116Tyr;
 Ser117Ala; Ser117Cys; Ser117Asp; Ser117Glu; Ser117Phe;
 Ser117Gly; Ser117His; Ser117Ile; Ser117Lys; Ser117Leu;
 Ser117Met; Ser117Asn; Ser117Pro; Ser117Gln; Ser117Arg;
 Ser117Thr; Ser117Val; Ser117Trp; Ser117Tyr; Leu118Ala;
 Leu118Cys; Leu118Asp; Leu118Glu; Leu118Phe;
 Leu118Gly; Leu118His; Leu118Ile; Leu118Lys;
 Leu118Met; Leu118Asn; Leu118Pro; Leu118Gln;
 Leu118Arg; Leu118Ser; Leu118Thr; Leu118Val;
 Leu118Trp; Leu118Tyr; Lys119Ala; Lys119Cys;
 Lys119Asp; Lys119Glu; Lys119Phe; Lys119Gly;
 Lys119His; Lys119Ile; Lys119Leu; Lys119Met; Lys119Asn;
 Lys119Pro; Lys119Gln; Lys119Arg; Lys119Ser; Lys119Thr;
 Lys119Val; Lys119Trp; Lys119Tyr; Lys120Ala; Lys120Cys;
 Lys120Asp; Lys120Glu; Lys120Phe; Lys120Gly;
 Lys120His; Lys120Ile; Lys120Leu; Lys120Met; Lys120Asn;
 Lys120Pro; Lys120Gln; Lys120Arg; Lys120Ser; Lys120Thr;
 Lys120Val; Lys120Trp; Lys120Tyr; Glu121Ala; Glu121Cys;
 Glu121Asp; Glu121Phe; Glu121Gly; Glu121His;
 Glu121Ile; Glu121Lys; Glu121Leu; Glu121Met;
 Glu121Asn; Glu121Pro; Glu121Gln; Glu121Arg;
 Glu121Ser; Glu121Thr; Glu121Val; Glu121Trp; Glu121Tyr;
 Leu122Ala; Leu122Cys; Leu122Asp; Leu122Glu;
 Leu122Phe; Leu122Gly; Leu122His; Leu122Ile;
 Leu122Lys; Leu122Met; Leu122Asn; Leu122Pro;
 Leu122Gln; Leu122Arg; Leu122Ser; Leu122Thr;
 Leu122Val; Leu122Trp; Leu122Tyr; Arg123Ala;
 Arg123Cys; Arg123Asp; Arg123Glu; Arg123Phe;
 Arg123Gly; Arg123His; Arg123Ile; Arg123Lys; Arg123Leu;
 Arg123Met; Arg123Asn; Arg123Pro; Arg123Gln;
 Arg123Ser; Arg123Thr; Arg123Val; Arg123Trp; Arg123Tyr;
 Lys124Ala; Lys124Cys; Lys124Asp; Lys124Glu;
 Lys124Phe; Lys124Gly; Lys124His; Lys124Ile; Lys124Leu;
 Lys124Met; Lys124Asn; Lys124Pro; Lys124Gln;
 Lys124Arg; Lys124Ser; Lys124Thr; Lys124Val; Lys124Trp;
 Lys124Tyr; Ile125Ala; Ile125Cys; Ile125Asp; Ile125Glu;
 Ile125Phe; Ile125Gly; Ile125His; Ile125Lys; Ile125Leu;
 Ile125Met; Ile125Asn; Ile125Pro; Ile125Gln; Ile125Arg;
 Ile125Ser; Ile125Thr; Ile125Val; Ile125Trp; Ile125Tyr;
 Gly126Ala; Gly126Cys; Gly126Asp; Gly126Glu;
 Gly126Phe; Gly126His; Gly126Ile; Gly126Lys; Gly126Leu;
 Gly126Met; Gly126Asn; Gly126Pro; Gly126Gln;
 Gly126Arg; Gly126Ser; Gly126Thr; Gly126Val;
 Gly126Trp; Gly126Tyr; Asp127Ala; Asp127Cys;

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Asp127Glu; Asp127Phe; Asp127Gly; Asp127His;
 Asp127Ile; Asp127Lys; Asp127Leu; Asp127Met;
 Asp127Asn; Asp127Pro; Asp127Gln; Asp127Arg;
 Asp127Ser; Asp127Thr; Asp127Val; Asp127Trp;
 5 Asp127Tyr; Glu128Ala; Glu128Cys; Glu128Asp;
 Glu128Phe; Glu128Gly; Glu128His; Glu128Ile; Glu128Lys;
 Glu128Leu; Glu128Met; Glu128Asn; Glu128Pro;
 Glu128Gln; Glu128Arg; Glu128Ser; Glu128Thr;
 Glu128Val; Glu128Trp; Glu128Tyr; Val129Ala; Val129Cys;
 10 Val129Asp; Val129Glu; Val129Phe; Val129Gly; Val129His;
 Val129Ile; Val129Lys; Val129Leu; Val129Met; Val129Asn;
 Val129Pro; Val129Gln; Val129Arg; Val129Ser; Val129Thr;
 Val129Trp; Val129Tyr; Thr130Ala; Thr130Cys; Thr130Asp;
 Thr130Glu; Thr130Phe; Thr130Gly; Thr130His; Thr130Ile;
 15 Thr130Lys; Thr130Leu; Thr130Met; Thr130Asn;
 Thr130Pro; Thr130Gln; Thr130Arg; Thr130Ser; Thr130Val;
 Thr130Trp; Thr130Tyr; Asn131Ala; Asn131Cys;
 Asn131Asp; Asn131Glu; Asn131Phe; Asn131Gly;
 Asn131His; Asn131Ile; Asn131Lys; Asn131Leu;
 20 Asn131Met; Asn131Pro; Asn131Gln; Asn131Arg;
 Asn131Ser; Asn131Thr; Asn131Val; Asn131Trp;
 Asn131Tyr; Pro132Ala; Pro132Cys; Pro132Asp;
 Pro132Glu; Pro132Phe; Pro132Gly; Pro132His; Pro132Ile;
 Pro132Lys; Pro132Leu; Pro132Met; Pro132Asn;
 25 Pro132Gln; Pro132Arg; Pro132Ser; Pro132Thr; Pro132Val;
 Pro132Trp; Pro132Tyr; Glu133Ala; Glu133Cys;
 Glu133Asp; Glu133Phe; Glu133Gly; Glu133His;
 Glu133Ile; Glu133Lys; Glu133Leu; Glu133Met;
 Glu133Asn; Glu133Pro; Glu133Gln; Glu133Arg;
 30 Glu133Ser; Glu133Thr; Glu133Val; Glu133Trp; Glu133Tyr;
 Arg134Ala; Arg134Cys; Arg134Asp; Arg134Glu;
 Arg134Phe; Arg134Gly; Arg134His; Arg134Ile; Arg134Lys;
 Arg134Leu; Arg134Met; Arg134Asn; Arg134Trp;
 Arg134Gln; Arg134Ser; Arg134Thr; Arg134Val; Arg134Trp;
 35 Arg134Tyr; Phe135Ala; Phe135Cys; Phe135Asp;
 Phe135Glu; Phe135Gly; Phe135His; Phe135Ile; Phe135Lys;
 Phe135Leu; Phe135Met; Phe135Asn; Phe135Pro;
 Phe135Gln; Phe135Arg; Phe135Ser; Phe135Thr;
 Phe135Val; Phe135Trp; Phe135Tyr; Glu136Ala;
 40 Glu136Cys; Glu136Asp; Glu136Phe; Glu136Gly;
 Glu136His; Glu136Ile; Glu136Lys; Glu136Leu;
 Glu136Met; Glu136Asn; Glu136Pro; Glu136Gln;
 Glu136Arg; Glu136Ser; Glu136Thr; Glu136Val;
 Glu136Trp; Glu136Tyr; Pro137Ala; Pro137Cys;
 45 Pro137Asp; Pro137Glu; Pro137Phe; Pro137Gly; Pro137His;
 Pro137Ile; Pro137Lys; Pro137Leu; Pro137Met; Pro137Asn;
 Pro137Gln; Pro137Arg; Pro137Ser; Pro137Thr; Pro137Val;
 Pro137Trp; Pro137Tyr; Glu138Ala; Glu138Cys;
 Glu138Asp; Glu138Phe; Glu138Gly; Glu138His;
 50 Glu138Ile; Glu138Lys; Glu138Leu; Glu138Met;
 Glu138Asn; Glu138Pro; Glu138Gln; Glu138Arg;
 Glu138Ser; Glu138Thr; Glu138Val; Glu138Trp; Glu138Tyr;
 Leu139Ala; Leu139Cys; Leu139Asp; Leu139Glu;
 Leu139Phe; Leu139Gly; Leu139His; Leu139Ile;
 55 Leu139Lys; Leu139Met; Leu139Asn; Leu139Pro;
 Leu139Gln; Leu139Arg; Leu139Ser; Leu139Thr;
 Leu139Val; Leu139Trp; Leu139Tyr; Asn140Ala;
 Asn140Cys; Asn140Asp; Asn140Glu; Asn140Phe;
 Asn140Gly; Asn140His; Asn140Ile; Asn140Lys;
 60 Asn140Leu; Asn140Met; Asn140Pro; Asn140Gln;
 Asn140Arg; Asn140Ser; Asn140Thr; Asn140Val;
 Asn140Trp; Asn140Tyr; Glu141Ala; Glu141Cys;
 Glu141Asp; Glu141Phe; Glu141Gly; Glu141His;
 Glu141Ile; Glu141Lys; Glu141Leu; Glu141Met;
 65 Glu141Asn; Glu141Pro; Glu141Gln; Glu141Arg;
 Glu141Ser; Glu141Thr; Glu141Val; Glu141Trp; Glu141Tyr;
 Val142Ala; Val142Cys; Val142Asp; Val142Glu; Val142Phe;

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Val142Gly; Val142His; Val142Ile; Val142Lys; Val142Leu;
 Val142Met; Val142Asn; Val142Pro; Val142Gln; Val142Arg;
 Val142Ser; Val142Thr; Val142Trp; Val142Tyr; Asn143Ala;
 Asn143Cys; Asn143Asp; Asn143Glu; Asn143Phe;
 Asn143Gly; Asn143His; Asn143Ile; Asn143Lys;
 Asn143Leu; Asn143Met; Asn143Pro; Asn143Gln;
 Asn143Arg; Asn143Ser; Asn143Thr; Asn143Val;
 Asn143Trp; Asn143Tyr; Pro144Ala; Pro144Cys;
 Pro144Asp; Pro144Glu; Pro144Phe; Pro144Gly; Pro144His;
 Pro144Ile; Pro144Lys; Pro144Leu; Pro144Met; Pro144Asn;
 Pro144Gln; Pro144Arg; Pro144Ser; Pro144Thr; Pro144Val;
 Pro144Trp; Pro144Tyr; Gly145Ala; Gly145Cys;
 Gly145Asp; Gly145Glu; Gly145Phe; Gly145His;
 Gly145Ile; Gly145Lys; Gly145Leu; Gly145Met;
 Gly145Asn; Gly145Pro; Gly145Gln; Gly145Arg;
 Gly145Ser; Gly145Thr; Gly145Val; Gly145Trp; Gly145Tyr;
 Glu146Ala; Glu146Cys; Glu146Asp; Glu146Phe;
 Glu146Gly; Glu146His; Glu146Ile; Glu146Lys; Glu146Leu;
 Glu146Met; Glu146Asn; Glu146Pro; Glu146Gln;
 Glu146Arg; Glu146Ser; Glu146Thr; Glu146Val;
 Glu146Trp; Glu146Tyr; Thr147Ala; Thr147Cys;
 Thr147Asp; Thr147Glu; Thr147Phe; Thr147Gly;
 Thr147His; Thr147Ile; Thr147Lys; Thr147Leu; Thr147Met;
 Thr147Asn; Thr147Pro; Thr147Gln; Thr147Arg;
 Thr147Ser; Thr147Val; Thr147Trp; Thr147Tyr; Gln148Ala;
 Gln148Cys; Gln148Asp; Gln148Glu; Gln148Phe;
 Gln148Gly; Gln148His; Gln148Ile; Gln148Lys; Gln148Leu;
 Gln148Met; Gln148Asn; Gln148Pro; Gln148Arg;
 Gln148Ser; Gln148Thr; Gln148Val; Gln148Trp; Gln148Tyr;
 Asp149Ala; Asp149Cys; Asp149Glu; Asp149Phe;
 Asp149Gly; Asp149His; Asp149Ile; Asp149Lys;
 Asp149Leu; Asp149Met; Asp149Asn; Asp149Pro;
 Asp149Gln; Asp149Arg; Asp149Ser; Asp149Thr;
 Asp149Val; Asp149Trp; Asp149Tyr; Thr150Ala;
 Thr150Cys; Thr150Asp; Thr150Glu; Thr150Phe;
 Thr150Gly; Thr150His; Thr150Ile; Thr150Lys; Thr150Leu;
 Thr150Met; Thr150Asn; Thr150Pro; Thr150Gln;
 Thr150Arg; Thr150Ser; Thr150Val; Thr150Trp; Thr150Tyr;
 Ser151Ala; Ser151Cys; Ser151Asp; Ser151Glu; Ser151Phe;
 Ser151Gly; Ser151His; Ser151Ile; Ser151Lys; Ser151Leu;
 Ser151Met; Ser151Asn; Ser151Pro; Ser151Gln; Ser151Arg;
 Ser151Thr; Ser151Val; Ser151Trp; Ser151Tyr; Thr152Ala;
 Thr152Cys; Thr152Asp; Thr152Glu; Thr152Phe;
 Thr152Gly; Thr152His; Thr152Ile; Thr152Lys; Thr152Leu;
 Thr152Met; Thr152Asn; Thr152Pro; Thr152Gln;
 Thr152Arg; Thr152Ser; Thr152Val; Thr152Trp; Thr152Tyr;
 Ala153Cys; Ala153Asp; Ala153Glu; Ala153Phe;
 Ala153Gly; Ala153His; Ala153Ile; Ala153Lys; Ala153Leu;
 Ala153Met; Ala153Asn; Ala153Pro; Ala153Gln;
 Ala153Arg; Ala153Ser; Ala153Thr; Ala153Val; Ala153Trp;
 Ala153Tyr; Arg154Ala; Arg154Cys; Arg154Asp;
 Arg154Glu; Arg154Phe; Arg154Gly; Arg154His; Arg154Ile;
 Arg154Lys; Arg154Leu; Arg154Met; Arg154Asn;
 Arg154Pro; Arg154Gln; Arg154Ser; Arg154Thr; Arg154Val;
 Arg154Trp; Arg154Tyr; Ala155Cys; Ala155Asp;
 Ala155Glu; Ala155Phe; Ala155Gly; Ala155His; Ala155Ile;
 Ala155Lys; Ala155Leu; Ala155Met; Ala155Asn;
 Ala155Pro; Ala155Gln; Ala155Arg; Ala155Ser; Ala155Thr;
 Ala155Val; Ala155Trp; Ala155Tyr; Leu156Ala; Leu156Cys;
 Leu156Asp; Leu156Glu; Leu156Phe; Leu156Gly;
 Leu156His; Leu156Ile; Leu156Lys; Leu156Met;
 Leu156Asn; Leu156Pro; Leu156Gln; Leu156Arg;
 Leu156Ser; Leu156Thr; Leu156Val; Leu156Trp;
 Leu156Tyr; Val157Ala; Val157Cys; Val157Asp; Val157Glu;
 Val157Phe; Val157Gly; Val157His; Val157Ile; Val157Lys;
 Val157Leu; Val157Met; Val157Asn; Val157Pro; Val157Gln;
 Val157Arg; Val157Ser; Val157Thr; Val157Trp; Val157Tyr;

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Thr158Ala; Thr158Cys; Thr158Asp; Thr158Glu;
 Thr158Phe; Thr158Gly; Thr158His; Thr158Ile; Thr158Lys;
 Thr158Leu; Thr158Met; Thr158Asn; Thr158Pro;
 Thr158Gln; Thr158Arg; Thr158Ser; Thr158Val; Thr158Trp;
 Thr158Tyr; Ser159Ala; Ser159Cys; Ser159Asp; Ser159Glu;
 Ser159Phe; Ser159Gly; Ser159His; Ser159Ile; Ser159Lys;
 Ser159Leu; Ser159Met; Ser159Asn; Ser159Pro; Ser159Gln;
 Ser159Arg; Ser159Thr; Ser159Val; Ser159Trp; Ser159Tyr;
 Leu160Ala; Leu160Cys; Leu160Asp; Leu160Glu;
 Leu160Phe; Leu160Gly; Leu160His; Leu160Ile;
 Leu160Lys; Leu160Met; Leu160Asn; Leu160Pro;
 Leu160Gln; Leu160Arg; Leu160Ser; Leu160Thr;
 Leu160Val; Leu160Trp; Leu160Tyr; Arg161Ala;
 Arg161Cys; Arg161Asp; Arg161Glu; Arg161Phe;
 Arg161Gly; Arg161His; Arg161Ile; Arg161Lys; Arg161Leu;
 Arg161Met; Arg161Asn; Arg161Pro; Arg161Gln;
 Arg161Ser; Arg161Thr; Arg161Val; Arg161Trp; Arg161Tyr;
 Ala162Cys; Ala162Asp; Ala162Glu; Ala162Phe;
 Ala162Gly; Ala162His; Ala162Ile; Ala162Lys; Ala162Leu;
 Ala162Met; Ala162Asn; Ala162Pro; Ala162Gln;
 Ala162Arg; Ala162Ser; Ala162Thr; Ala162Val; Ala162Trp;
 Ala162Tyr; Phe163Ala; Phe163Cys; Phe163Asp;
 Phe163Glu; Phe163Gly; Phe163His; Phe163Ile; Phe163Lys;
 Phe163Leu; Phe163Met; Phe163Asn; Phe163Pro;
 Phe163Gln; Phe163Arg; Phe163Ser; Phe163Thr;
 Phe163Val; Phe163Trp; Phe163Tyr; Ala164Cys;
 Ala164Asp; Ala164Glu; Ala164Phe; Ala164Gly; Ala164His;
 Ala164Ile; Ala164Lys; Ala164Leu; Ala164Met; Ala164Asn;
 Ala164Pro; Ala164Gln; Ala164Arg; Ala164Ser; Ala164Thr;
 Ala164Val; Ala164Trp; Ala164Tyr; Leu165Ala; Leu165Cys;
 Leu165Asp; Leu165Glu; Leu165Phe; Leu165Gly;
 Leu165His; Leu165Ile; Leu165Lys; Leu165Met;
 Leu165Asn; Leu165Pro; Leu165Gln; Leu165Arg;
 Leu165Ser; Leu165Thr; Leu165Val; Leu165Tyr;
 Glu166Ala; Glu166Cys; Glu166Asp;
 Glu166Phe; Glu166Gly; Glu166His; Glu166Ile; Glu166Lys;
 Glu166Leu; Glu166Met; Glu166Asn; Glu166Pro;
 Glu166Gln; Glu166Arg; Glu166Ser; Glu166Thr;
 Glu166Val; Glu166Trp; Glu166Tyr; Asp167Ala;
 Asp167Cys; Asp167Glu; Asp167Phe; Asp167Gly;
 Asp167His; Asp167Ile; Asp167Lys; Asp167Leu;
 Asp167Met; Asp167Asn; Asp167Pro; Asp167Gln;
 Asp167Arg; Asp167Ser; Asp167Thr; Asp167Val;
 Asp167Trp; Asp167Tyr; Lys168Ala; Lys168Cys;
 Lys168Asp; Lys168Glu; Lys168Phe; Lys168Gly;
 Lys168His; Lys168Ile; Lys168Leu; Lys168Met; Lys168Asn;
 Lys168Pro; Lys168Gln; Lys168Arg; Lys168Ser; Lys168Thr;
 Lys168Val; Lys168Trp; Lys168Tyr; Leu169Ala;
 Leu169Cys; Leu169Asp; Leu169Glu; Leu169Phe;
 Leu169Gly; Leu169His; Leu169Ile; Leu169Lys;
 Leu169Met; Leu169Asn; Leu169Pro; Leu169Gln;
 Leu169Arg; Leu169Ser; Leu169Thr; Leu169Val;
 Leu169Trp; Leu169Tyr; Pro170Ala; Pro170Cys;
 Pro170Asp; Pro170Glu; Pro170Phe; Pro170Gly; Pro170His;
 Pro170Ile; Pro170Lys; Pro170Leu; Pro170Met; Pro170Asn;
 Pro170Gln; Pro170Arg; Pro170Ser; Pro170Thr; Pro170Val;
 Pro170Trp; Pro170Tyr; Ser171Ala; Ser171Cys; Ser171Asp;
 Ser171Glu; Ser171Phe; Ser171Gly; Ser171His; Ser171Ile;
 Ser171Lys; Ser171Leu; Ser171Met; Ser171Asn; Ser171Pro;
 Ser171Gln; Ser171Arg; Ser171Thr; Ser171Val; Ser171Trp;
 Ser171Tyr; Glu172Ala; Glu172Cys; Glu172Asp;
 Glu172Phe; Glu172Gly; Glu172His; Glu172Ile; Glu172Lys;
 Glu172Leu; Glu172Met; Glu172Asn; Glu172Pro;
 Glu172Gln; Glu172Arg; Glu172Ser; Glu172Thr;
 Glu172Val; Glu172Trp; Glu172Tyr; Lys173Ala; Lys173Cys;
 Lys173Asp; Lys173Glu; Lys173Phe; Lys173Gly;
 Lys173His; Lys173Ile; Lys173Leu; Lys173Met; Lys173Asn;

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Lys173Pro; Lys173Gln; Lys173Arg; Lys173Ser; Lys173Thr;
 Lys173Val; Lys173Trp; Lys173Tyr; Arg174Ala; Arg174Cys;
 Arg174Asp; Arg174Glu; Arg174Phe; Arg174Gly;
 Arg174His; Arg174Ile; Arg174Lys; Arg174Leu;
 Arg174Met; Arg174Asn; Arg174Pro; Arg174Gln;
 Arg174Ser; Arg174Thr; Arg174Val; Arg174Trp; Arg174Tyr;
 Glu175Ala; Glu175Cys; Glu175Asp; Glu175Phe;
 Glu175Gly; Glu175His; Glu175Ile; Glu175Lys; Glu175Leu;
 Glu175Met; Glu175Asn; Glu175Pro; Glu175Gln;
 Glu175Arg; Glu175Ser; Glu175Thr; Glu175Val;
 Glu175Trp; Glu175Tyr; Leu176Ala; Leu176Cys;
 Leu176Asp; Leu176Glu; Leu176Phe; Leu176Gly;
 Leu176His; Leu176Ile; Leu176Lys; Leu176Met;
 Leu176Asn; Leu176Pro; Leu176Gln; Leu176Arg;
 Leu176Ser; Leu176Thr; Leu176Val; Leu176Trp;
 Leu177Arg; Leu177Cys; Leu177Asp; Leu177Phe;
 Leu177Gly; Leu177His; Leu177Ile; Leu177Lys;
 Leu177Met; Leu177Asn; Leu177Pro; Leu177Gln;
 Leu177Arg; Leu177Ser; Leu177Thr; Leu177Val;
 Leu177Trp; Leu177Tyr; Ile178Ala; Ile178Cys;
 Ile178Asp; Ile178Glu; Ile178Phe; Ile178Gly;
 Ile178His; Ile178Lys; Ile178Leu; Ile178Met; Ile178Asn;
 Ile178Pro; Ile178Gln; Ile178Arg; Ile178Ser; Ile178Thr;
 Ile178Val; Ile178Trp; Ile178Tyr; Asp179Ala; Asp179Cys;
 Asp179Glu; Asp179Phe; Asp179Gly; Asp179His;
 Asp179Ile; Asp179Lys; Asp179Leu; Asp179Met;
 Asp179Asn; Asp179Pro; Asp179Gln; Asp179Arg;
 Asp179Ser; Asp179Thr; Asp179Val; Asp179Trp;
 Asp179Tyr; Trp180Ala; Trp180Cys; Trp180Asp;
 Trp180Glu; Trp180Phe; Trp180Gly; Trp180His; Trp180Ile;
 Trp180Lys; Trp180Leu; Trp180Met; Trp180Asn;
 Trp180Pro; Trp180Gln; Trp180Arg; Trp180Ser; Trp180Thr;
 Trp180Val; Trp180Tyr; Met181Ala; Met181Cys;
 Met181Asp; Met181Glu; Met181Phe; Met181Gly;
 Met181His; Met181Ile; Met181Lys; Met181Leu;
 Met181Asn; Met181Pro; Met181Gln; Met181Arg;
 Met181Ser; Met181Thr; Met181Val; Met181Trp;
 Met181Tyr; Lys182Ala; Lys182Cys; Lys182Asp;
 Lys182Glu; Lys182Phe; Lys182Gly; Lys182His; Lys182Ile;
 Lys182Leu; Lys182Met; Lys182Asn; Lys182Pro;
 Lys182Gln; Lys182Arg; Lys182Ser; Lys182Thr; Lys182Val;
 Lys182Trp; Lys182Tyr; Arg183Ala; Arg183Cys;
 Arg183Asp; Arg183Glu; Arg183Phe; Arg183Gly;
 Arg183His; Arg183Ile; Arg183Lys; Arg183Leu;
 Arg183Met; Arg183Asn; Arg183Pro; Arg183Gln;
 Arg183Ser; Arg183Thr; Arg183Val; Arg183Trp; Arg183Tyr;
 Asn184Ala; Asn184Cys; Asn184Asp; Asn184Glu;
 Asn184Phe; Asn184Gly; Asn184His; Asn184Ile;
 Asn184Lys; Asn184Leu; Asn184Met; Asn184Pro;
 Asn184Gln; Asn184Arg; Asn184Ser; Asn184Thr;
 Asn184Val; Asn184Trp; Asn184Tyr; Thr185Ala;
 Thr185Cys; Thr185Asp; Thr185Glu; Thr185Phe;
 Thr185Gly; Thr185His; Thr185Ile; Thr185Lys;
 Thr185Leu; Thr185Met; Thr185Asn; Thr185Pro;
 Thr185Gln; Thr185Arg; Thr185Ser; Thr185Val;
 Thr185Trp; Thr185Tyr; Thr186Ala; Thr186Cys;
 Thr186Asp; Thr186Glu; Thr186Phe; Thr186Gly;
 Thr186His; Thr186Ile; Thr186Lys; Thr186Leu;
 Thr186Met; Thr186Asn; Thr186Pro; Thr186Gln;
 Thr186Arg; Thr186Ser; Thr186Val; Thr186Trp;
 Thr186Tyr; Gly187Ala; Gly187Cys; Gly187Asp;
 Gly187Glu; Gly187Phe; Gly187His; Gly187Ile;
 Gly187Lys; Gly187Leu; Gly187Met; Gly187Asn;
 Gly187Pro; Gly187Gln; Gly187Arg; Gly187Ser;
 Gly187Thr; Gly187Val; Gly187Trp; Gly187Tyr;
 Asp188Cys; Asp188Glu; Asp188Phe; Asp188Gly;
 Asp188His; Asp188Ile; Asp188Lys; Asp188Leu;
 Asp188Met; Asp188Asn; Asp188Pro; Asp188Gln;

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Asp188Arg; Asp188Ser; Asp188Thr; Asp188Val;
 Asp188Trp; Asp188Tyr; Ala189Cys; Ala189Asp;
 Ala189Glu; Ala189Phe; Ala189Gly; Ala189His; Ala189Ile;
 Ala189Lys; Ala189Leu; Ala189Met; Ala189Asn;
 Ala189Pro; Ala189Gln; Ala189Arg; Ala189Ser; Ala189Thr;
 Ala189Val; Ala189Trp; Ala189Tyr; Leu190Ala; Leu190Cys;
 Leu190Asp; Leu190Glu; Leu190Phe; Leu190Gly;
 Leu190His; Leu190Ile; Leu190Lys; Leu190Met;
 Leu190Asn; Leu190Pro; Leu190Gln; Leu190Arg;
 Leu190Ser; Leu190Thr; Leu190Val; Leu190Trp;
 Leu190Tyr; Ile191Ala; Ile191Cys; Ile191Asp; Ile191Glu;
 Ile191Phe; Ile191Gly; Ile191His; Ile191Lys; Ile191Leu;
 Ile191Met; Ile191Asn; Ile191Pro; Ile191Gln; Ile191Arg;
 Ile191Ser; Ile191Thr; Ile191Val; Ile191Trp; Ile191Tyr;
 Arg192Ala; Arg192Cys; Arg192Asp; Arg192Glu;
 Arg192Phe; Arg192Gly; Arg192His; Arg192Ile; Arg192Lys;
 Arg192Leu; Arg192Met; Arg192Asn; Arg192Pro;
 Arg192Gln; Arg192Ser; Arg192Thr; Arg192Val; Arg192Trp;
 Arg192Tyr; Ala193Cys; Ala193Asp; Ala193Glu;
 Ala193Phe; Ala193Gly; Ala193His; Ala193Ile; Ala193Lys;
 Ala193Leu; Ala193Met; Ala193Asn; Ala193Pro;
 Ala193Gln; Ala193Arg; Ala193Ser; Ala193Thr; Ala193Val;
 Ala193Trp; Ala193Tyr; Gly194Ala; Gly194Cys;
 Gly194Asp; Gly194Glu; Gly194Phe; Gly194His;
 Gly194Ile; Gly194Lys; Gly194Leu; Gly194Met;
 Gly194Asn; Gly194Pro; Gly194Gln; Gly194Arg;
 Gly194Ser; Gly194Thr; Gly194Val; Gly194Trp; Gly194Tyr;
 Val195Ala; Val195Cys; Val195Asp; Val195Glu; Val195Phe;
 Val195Gly; Val195His; Val195Ile; Val195Lys; Val195Leu;
 Val195Met; Val195Asn; Val195Pro; Val195Gln; Val195Arg;
 Val195Ser; Val195Thr; Val195Trp; Val195Tyr; Pro196Ala;
 Pro196Cys; Pro196Asp; Pro196Glu; Pro196Phe;
 Pro196Gly; Pro196His; Pro196Ile; Pro196Lys; Pro196Leu;
 Pro196Met; Pro196Asn; Pro196Gln; Pro196Arg;
 Pro196Ser; Pro196Thr; Pro196Val; Pro196Trp; Pro196Tyr;
 Asp197Ala; Asp197Cys; Asp197Glu; Asp197Phe;
 Asp197Gly; Asp197His; Asp197Ile; Asp197Lys;
 Asp197Leu; Asp197Met; Asp197Asn; Asp197Pro;
 Asp197Gln; Asp197Arg; Asp197Ser; Asp197Thr;
 Asp197Val; Asp197Trp; Asp197Tyr; Gly198Ala;
 Gly198Cys; Gly198Asp; Gly198Glu; Gly198Phe;
 Gly198His; Gly198Ile; Gly198Lys; Gly198Leu;
 Gly198Met; Gly198Asn; Gly198Pro; Gly198Gln;
 Gly198Arg; Gly198Ser; Gly198Thr; Gly198Val;
 Gly198Trp; Gly198Tyr; Trp199Ala; Trp199Cys;
 Trp199Asp; Trp199Glu; Trp199Phe; Trp199Gly; Trp199His;
 Trp199Ile; Trp199Lys; Trp199Leu; Trp199Met; Trp199Asn;
 Trp199Pro; Trp199Gln; Trp199Arg; Trp199Ser; Trp199Thr;
 Trp199Val; Trp199Tyr; Glu200Ala; Glu200Cys;
 Glu200Asp; Glu200Phe; Glu200Gly; Glu200His;
 Glu200Ile; Glu200Lys; Glu200Leu; Glu200Met;
 Glu200Asn; Glu200Pro; Glu200Gln; Glu200Arg;
 Glu200Ser; Glu200Thr; Glu200Val; Glu200Trp; Glu200Tyr;
 Val201Ala; Val201Cys; Val201Asp; Val201Glu; Val201Phe;
 Val201Gly; Val201His; Val201Ile; Val201Lys; Val201Leu;
 Val201Met; Val201Asn; Val201Pro; Val201Gln; Val201Arg;
 Val201Ser; Val201Thr; Val201Trp; Val201Tyr; Ala202Cys;
 Ala202Asp; Ala202Glu; Ala202Phe; Ala202Gly; Ala202His;
 Ala202Ile; Ala202Lys; Ala202Leu; Ala202Met; Ala202Asn;
 Ala202Pro; Ala202Gln; Ala202Arg; Ala202Ser; Ala202Thr;
 Ala202Val; Ala202Trp; Ala202Tyr; Asp203Ala; Asp203Cys;
 Asp203Glu; Asp203Phe; Asp203Gly; Asp203His;
 Asp203Ile; Asp203Lys; Asp203Leu; Asp203Met;
 Asp203Asn; Asp203Pro; Asp203Gln; Asp203Arg;
 Asp203Ser; Asp203Thr; Asp203Val; Asp203Trp;
 Asp203Tyr; Lys204Ala; Lys204Cys; Lys204Asp;
 Lys204Glu; Lys204Phe; Lys204Gly; Lys204His; Lys204Ile;

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Lys204Leu; Lys204Met; Lys204Asn; Lys204Pro;
 Lys204Gln; Lys204Arg; Lys204Ser; Lys204Thr; Lys204Val;
 Lys204Trp; Lys204Tyr; Thr205Ala; Thr205Cys;
 Thr205Asp; Thr205Glu; Thr205Phe; Thr205Gly;
 Thr205His; Thr205Ile; Thr205Lys; Thr205Leu; Thr205Met;
 Thr205Asn; Thr205Pro; Thr205Gln; Thr205Arg;
 Thr205Ser; Thr205Val; Thr205Trp; Thr205Tyr; Gly206Ala;
 Gly206Cys; Gly206Asp; Gly206Glu; Gly206Phe;
 Gly206His; Gly206Ile; Gly206Lys; Gly206Leu;
 Gly206Met; Gly206Asn; Gly206Pro; Gly206Gln;
 Gly206Arg; Gly206Ser; Gly206Thr; Gly206Val;
 Gly206Trp; Gly206Tyr; Ala207Cys; Ala207Asp;
 Ala207Glu; Ala207Phe; Ala207Gly; Ala207His; Ala207Ile;
 Ala207Lys; Ala207Leu; Ala207Met; Ala207Asn;
 Ala207Pro; Ala207Gln; Ala207Arg; Ala207Ser; Ala207Thr;
 Ala207Val; Ala207Trp; Ala207Tyr; Ala208Cys; Ala208Asp;
 Ala208Glu; Ala208Phe; Ala208Gly; Ala208His; Ala208Ile;
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 Ala208Pro; Ala208Gln; Ala208Arg; Ala208Ser; Ala208Thr;
 Ala208Val; Ala208Trp; Ala208Tyr; Ser209Ala; Ser209Cys;
 Ser209Asp; Ser209Glu; Ser209Phe; Ser209Gly; Ser209His;
 Ser209Ile; Ser209Lys; Ser209Leu; Ser209Met; Ser209Asn;
 Ser209Pro; Ser209Gln; Ser209Arg; Ser209Thr; Ser209Val;
 Ser209Trp; Ser209Tyr; Tyr210Ala; Tyr210Cys; Tyr210Asp;
 Tyr210Glu; Tyr210Phe; Tyr210Gly; Tyr210His; Tyr210Ile;
 Tyr210Lys; Tyr210Leu; Tyr210Met; Tyr210Asn; Tyr210Pro;
 Tyr210Gln; Tyr210Arg; Tyr210Ser; Tyr210Thr; Tyr210Val;
 Tyr210Trp; Gly211Ala; Gly211Cys; Gly211Asn;
 Gly211Glu; Gly211Phe; Gly211His; Gly211Ile; Gly211Lys;
 Gly211Leu; Gly211Met; Gly211Asn; Gly211Pro;
 Gly211Gln; Gly211Arg; Gly211Ser; Gly211Thr;
 Gly211Val; Gly211Trp; Gly211Tyr; Thr212Ala; Thr212Cys;
 Thr212Asp; Thr212Glu; Thr212Phe; Thr212Gly;
 Thr212His; Thr212Ile; Thr212Lys; Thr212Leu; Thr212Met;
 Thr212Asn; Thr212Pro; Thr212Gln; Thr212Arg;
 Thr212Ser; Thr212Val; Thr212Trp; Thr212Tyr; Arg213Ala;
 Arg213Cys; Arg213Asp; Arg213Glu; Arg213Phe;
 Arg213Gly; Arg213His; Arg213Ile; Arg213Lys; Arg213Leu;
 Arg213Met; Arg213Asn; Arg213Pro; Arg213Gln;
 Arg213Ser; Arg213Thr; Arg213Val; Arg213Trp; Arg213Tyr;
 Asn214Ala; Asn214Cys; Asn214Asp; Asn214Glu;
 Asn214Phe; Asn214Gly; Asn214His; Asn214Ile;
 Asn214Lys; Asn214Leu; Asn214Met; Asn214Pro;
 Asn214Gln; Asn214Arg; Asn214Ser; Asn214Thr;
 Asn214Val; Asn214Trp; Asn214Tyr; Asp215Ala;
 Asp215Cys; Asp215Glu; Asp215Phe; Asp215Gly;
 Asp215His; Asp215Ile; Asp215Lys; Asp215Leu;
 Asp215Met; Asp215Asn; Asp215Pro; Asp215Gln;
 Asp215Arg; Asp215Ser; Asp215Thr; Asp215Val;
 Asp215Trp; Asp215Tyr; Ile216Ala; Ile216Cys; Ile216Asp;
 Ile216Glu; Ile216Phe; Ile216Gly; Ile216His; Ile216Lys;
 Ile216Leu; Ile216Met; Ile216Asn; Ile216Pro; Ile216Gln;
 Ile216Arg; Ile216Ser; Ile216Thr; Ile216Val; Ile216Trp;
 Ile216Tyr; Ala217Cys; Ala217Asp; Ala217Glu; Ala217Phe;
 Ala217Gly; Ala217His; Ala217Ile; Ala217Lys; Ala217Leu;
 Ala217Met; Ala217Asn; Ala217Pro; Ala217Gln;
 Ala217Arg; Ala217Ser; Ala217Thr; Ala217Val; Ala217Trp;
 Ala217Tyr; Ile218Ala; Ile218Cys; Ile218Asp; Ile218Glu;
 Ile218Phe; Ile218Gly; Ile218His; Ile218Lys; Ile218Leu;
 Ile218Met; Ile218Asn; Ile218Pro; Ile218Gln; Ile218Arg;
 Ile218Ser; Ile218Thr; Ile218Val; Ile218Trp; Ile218Tyr;
 Ile219Ala; Ile219Cys; Ile219Asp; Ile219Glu; Ile219Phe;
 Ile219Gly; Ile219His; Ile219Lys; Ile219Leu; Ile219Met;
 Ile219Asn; Ile219Pro; Ile219Gln; Ile219Arg; Ile219Ser;
 Ile219Thr; Ile219Val; Ile219Trp; Ile219Tyr; Trp220Ala;
 Trp220Cys; Trp220Asp; Trp220Glu; Trp220Phe;
 Trp220Gly; Trp220His; Trp220Ile; Trp220Lys; Trp220Leu;

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Trp220Met; Trp220Asn; Trp220Pro; Trp220Gln;
 Trp220Arg; Trp220Ser; Trp220Thr; Trp220Val; Trp220Tyr;
 Pro221Ala; Pro221Cys; Pro221Asp; Pro221Glu;
 Pro221Phe; Pro221Gly; Pro221His; Pro221Ile; Pro221Lys;
 Pro221Leu; Pro221Met; Pro221Asn; Pro221Gln;
 Pro221Arg; Pro221Ser; Pro221Thr; Pro221Val; Pro221Trp;
 Pro221Tyr; Pro222Ala; Pro222Cys; Pro222Asp; Pro222Glu;
 Pro222Phe; Pro222Gly; Pro222His; Pro222Ile; Pro222Lys;
 Pro222Leu; Pro222Met; Pro222Asn; Pro222Gln;
 Pro222Arg; Pro222Ser; Pro222Thr; Pro222Val; Pro222Trp;
 Pro222Tyr; Lys223Ala; Lys223Cys; Lys223Asp;
 Lys223Glu; Lys223Phe; Lys223Gly; Lys223His; Lys223Ile;
 Lys223Leu; Lys223Met; Lys223Asn; Lys223Pro;
 Lys223Gln; Lys223Arg; Lys223Ser; Lys223Thr; Lys223Val;
 Lys223Trp; Lys223Tyr; Gly224Ala; Gly224Cys;
 Gly224Asp; Gly224Glu; Gly224Phe; Gly224His;
 Gly224Ile; Gly224Lys; Gly224Leu; Gly224Met;
 Gly224Asn; Gly224Pro; Gly224Gln; Gly224Arg;
 Gly224Ser; Gly224Thr; Gly224Val; Gly224Trp; Gly224Tyr;
 Asp225Ala; Asp225Cys; Asp225Glu; Asp225Phe;
 Asp225Gly; Asp225His; Asp225Ile; Asp225Lys;
 Asp225Leu; Asp225Met; Asp225Asn; Asp225Pro;
 Asp225Gln; Asp225Arg; Asp225Ser; Asp225Thr;
 Asp225Val; Asp225Trp; Asp225Tyr; Pro226Ala;
 Pro226Cys; Pro226Asp; Pro226Glu; Pro226Phe;
 Pro226Gly; Pro226His; Pro226Ile; Pro226Lys; Pro226Leu;
 Pro226Met; Pro226Asn; Pro226Gln; Pro226Arg;
 Pro226Ser; Pro226Thr; Pro226Val; Pro226Trp; Pro226Tyr;
 Val227Ala; Val227Cys; Val227Asp; Val227Glu; Val227Phe;
 Val227Gly; Val227His; Val227Ile; Val227Lys; Val227Leu;
 Val227Met; Val227Asn; Val227Pro; Val227Gln; Val227Arg;
 Val227Ser; Val227Thr; Val227Trp; Val227Tyr; Val228Ala;
 Val228Cys; Val228Asp; Val228Glu; Val228Phe; Val228Gly;
 Val228His; Val228Ile; Val228Lys; Val228Leu; Val228Met;
 Val228Asn; Val228Pro; Val228Gln; Val228Arg; Val228Ser;
 Val228Thr; Val228Trp; Val228Tyr; Leu229Ala; Leu229Cys;
 Leu229Asp; Leu229Glu; Leu229Phe; Leu229Gly;
 Leu229His; Leu229Ile; Leu229Lys; Leu229Met;
 Leu229Asn; Leu229Pro; Leu229Gln; Leu229Arg;
 Leu229Ser; Leu229Thr; Leu229Val; Leu229Trp;
 Leu229Tyr; Ala230Cys; Ala230Asp; Ala230Glu;
 Ala230Phe; Ala230Gly; Ala230His; Ala230Ile; Ala230Lys;
 Ala230Leu; Ala230Met; Ala230Asn; Ala230Pro;
 Ala230Gln; Ala230Arg; Ala230Ser; Ala230Thr; Ala230Val;
 Ala230Trp; Ala230Tyr; Val231Ala; Val231Cys; Val231Asp;
 Val231Glu; Val231Phe; Val231Gly; Val231His; Val231Ile;
 Val231Lys; Val231Leu; Val231Met; Val231Asn; Val231Pro;
 Val231Gln; Val231Arg; Val231Ser; Val231Thr; Val231Trp;
 Val231Tyr; Leu232Ala; Leu232Cys; Leu232Asp;
 Leu232Glu; Leu232Phe; Leu232Gly; Leu232His;
 Leu232Ile; Leu232Lys; Leu232Met; Leu232Asn;
 Leu232Pro; Leu232Gln; Leu232Arg; Leu232Ser;
 Leu232Thr; Leu232Val; Leu232Trp; Leu232Tyr;
 Ser233Ala; Ser233Cys; Ser233Asp; Ser233Glu; Ser233Phe;
 Ser233Gly; Ser233His; Ser233Ile; Ser233Lys; Ser233Leu;
 Ser233Met; Ser233Asn; Ser233Pro; Ser233Gln; Ser233Arg;
 Ser233Thr; Ser233Val; Ser233Trp; Ser233Tyr; Ser234Ala;
 Ser234Cys; Ser234Asp; Ser234Glu; Ser234Phe; Ser234Gly;
 Ser234His; Ser234Ile; Ser234Lys; Ser234Leu; Ser234Met;
 Ser234Asn; Ser234Pro; Ser234Gln; Ser234Arg; Ser234Thr;
 Ser234Val; Ser234Trp; Ser234Tyr; Arg235Ala; Arg235Cys;
 Arg235Asp; Arg235Glu; Arg235Phe; Arg235Gly;
 Arg235His; Arg235Ile; Arg235Lys; Arg235Leu;
 Arg235Met; Arg235Asn; Arg235Pro; Arg235Gln;
 Arg235Ser; Arg235Thr; Arg235Val; Arg235Trp; Arg235Tyr;
 Asp236Ala; Asp236Cys; Asp236Glu; Asp236Phe;
 Asp236Gly; Asp236His; Asp236Ile; Asp236Lys;

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Asp236Leu; Asp236Met; Asp236Asn; Asp236Pro;
 Asp236Gln; Asp236Arg; Asp236Ser; Asp236Thr;
 Asp236Val; Asp236Trp; Asp236Tyr; Lys237Ala;
 Lys237Cys; Lys237Asp; Lys237Glu; Lys237Phe;
 Lys237Gly; Lys237His; Lys237Ile; Lys237Leu; Lys237Met;
 Lys237Asn; Lys237Pro; Lys237Gln; Lys237Arg;
 Lys237Ser; Lys237Thr; Lys237Val; Lys237Trp; Lys237Tyr;
 Lys238Ala; Lys238Cys; Lys238Asp; Lys238Glu;
 Lys238Phe; Lys238Gly; Lys238His; Lys238Ile; Lys238Leu;
 Lys238Met; Lys238Asn; Lys238Pro; Lys238Gln;
 Lys238Arg; Lys238Ser; Lys238Thr; Lys238Val; Lys238Trp;
 Lys238Tyr; Asp239Ala; Asp239Cys; Asp239Glu;
 Asp239Phe; Asp239Gly; Asp239His; Asp239Ile;
 Asp239Lys; Asp239Leu; Asp239Met; Asp239Asn;
 Asp239Pro; Asp239Gln; Asp239Arg; Asp239Ser;
 Asp239Thr; Asp239Val; Asp239Trp; Asp239Tyr;
 Ala240Cys; Ala240Asp; Ala240Glu; Ala240Phe;
 Ala240Gly; Ala240His; Ala240Ile; Ala240Lys; Ala240Leu;
 Ala240Met; Ala240Asn; Ala240Pro; Ala240Gln;
 Ala240Arg; Ala240Ser; Ala240Thr; Ala240Val; Ala240Trp;
 Ala240Tyr; Lys241Ala; Lys241Cys; Lys241Asn;
 Lys241Glu; Lys241Phe; Lys241Gly; Lys241His; Lys241Ile;
 Lys241Leu; Lys241Met; Lys241Asn; Lys241Pro;
 Lys241Gln; Lys241Arg; Lys241Ser; Lys241Thr; Lys241Val;
 Lys241Trp; Lys241Tyr; Tyr242Ala; Tyr242Cys; Tyr242Asp;
 Tyr242Glu; Tyr242Phe; Tyr242Gly; Tyr242His; Tyr242Ile;
 Tyr242Lys; Tyr242Leu; Tyr242Met; Tyr242Asn; Tyr242Pro;
 Tyr242Gln; Tyr242Arg; Tyr242Ser; Tyr242Thr; Tyr242Val;
 Tyr242Trp; Asp243Ala; Asp243Cys; Asp243Glu;
 Asp243Phe; Asp243Gly; Asp243His; Asp243Ile;
 Asp243Lys; Asp243Leu; Asp243Met; Asp243Asn;
 Asp243Pro; Asp243Gln; Asp243Arg; Asp243Ser;
 Asp243Thr; Asp243Val; Asp243Trp; Asp243Tyr;
 Asp244Ala; Asp244Cys; Asp244Glu; Asp244Phe;
 Asp244Gly; Asp244His; Asp244Ile; Asp244Lys;
 Asp244Leu; Asp244Met; Asp244Asn; Asp244Pro;
 Asp244Gln; Asp244Arg; Asp244Ser; Asp244Thr;
 Asp244Val; Asp244Trp; Asp244Tyr; Lys245Ala;
 Lys245Cys; Lys245Asp; Lys245Glu; Lys245Phe;
 Lys245Gly; Lys245His; Lys245Ile; Lys245Leu; Lys245Met;
 Lys245Asn; Lys245Pro; Lys245Gln; Lys245Arg;
 Lys245Ser; Lys245Thr; Lys245Val; Lys245Trp; Lys245Tyr;
 Leu246Ala; Leu246Cys; Leu246Asp; Leu246Glu;
 Leu246Phe; Leu246Gly; Leu246His; Leu246Ile;
 Leu246Lys; Leu246Met; Leu246Asn; Leu246Pro;
 Leu246Gln; Leu246Arg; Leu246Ser; Leu246Thr;
 Leu246Val; Leu246Trp; Leu246Tyr; Ile247Ala; Ile247Cys;
 Ile247Asp; Ile247Glu; Ile247Phe; Ile247Gly; Ile247His;
 Ile247Lys; Ile247Leu; Ile247Met; Ile247Asn; Ile247Pro;
 Ile247Gln; Ile247Arg; Ile247Ser; Ile247Thr; Ile247Val;
 Ile247Trp; Ile247Tyr; Ala248Cys; Ala248Asp; Ala248Glu;
 Ala248Phe; Ala248Gly; Ala248His; Ala248Ile; Ala248Lys;
 Ala248Leu; Ala248Met; Ala248Asn; Ala248Pro;
 Ala248Gln; Ala248Arg; Ala248Ser; Ala248Thr; Ala248Val;
 Ala248Trp; Ala248Tyr; Glu249Ala; Glu249Cys;
 Glu249Asp; Glu249Phe; Glu249Gly; Glu249His;
 Glu249Ile; Glu249Lys; Glu249Leu; Glu249Met;
 Glu249Asn; Glu249Pro; Glu249Gln; Glu249Arg;
 Glu249Ser; Glu249Thr; Glu249Val; Glu249Trp; Glu249Tyr;
 Ala250Cys; Ala250Asp; Ala250Glu; Ala250Phe;
 Ala250Gly; Ala250His; Ala250Ile; Ala250Lys; Ala250Leu;
 Ala250Met; Ala250Asn; Ala250Pro; Ala250Gln;
 Ala250Arg; Ala250Ser; Ala250Thr; Ala250Val; Ala250Trp;
 Ala250Tyr; Thr251Ala; Thr251Cys; Thr251Asp;
 Thr251Glu; Thr251Phe; Thr251Gly; Thr251His; Thr251Ile;
 Thr251Lys; Thr251Leu; Thr251Met; Thr251Asn;
 Thr251Pro; Thr251Gln; Thr251Arg; Thr251Ser; Thr251Val;

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Thr251Trp; Thr251Tyr; Lys252Ala; Lys252Cys;
 Lys252Asp; Lys252Glu; Lys252Phe; Lys252Gly;
 Lys252His; Lys252Ile; Lys252Leu; Lys252Met; Lys252Asn;
 Lys252Pro; Lys252Gln; Lys252Arg; Lys252Ser; Lys252Thr;
 Lys252Val; Lys252Trp; Lys252Tyr; Val253Ala; Val253Cys;
 Val253Asp; Val253Glu; Val253Phe; Val253Gly; Val253His;
 Val253Ile; Val253Lys; Val253Leu; Val253Met; Val253Asn;
 Val253Pro; Val253Gln; Val253Arg; Val253Ser; Val253Thr;
 Val253Trp; Val253Tyr; Val254Ala; Val254Cys; Val254Asp;
 Val254Glu; Val254Phe; Val254Gly; Val254His; Val254Ile;
 Val254Lys; Val254Leu; Val254Met; Val254Asn; Val254Pro;
 Val254Gln; Val254Arg; Val254Ser; Val254Thr; Val254Trp;
 Val254Tyr; Met255Ala; Met255Cys; Met255Asp;
 Met255Glu; Met255Phe; Met255Gly; Met255His;
 Met255Ile; Met255Lys; Met255Leu; Met255Asn;
 Met255Pro; Met255Gln; Met255Arg; Met255Ser;
 Met255Thr; Met255Val; Met255Trp; Met255Tyr;
 Lys256Ala; Lys256Cys; Lys256Asp; Lys256Glu;
 Lys256Phe; Lys256Gly; Lys256His; Lys256Ile; Lys256Leu;
 Lys256Met; Lys256Asn; Lys256Pro; Lys256Gln;
 Lys256Arg; Lys256Ser; Lys256Thr; Lys256Val; Lys256Trp;
 Lys256Tyr; Ala257Cys; Ala257Asp; Ala257Glu;
 Ala257Phe; Ala257Gly; Ala257His; Ala257Ile; Ala257Lys;
 Ala257Leu; Ala257Met; Ala257Asn; Ala257Pro;
 Ala257Gln; Ala257Arg; Ala257Ser; Ala257Thr; Ala257Val;
 Ala257Trp; Ala257Tyr; Leu258Ala; Leu258Cys;
 Leu258Asp; Leu258Glu; Leu258Phe; Leu258Gly;
 Leu258His; Leu258Ile; Leu258Lys; Leu258Met;
 Leu258Asn; Leu258Pro; Leu258Gln; Leu258Arg;
 Leu258Ser; Leu258Thr; Leu258Val; Leu258Trp;
 Leu258Tyr; Asn259Ala; Asn259Cys; Asn259Asp;
 Asn259Glu; Asn259Phe; Asn259Gly; Asn259His;
 Asn259Ile; Asn259Lys; Asn259Leu; Asn259Met;
 Asn259Pro; Asn259Gln; Asn259Arg; Asn259Ser;
 Asn259Thr; Asn259Val; Asn259Trp; Asn259Tyr;
 Met260Ala; Met260Cys; Met260Asp; Met260Glu;
 Met260Phe; Met260Gly; Met260His; Met260Ile;
 Met260Lys; Met260Leu; Met260Asn; Met260Pro;
 Met260Gln; Met260Arg; Met260Ser; Met260Thr;
 Met260Val; Met260Trp; Met260Tyr; Asn261Ala;
 Asn261Cys; Asn261Asp; Asn261Glu; Asn261Phe;
 Asn261Gly; Asn261His; Asn261Ile; Asn261Lys;
 Asn261Leu; Asn261Met; Asn261Pro; Asn261Gln;
 Asn261Arg; Asn261Ser; Asn261Thr; Asn261Val;
 Asn261Trp; Asn261Tyr; Gly262Ala; Gly262Cys;
 Gly262Asp; Gly262Glu; Gly262Phe; Gly262His;
 Gly262Ile; Gly262Lys; Gly262Leu; Gly262Met;
 Gly262Asn; Gly262Pro; Gly262Gln; Gly262Arg;
 Gly262Ser; Gly262Thr; Gly262Val; Gly262Trp; Gly262Tyr;
 Lys263Ala; Lys263Cys; Lys263Asp; Lys263Glu;
 Lys263Phe; Lys263Gly; Lys263His; Lys263Ile; Lys263Leu;
 Lys263Met; Lys263Asn; Lys263Pro; Lys263Gln;
 Lys263Arg; Lys263Ser; Lys263Thr; Lys263Val; Lys263Trp;
 Lys263Tyr; Met 264Ala; Met 264Cys; Met 264Asp; Met
 264Glu; Met 264Phe; Met 264Gly; Met 264His; Met 264Ile;
 Met 264Lys; Met 264Leu; Met 264Asn; Met 264Pro; Met
 264Gln; Met 264Arg; Met 264Ser; Met 264Thr; Met 264Val;
 Met 264Trp; Met 264Tyr; Asn 265Ala; Asn 265Cys; Asn
 265Asp; Asn 265Glu; Asn 265Phe; Asn 265Gly; Asn 265His;
 Asn 265Ile; Asn 265Lys; Asn 265Leu; Asn 265Met; ; Asn
 265Pro; Asn 265Gln; Asn 265Arg; Asn 265Ser; Asn 265Thr;
 Asn 265Val; Asn 265Trp; Asn 265Tyr; Gly 266Ala; Gly
 266Cys; Gly 266Asp; Gly 266Glu; Gly 266Phe; ; Gly
 266His; Gly 266Ile; Gly 266Lys; Gly 266Leu; Gly 266Met;
 Gly 266Asn; Gly 266Pro; Gly 266Gln; Gly 266Arg; Gly
 266Ser; Gly 266Thr; Gly 266Val; Gly 266Trp; Gly 266Tyr;
 Lys267Ala; Lys267Cys; Lys267Asp; Lys267Glu;

Lys267Phe; Lys267Gly; Lys267His; Lys267Ile; Lys267Leu; Lys267Met; Lys267Asn; Lys267Pro; Lys267Gln; Lys267Arg; Lys267Ser; Lys267Thr; Lys267Val; Lys267Trp; and Lys267Tyr. In some embodiments, SEQ ID NO: 1 may have a Met and/or Thr preceding the first residue of the sequence. These residues may be similarly mutated as above.

In all of these mutants, the numbering of residues corresponds to SEQ ID NO: 1. These residue numbers may be converted to Ambler numbers (Ambler et al., 1991, A standard numbering scheme for the Class A β -lactamases, *Biochem. J.* 276:269-272, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference) through use of any conventional bioinformatic method, for example by using BLAST (Basic Local Alignment Search Tools) or FASTA (FAST-All). For example, residue 244 corresponds to Ambler 276. For example, the following conversions may be used:

Ambler Classification No.	SEQ ID NO: 1 Residue
F33	F6
I72	I44
Q135	Q105
G156	G126
T160	T130
A232	A202
A237	A207
A238	A208
S240	S209
T243	T212
R244	R213
S266	S234
D276	D244

Furthermore, percent identity may also be assessed with these conventional bioinformatic methods.

In one aspect, the present invention pertains to beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprising an amino acid sequence having at least 70% (e.g. about 70%, or about 71%, or about 72%, or about 73%, or about 74%, or about 75%, or about 76%, or about 77%, or about 78%, or about 79%, or about 80%, or about 81%, or about 82%, or about 83%, or about 84%, or about 85%, or about 86%, or about 87%, or about 88%, or about 89%, or about 90%, or about 91%, or about 92%, or about 93%, or about 94%, or about 95%, or about 96%, or about 97%, or about 98%, or about 99%) sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 and one or more of the following mutations of Ambler classification: F33X, Q135X, G156X, A232X, A237X, A238X, S240X, T243X, R244X, S266X, and D276X, wherein X is any naturally-occurring amino acid and with the proviso that D276X is not present in the context of a single mutant. In some embodiments, X is a naturally occurring hydrophilic or hydrophobic amino acid residue or a non-classical amino acid.

In another aspect, the present invention pertains to beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprising an amino acid sequence having at least 70% sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 1 or SEQ ID NO: 3 and one or more of the following mutations of Ambler classification: a hydrophobic residue other than phenylalanine (F) at position 33; a hydrophobic residue other than glutamine (Q) at position 135; a hydrophilic residue other than glycine (G) at position 156; a hydrophobic residue other than alanine (A) at position 232; a hydrophilic residue other than alanine (A) at position 237; a hydrophobic or hydrophilic residue other than alanine (A) at position 238; a hydrophilic residue other than serine (S) at position 240; a hydrophobic residue other than threonine (T) at position 243; a hydrophobic residue other than arginine (R)

at position 244; a hydrophilic residue other than serine (S) at position 266; and a hydrophilic residue other than aspartate (D) at position 276, with the proviso that hydrophilic amino acid residue other than aspartic acid (D) at a position corresponding to position 276 is not present in the context of a single mutant.

As used throughout, a hydrophilic amino acid residue may include a polar and positively charged hydrophilic residue selected from arginine (R) and lysine (K), a polar and neutral of charge hydrophilic residue selected from asparagine (N), glutamine (Q), serine (S), threonine (T), proline (P), and cysteine (C), a polar and negatively charged hydrophilic residue selected from aspartate (D) and glutamate (E), or an aromatic, polar and positively charged hydrophilic including histidine (H). As used throughout, a hydrophobic amino acid residue may include a hydrophobic, aliphatic amino acid selected from glycine (G), alanine (A), leucine (L), isoleucine (I), methionine (M), or valine (V) or a hydrophobic, aromatic amino acid selected from phenylalanine (F), tryptophan (W), or tyrosine (Y).

Mutations may be made to the gene sequence of a beta-lactamase (e.g. SEQ ID NOs: 3 and 4) by reference to the genetic code, including taking into account codon degeneracy.

In some embodiments, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise one or more of the following mutations at positions of Ambler classification: F33Y, Q135M, G156R, A232G, A237S, A238G or T, S240P or D, T243I, R244T, S266N, D276N or R or K, provided that D276N or R or K is not in the context of a single mutant. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise Q135M. In another embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise G156R and A238T. In another embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise F33Y and D276N. In still another embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise F33Y, S240P, and D276N. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise F33Y, A238T, and D276N. In another embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A232G, A237S, A238G, and S240D. In a further embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and R244T. In another embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and D276R. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and D276K. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and Q135M. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A238T. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise T243I, S266N, and D276N. In one embodiment, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and D276N.

In other embodiments, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions comprise an amino acid sequence having at least 70% sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 2 and the following of Ambler classification: a hydrophobic residue other than alanine (A) at position 232; a hydrophilic residue other than alanine (A) at position 237; a hydrophobic residue other than alanine (A) at position 238; a hydrophilic residue other than serine (S) at position 240; and a hydrophilic residue other than aspartate (D) at position 276. In some embodiments, the hydrophobic residue other than alanine (A) at

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position 232 is glycine (G). In some embodiments, the hydrophilic residue other than alanine (A) at position 237 is serine (S). In some embodiments, the hydrophobic residue other than alanine (A) at position 238 is glycine (G). In some embodiments, the hydrophilic residue other than serine (S) at position 240 is aspartate (D). In some embodiments, the other than aspartate (D) at position 276 is asparagine (N). In some embodiments, the beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition comprises one or more of A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and D276N. In some embodiments, the beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition comprises all of A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and D276N, the sequence of which may be SEQ ID NO:5:

SEQ ID NO: 5

EMKDDFAKLEEQFADKLGI FALDTGTNRTVAYRPDERFAFASTIKALTVG
VLLQOKSIEDLNQRITTRDDL VNYNPITEKHVDTGMTLKLADASLRYSD
NAAQNLIKQIGGPESLKKELRKIGDEV TNP EPELNEVNPGETQDTS
TARALVTS LRAFALEDKL PSEKRELLIDW MKRNTTG DALIRAGVPD GWEV
GDKTGS G DYGTRNDIAI IWPPKGPVVLAVLSSRD KDKAKYDNKLIAEAT
KVVMKALNMNGK
or

SEQ ID NO: 6: SEQ ID NO: 5, including the signal and the addition of the QASKT amino acids (the coding region is underlined):

M I Q K R K R T V S F R L V L M C T L L F V S L P
I T K T S A Q A S K T E M K D D F A K L E E Q F D
A K L G I F A L D T G T N R T V A Y R P D E R F A
F A S T I K A L T V G V L L Q Q K S I E D L N Q R
I T Y T R D D L V N Y N P I T E K H V D T G M T L
K E L A D A S L R Y S D N A A Q N L I L K Q I G G
P E S L K K E L R K I G D E V T N P E R F E P E L
N E V N P G E T Q D T S T A R A L V T S L R A F A
L E D K L P S E K R E L L I D W M K R N T T G D A
L I R A G V P D G W E V G D K T G S G D Y G T R N
D I A I I W P P K G D P V V L A V L S S R D K K D
A K Y D N K L I A E A T K V V M K A L N M N G K

The invention also provides for polynucleotides encoding any of the beta-lactamases of the invention, including, for example, vectors, comprising such polynucleotides. Such polynucleotides may further comprise, in addition to sequences encoding the beta-lactamases of the invention, one or more expression control elements. For example, the polynucleotide, may comprise one or more promoters or transcriptional enhancers, ribosomal binding sites, transcription termination signals, and polyadenylation signals, as expression control elements. The polynucleotide may be inserted within any suitable vector, which may be contained within any suitable host cell for expression. An illustrative polynucleotide of the invention is SEQ ID NO: 7:

SEQ ID NO: 7

Full nucleotide sequence of A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D, and D276N mutant, Hind III site (AAGCTT-in bold) and additional K and T amino acids. The leader and additional

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nucleotides (Hind III site and K and T amino acids—for the addition of the amino acid sequence QASKT) are underlined.

5 atgattcaaaaacgaaagcggacagtttcggttcagacttgcgttatgtg
cacgctgttatttgcagtttgccgattacaaaacatcagcgcaagcctt
ccaagacggagatgaaagatgattttgcaaaacttgaggaaacatttgat
10 gcaaaactcgggatctttgcattggatacaggtacaaacggacggttagc
gtatcgccggatgagcggtttgcttttgccttcgacgattaaggctttaa
ctgtaggcggtgcttttgcaacagaaatcaatagaagatctgaaccagaga
15 ataacatatcacgtgatgatcttgtaactacaacccgattacggaaaa
gcacgttgatacgggaatgacgctcaaagagcttgccgatgcttcgcttc
gatatagtgaacatgcggcacagaatctcattcttaacaaattggcgga
cctgaaagtgtgaaaaaggaaactgaggaagattggtgatgaggttacaaa
20 tcccgaacgattcgaaccagagttaaatgaagtgaatccgggtgaaactc
aggataccagtcacagcaagagcacttgctcacaagccttcgagcctttgct
cttgaagataaaactccaagtgaaaaacgcgagcttttaacgattggat
25 gaaacgaaataccactggagacgccttaatccgtgcccgtgtgccggacg
gttgggaagtgggtgataaaactggaagcggagattatggaaccgggaat
gacattgccatcatttgccgcccagagagatcctgctgttcttgcagt
30 attatccagcagggataaaaaggacgccaagtatgataataaacttattg
cagaggcaacaaggtggtaatgaaagccttaacatgaacggcaataa

In some embodiments, the vector can remain episomal or become chromosomally integrated, as long as the insert encoding the therapeutic agent can be transcribed. Vectors can be constructed by standard recombinant DNA technology. Vectors can be, for example, plasmids, phages, cosmids, phagemids, viruses, or any other types known in the art, which are used for replication and expression in prokaryotic or eukaryotic cells (e.g. an adenovirus; a retrovirus; a lentivirus; an scAAV; pGEX vector; pET vector; and pHT vector). It will be appreciated by one of skill in the art that a wide variety of components known in the art (such as expression control elements) may be included in such vectors, including a wide variety of transcription signals, such as promoters and other sequences that regulate the binding of RNA polymerase onto the promoter. Any promoter known to be effective in the cells in which the vector will be expressed can be used to initiate expression of the therapeutic agent. Suitable promoters may be inducible or constitutive. Examples of suitable promoters include the pET system (INVTROGEN), lac promoter, tac, trc, T7, T7A3 promoter, PhoA, lux, and Phage lambda pR, lambda pL promoter (see, e.g. *J Ind Microbiol Biotechnol* (2012) 39:383-399; *Curr Opin Biotech* 2001, 12: 195, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference). The promoter may be inducible (e.g. via IPTG, metabolites, temperature). Examples of suitable promoters include the SV40 early promoter region, the promoter contained in the 3' long terminal repeat of Rous sarcoma virus, the HSV-1 thymidine kinase promoter, the regulatory sequences of the metallothionein gene, etc., as well as the following animal transcriptional control regions, which exhibit tissue specificity and have been utilized in transgenic animals: elastase I gene control region which is active in pancreatic acinar cells; insulin gene control region which is active in pancreatic beta cells, immunoglobulin gene control region which is active in lymphoid cells,

mouse mammary tumor virus control region which is active in testicular, breast, lymphoid and mast cells, albumin gene control region which is active in liver, alpha-fetoprotein gene control region which is active in liver, alpha 1-antitrypsin gene control region which is active in the liver, beta-globin gene control region which is active in erythroid cells, myelin basic protein gene control region which is active in oligodendrocyte cells in the brain, myosin light chain-2 gene control region which is active in skeletal muscle, and gonadotropin releasing hormone gene control region which is active in the hypothalamus.

The invention provides polynucleotides, such as polynucleotides comprising a nucleotide sequence encoding a beta-lactamase of the invention. For example, the nucleotide sequence that encodes a beta-lactamase of the invention. Such polynucleotides may further comprise additional control element(s) operably linked to the nucleotide sequence, such as promoter elements and/or other transcription or expression-related signals. The polynucleotide may be inserted into various vectors, which may be useful for production of the therapeutic agent in host cells, including, for example, bacterial and eukaryotic host cells. The beta-lactamase of the invention can be prepared by known recombinant expression techniques. For example, to recombinantly produce the beta-lactamase of the invention, a nucleic acid sequence encoding the respective gene is operatively linked to a suitable promoter sequence such that the nucleic acid sequence encoding such beta-lactamase of the invention will be transcribed and/or translated in the host cells. Illustrative promoters are those useful for expression in various systems such as the T7 promoter, Pspac, PgroES, Pgsi and Plux and amyQ promoter and/or amyQ signal peptide from *Bacillus amyloliquefaciens* (by way of non-limiting example Gen Bank ID No. J01542.1, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference). Any commonly used expression system may be used, including eukaryotic or prokaryotic systems. Specific examples include yeast (e.g., *Saccharomyces* spp., *Pichia* spp.), baculovirus, mammalian, and bacterial systems, such as *E. coli*, *B. subtilis*, and *Caulobacter*.

Host cells of the present invention include, for example, prokaryotic, eukaryotic, bacterial, yeast, algal, plant, insect, and/or mammalian cells. In some embodiments, the invention encompasses any type of cell that recombinantly expresses genes associated with the invention, including prokaryotic and eukaryotic cells. In some embodiments the cell is a bacterial cell, such as, for example, *Escherichia* spp., *Streptomyces* spp., *Zyomonas* spp., *Acetobacter* spp., *Citrobacter* spp., *Synechocystis* spp., *Rhizobium* spp., *Clostridium* spp., *Corynebacterium* spp., *Streptococcus* spp., *Xanthomonas* spp., *Lactobacillus* spp., *Lactococcus* spp., *Bacillus* spp., *Alcaligenes* spp., *Pseudomonas* spp., *Aeromonas* spp., *Azotobacter* spp., *Comamonas* spp., *Mycobacterium* spp., *Rhodococcus* spp., *Gluconobacter* spp., *Ralstonia* spp., *Acidithiobacillus* spp., *Microlunatus* spp., *Geobacter* spp., *Geobacillus* spp., *Arthrobacter* spp., *Flavobacterium* spp., *Serratia* spp., *Saccharopolyspora* spp., *Thermus* spp., *Stenotrophomonas* spp., *Chromobacterium* spp., *Sinorhizobium* spp., *Saccharopolyspora* spp., *Agrobacterium* spp. and *Pantoea* spp. The bacterial cell can be a Gram-negative cell such as an *Escherichia coli* (*E. coli*) cell, or a Gram-positive cell such as a species of *Bacillus*. In other embodiments, the cell is a fungal cell such as, for example, a yeast cell, e.g., *Saccharomyces* spp., *Schizosaccharomyces* spp., *Pichia* spp., *Paffia* spp., *Kluyveromyces* spp., *Candida* spp., *Talaromyces* spp., *Brettanomyces* spp., *Pachysolen* spp., *Debaryomyces* spp., *Yarrowia* spp., and industrial polyploid yeast strains. The yeast strain may be a *S. cerevisiae* strain or a *Yarrowia*

spp. strain. Other examples of fungi include, for example, *Aspergillus* spp., *Pennicillium* spp., *Fusarium* spp., *Rhizopus* spp., *Acremonium* spp., *Neurospora* spp., *Sordaria* spp., *Magnaporthe* spp., *Allomyces* spp., *Ustilago* spp., *Botrytis* spp., and *Trichoderma* spp. In other embodiments, the cell is an algal cell or a plant cell (e.g., *A. thaliana*, *C. reinhardtii*, *Arthrospira*, *P. tricomutum*, *T. suecica*, *P. carterae*, *P. tricomutum*, *Chlorella* spp., such as *Chlorella vulgaris*). Target cells can include transgenic and recombinant cell lines. In addition, heterologous cell lines can be used, such as Chinese Hamster Ovary cells (CHO). Host cells may be unicellular host cells or multicellular host cells.

In various embodiments, the beta-lactamases of the invention possess functional characteristics that make them desirable for a variety of uses, including therapeutic uses. Methods of characterizing beta-lactamases are known in the art (e.g. nitrocefin assay as described by O'Callaghan, et al. *Antimicrob. Agents Chemother.* 1 :283-288; the various methods of Viswanatha et al. *Methods Mol Med.* 2008;142:239-60).

In one embodiment, the inventive beta-lactamases hydrolyze one or more of penicillins and cephalosporins. As used throughout, penicillins include, for example, Amoxicillin (e.g. NOVAMOX, AMOXIL); Ampicillin (e.g. PRINCIPEN); Azlocillin; Carbenicillin (e.g. GEOCILLIN); Cloxacillin (e.g. TEGOPEN); Dicloxacillin (e.g. DYNAPEN); Flucloxacillin (e.g. FLOXAPEN); Mezlocillin (e.g. MEZLIN); Methicillin (e.g. STAPHICILLIN); Nafcillin (e.g. UNIPEN); Oxacillin (e.g. PROSTAPHLIN); Penicillin G (e.g. PENTIDS or PFIZERPEN); Penicillin V (e.g. VEETIDS (PEN-VEE-K)); Piperacillin (e.g. PIPRACIL); Temocillin (e.g. NEGABAN); and Ticarcillin (e.g. TICAR). As used throughout, cephalosporins include, for example, a first generation cephalosporin (e.g. Cefadroxil (e.g. DURICEF); Cefazolin (e.g. ANCEF); Cefotiozane, Cefalotin/Cefalothin (e.g. KEFLIN); Cefalexin (e.g. KEFLEX); a second generation cephalosporin (e.g. Cefaclor (e.g. DISTACLOX); Cefamandole (e.g. MANDOL); Cefoxitin (e.g. MEFOXIN); Cefprozil (e.g. CEFZIL); Cefuroxime (e.g. CEFTIN, ZINNAT); a third generation cephalosporin (e.g. Cefixime (e.g. SUPRAX); Cefdinir (e.g. OMNICEF, CEFDIEL); Cefditoren (e.g. SPECTRACEF); Cefoperazone (e.g. CEFOTID); Cefotaxime (e.g. CLAFORAN); Cefpodoxime (e.g. VANTIN); Cefazidime (e.g. FORTAZ); Cefibuten (e.g. CEDAX); Cefizoxime (e.g. CEFIZOX); and Ceftriaxone (e.g. ROCEPHIN); a fourth generation cephalosporin (e.g. Cefepime (e.g. MAXIPIME)); or a fifth generation cephalosporin (e.g. Ceftriaxone fosamil (e.g. TEFLARO); Cefetibiprole (e.g. ZEFTERA)). In a specific embodiment, cephalosporins include, for example, cefoperazone, ceftriaxone or cefazolin. In a specific embodiment, the inventive beta-lactamases have improved catalytic efficiency against cephalosporins as compared to SEQ ID NO: 1.

In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess desirable enzyme kinetic characteristics. For example, in some embodiments, the beta-lactamases possess a low K_M for at least one cephalosporin, including, for example, a K_M of less than about 500 μM , or about 100 μM , or about 10 μM , or about 1 μM , or about 0.1 μM (100 nM), or about 0.01 μM (10 nM), or about 1 nM. For example, in some embodiments, the beta-lactamases possess a low K_M for at least one penicillin, including, for example, a K_M of less than about 500 μM , or about 100 μM , or about 10 μM , or about 1 μM , or about 0.1 μM (100 nM), or about 0.01 μM (10 nM), or about 1 nM. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess a high V_{max} for at least one cephalosporin, including, for example, V_{max} which is greater than about 100 s⁻¹, or about 1000 s⁻¹, or about 10000 s⁻¹, or about 100000

s-1, or about 1000000 s-1. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess a high V_{max} for at least one penicillin, including, for example, V_{max} which is greater than about 100 s-1, or about 1000 s-1, or about 10000 s-1, or about 100000 s-1, or about 1000000 s-1. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess catalytic efficiency is greater than about $10^6 \text{ M}^{-1} \text{ s}^{-1}$ for at least one cephalosporin. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess catalytic efficiency is greater than about $10^6 \text{ M}^{-1} \text{ s}^{-1}$ for at least one penicillin. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases possess the desirable enzyme kinetic characteristics for at least one of either or both of cephalosporins and penicillins.

In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases are stable and/or active in the GI tract, e.g. in one or more of the mouth, esophagus, stomach, duodenum, small intestine, duodenum, jejunum, ileum, large intestine, colon transversum, colon descendens, colon ascendens, colon sigmoideum, cecum, and rectum. In a specific embodiment, the beta-lactamase is stable in the large intestine, optionally selected from one or more of colon transversum, colon descendens, colon ascendens, colon sigmoideum and cecum. In a specific embodiment, the beta-lactamase is stable in the small intestine, optionally selected from one or more of duodenum, jejunum, and ileum. In some embodiments, the beta-lactamase is resistant to proteases in the GI tract, including for example, the small intestine. In some embodiments, the beta-lactamase is substantially active at a pH of about 6.0 to about 7.5, e.g. about 6.0, or about 6.1, or about 6.2, or about 6.3, or about 6.4, or about 6.5, or about 6.6, or about 6.7, or about 6.8, or about 6.9, or about 7.0, or about 7.1, or about 7.2, or about 7.3, or about 7.4, or about 7.5 (including, for example, via formulation, as described herein). In various embodiments, the beta-lactamases of the present invention are resistant to one or more beta-lactamase inhibitors, optionally selected from avibactam, tazobactam, sulbactam, and clavulanic acid. In some embodiments, stable refers to an enzyme that has a long enough half life and maintains enough activity for therapeutic effectiveness.

In various embodiments, the present invention pertains to pharmaceutical compositions comprising a beta-lactamase described herein and one or more of and a pharmaceutically acceptable carrier or excipient as described herein. In a specific embodiment, the pharmaceutical composition is formulated for oral administration, e.g. as a tablet or multi-particulate sprinkle or a multi-particulate capsule. However, as described herein, other administration routes and formulations are also provided.

In some embodiments, the pharmaceutical compositions may be used in conjunction with or be co-formulations with an additional agent. In some embodiments, the additional agent is an additional antibiotic degradation enzyme, such as, for example, a beta-lactamase of class EC 3.5.2.6. In some embodiments, the antibiotic degradation enzyme is selected from a functional Group 1, Group 2, Group 3, or a Group 4 beta-lactamase (see, e.g., Bush et al., *Antimicrob. Agents Chemother.* 39: 1211, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference); without wishing to be bound by theory, Group 1 consists of cephalosporinases that are not well inhibited by clavulanic acid; Group 2 consists of penicillinases, cephalosporinases and broad-spectrum beta-lactamases that are generally inhibited by active site-directed beta-lactamase inhibitors; Group 3 consists of metallo-beta-lactamases that hydrolyze penicillins, cephalosporins and carbapenems, and that are poorly inhibited by almost all beta-lactam-containing molecules; and Group 4 consists of penicillinases that are not well inhibited by clavulanic acid) and/or a molecular/Ambler

class A, or class B, or class C, or class D beta-lactamase (see, e.g., Ambler 1980, *Philos Trans R Soc Lond B Biol Sci.* 289: 321 the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference), without wishing to be bound by theory: Classes A, C, and D gather evolutionarily distinct groups of serine beta-lactamase enzymes, and class B the zinc-dependent ("EDTA-inhibited") beta-lactamase enzymes (see Ambler R. P. et al., 1991, *Biochem J.* 276: 269-270, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference). In some embodiments, the antibiotic degradation enzyme is a serine beta-lactamase or a zinc-dependent (EDTA-inhibited) beta-lactamase. For example, in some embodiments, the beta-lactamase is one or more of P1A, P2A, or P3A. Further, the beta-lactamase may be an extended-spectrum beta-lactamase (ESBL), optionally selected from a TEM, SHV, CTX-M, OXA, PER, VEB, GES, and IBC beta-lactamase. Further, the beta-lactamase may be an inhibitor-resistant β -lactamase, optionally selected from an AmpC-type β -lactamases, Carbapenemase, IMP-type carbapenemases (metallo- β -lactamases), VIM (Verona integron-encoded metallo- β -lactamase), OXA (oxacillinase) group of β -lactamases, KPC (*K. pneumoniae* carbapenemase), CMY (Class C), SME, IMI, NMC and CcrA, and a NDM (New Delhi metallo- β -lactamase, e.g. NDM-1) beta-lactamase.

In some embodiments, the additional agent is an adjunctive therapy that is used in, for example, the treatment of CDI as described herein. In some embodiments, the additional agent is metronidazole (e.g. FLAGYL), fidaxomicin (e.g. DIFI-CID), or vancomycin (e.g. Vancocin), rifaximin, fecal bacteriotherapy, charcoal-based binders (e.g. DAV132), probiotic therapy (see, e.g., *Intnat'l J Inf Dis.* 16 (11): e786, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference, illustrative probiotics include *Saccharomyces boulardii*; *Lactobacillus rhamnosus* GG; *Lactobacillus plantarum* 299v; *Clostridium butyricum* M588; *Clostridium difficile* VP20621 (non-toxigenic *C. difficile* strain); combination of *Lactobacillus casei*, *Lactobacillus acidophilus* (Bio-K+CL1285); combination of *Lactobacillus casei*, *Lactobacillus bulgaricus*, *Streptococcus thermophilus* (Actimel); combination of *Lactobacillus acidophilus*, *Bifidobacterium bifidum* (Florajen3); combination of *Lactobacillus acidophilus*, *Lactobacillus bulgaricus delbrueckii* subsp. *bulgaricus*, *Lactobacillus bulgaricus casei*, *Lactobacillus bulgaricus plantarum*, *Bifidobacterium longum*, *Bifidobacterium infantis*, *Bifidobacterium breve*, *Streptococcus salivarius* subsp. *thermophilus* (VSL#3)) and antibody or other biologic therapy (e.g. monoclonal antibodies against *C. difficile* toxins A and B as described in *N Engl J Med.* 2010;362(3):197, the content of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety; neutralizing binding proteins, for example, arranged as multimers, which are directed to one or more of SEQ ID NOs. recited in United States Patent Publication No. 2013/0058962 (e.g. one or more of SEQ ID Nos.: 59, 60, 95, 67, 68, and 87), the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference); or any neutralizing binding protein directed against *C. difficile* binary toxin. In some embodiments, any of the penicillins and cephalosporins described herein may be the additional agent.

For all additional agent compositions and methods, targeting to various parts of the GI tract may be employed as described herein.

In some embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein, include derivatives that are modified, i.e., by the covalent attachment of any type of molecule to the composition such that covalent attachment does not prevent the activity of the composition. For example, but not by way of limitation, derivatives include composition that have been

modified by, inter alia, glycosylation, lipidation, acetylation, pegylation, phosphorylation, amidation, derivatization by known protecting/blocking groups, proteolytic cleavage, linkage to a cellular ligand or other protein, etc. Any of numerous chemical modifications can be carried out by known techniques, including, but not limited to specific chemical cleavage, acetylation, formylation, metabolic synthesis of turicamycin, etc. Additionally, the derivative can contain one or more non-classical amino acids.

In still other embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions described herein may be modified to add effector moieties such as chemical linkers, detectable moieties such as for example fluorescent dyes, enzymes, substrates, bioluminescent materials, radioactive materials, and chemiluminescent moieties, or functional moieties such as for example streptavidin, avidin, biotin, a cytotoxin, a cytotoxic agent, and radioactive materials.

The inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can possess a sufficiently basic functional group, which can react with an inorganic or organic acid, or a carboxyl group, which can react with an inorganic or organic base, to form a pharmaceutically acceptable salt. A pharmaceutically acceptable acid addition salt is formed from a pharmaceutically acceptable acid, as is well known in the art. Such salts include the pharmaceutically acceptable salts listed in, for example, *Journal of Pharmaceutical Science*, 66, 2-19 (1977) and *The Handbook of Pharmaceutical Salts; Properties, Selection, and Use*. P. H. Stahl and C. G. Wermuth (eds.), Verlag, Zurich (Switzerland) 2002, which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

Pharmaceutically acceptable salts include, by way of non-limiting example, sulfate, citrate, acetate, oxalate, chloride, bromide, iodide, nitrate, bisulfate, phosphate, acid phosphate, isonicotinate, lactate, salicylate, acid citrate, tartrate, oleate, tannate, pantothenate, bitartrate, ascorbate, succinate, maleate, gentisinate, fumarate, gluconate, glucuronate, saccharate, formate, benzoate, glutamate, methanesulfonate, ethanesulfonate, benzenesulfonate, p-toluenesulfonate, camphorsulfonate, pamoate, phenylacetate, trifluoroacetate, acrylate, chlorobenzoate, dinitrobenzoate, hydroxybenzoate, methoxybenzoate, methylbenzoate, o-acetoxybenzoate, naphthalene-2-benzoate, isobutyrate, phenylbutyrate, α -hydroxybutyrate, butyne-1,4-dicarboxylate, hexyne-1,4-dicarboxylate, caprate, caprylate, cinnamate, glycollate, heptanoate, hippurate, malate, hydroxymaleate, malonate, mandelate, mesylate, nicotinate, phthalate, teraphthalate, propiolate, propionate, phenylpropionate, sebacate, suberate, p-bromobenzenesulfonate, chlorobenzenesulfonate, ethylsulfonate, 2-hydroxyethylsulfonate, methylsulfonate, naphthalene-1-sulfonate, naphthalene-2-sulfonate, naphthalene-1,5-sulfonate, xylenesulfonate, and tartarate salts.

The term "pharmaceutically acceptable salt" also refers to a salt of the compositions of the present invention having an acidic functional group, such as a carboxylic acid functional group, and a base. Suitable bases include, but are not limited to, hydroxides of alkali metals such as sodium, potassium, and lithium; hydroxides of alkaline earth metal such as calcium and magnesium; hydroxides of other metals, such as aluminum and zinc; ammonia, and organic amines, such as unsubstituted or hydroxy-substituted mono-, di-, or tri-alkylamines, dicyclohexylamine; tributyl amine; pyridine; N-methyl, N-ethylamine; diethylamine; triethylamine; mono-, bis-, or tris-(2-OH-lower alkylamines), such as mono-, bis-, or tris-(2-hydroxyethyl)amine, 2-hydroxy-tert-butylamine, or tris-(hydroxymethyl)methylamine, N,N-di-lower alkyl-N-(hydroxyl-lower alkyl)-amines, such as N,N-dimethyl-N-(2-

hydroxyethyl)amine or tri-(2-hydroxyethyl)amine; N-methyl-D-glucamine; and amino acids such as arginine, lysine, and the like.

In some embodiments, the compositions described herein are in the form of a pharmaceutically acceptable salt.

Further, any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can be administered to a subject as a component of a composition that comprises a pharmaceutically acceptable carrier or vehicle. Such compositions can optionally comprise a suitable amount of a pharmaceutically acceptable excipient so as to provide the form for proper administration.

Pharmaceutical excipients can be liquids, such as water and oils, including those of petroleum, animal, vegetable, or synthetic origin, such as peanut oil, soybean oil, mineral oil, sesame oil and the like. The pharmaceutical excipients can be, for example, saline, gum acacia, gelatin, starch paste, talc, keratin, colloidal silica, urea and the like. In addition, auxiliary, stabilizing, thickening, lubricating, and coloring agents can be used. In one embodiment, the pharmaceutically acceptable excipients are sterile when administered to a subject. Water is a useful excipient when any agent described herein is administered intravenously. Saline solutions and aqueous dextrose and glycerol solutions can also be employed as liquid excipients, specifically for injectable solutions. Suitable pharmaceutical excipients also include starch, glucose, lactose, sucrose, gelatin, malt, rice, flour, chalk, silica gel, sodium stearate, glycerol monostearate, talc, sodium chloride, dried skim milk, glycerol, propylene glycol, water, ethanol and the like. Any agent described herein, if desired, can also comprise minor amounts of wetting or emulsifying agents, or pH buffering agents.

The present invention includes the described inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) in various formulations. Any inventive beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agents) described herein can take the form of solutions, suspensions, emulsion, drops, tablets, pills, pellets, capsules, capsules containing liquids, powders, sustained-release formulations, suppositories, emulsions, aerosols, sprays, suspensions, or any other form suitable for use. In one embodiment, the composition is in the form of a capsule (see, e.g., U.S. Pat. No. 5,698,155). Other examples of suitable pharmaceutical excipients are described in *Remington's Pharmaceutical Sciences* 1447-1676 (Alfonso R. Gennaro eds., 19th ed. 1995), incorporated herein by reference.

Where necessary, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) can also include a solubilizing agent. Also, the agents can be delivered with a suitable vehicle or delivery device as known in the art. Compositions for administration can optionally include a local anesthetic such as, for example, lignocaine to lessen pain at the site of the injection. Combination therapies outlined herein can be co-delivered in a single delivery vehicle or delivery device.

The formulations comprising the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) of the present invention may conveniently be presented in unit dosage forms and may be prepared by any of the methods well known in the art of pharmacy. Such methods generally include the step of bringing the therapeutic agents into association with a carrier, which constitutes one or more accessory ingredients. Typically, the formulations are prepared by uniformly and intimately bringing the therapeutic agent into association with a liquid carrier, a finely divided solid carrier, or both, and then, if necessary, shaping the product into dosage forms of the desired formulation (e.g.,

wet or dry granulation, powder blends, etc., followed by tableting using conventional methods known in the art)

In one embodiment, any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein is formulated in accordance with routine procedures as a composition adapted for a mode of administration described herein.

In some embodiments, the administration of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) is any one of oral, intravenous, and parenteral. In some embodiments, the administration of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) is not intravenous in order to, for example, prevent interference with an antibiotic administered systemically. In other embodiments, routes of administration include, for example: oral, intradermal, intramuscular, intraperitoneal, intravenous, subcutaneous, intranasal, epidural, sublingual, intranasal, intracerebral, intravaginal, transdermal, rectally, by inhalation, or topically, particularly to the ears, nose, eyes, or skin. In some embodiments, the administering is effected orally or by parenteral injection. The mode of administration can be left to the discretion of the practitioner, and depends in-part upon the site of the medical condition. In most instances, administration results in the release of any agent described herein into the bloodstream.

Any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can be administered orally. Such inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) can also be administered by any other convenient route, for example, by intravenous infusion or bolus injection, by absorption through epithelial or mucocutaneous linings (e.g., oral mucosa, rectal and intestinal mucosa, etc.) and can be administered together with an additional agent. Administration can be systemic or local. In some embodiments, administration is not at the site of infection to avoid, for example, hydrolysis of an antibiotic at the site of infection. Various delivery systems are known, e.g., encapsulation in liposomes, microparticles, microcapsules, capsules, etc., and can be used to administer.

In specific embodiments, it may be desirable to administer locally to the area in need of treatment.

In one embodiment, any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein is formulated in accordance with routine procedures as a composition adapted for oral administration to humans. Compositions for oral delivery can be in the form of tablets, lozenges, aqueous or oily suspensions, granules, powders, sprinkles, emulsions, capsules, syrups, or elixirs, for example. Orally administered compositions can comprise one or more agents, for example, sweetening agents such as fructose, aspartame or saccharin; flavoring agents such as peppermint, oil of wintergreen, or cherry; coloring agents; and preserving agents, to provide a pharmaceutically palatable preparation. Moreover, where in tablet or pill form, the compositions can be coated to delay disintegration to provide a sustained action over an extended period of time. Selectively permeable membranes surrounding an osmotically active agent driving any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein are also suitable for orally administered compositions. In these latter platforms, fluid from the environment surrounding the capsule is imbibed by the driving compound, which swells to displace the agent or agent composition through an aperture. These delivery platforms can provide an essentially zero order delivery profile as opposed to the spiked profiles of immediate release formulations. A

time-delay material such as glycerol monostearate or glycerol stearate can also be useful. Oral compositions can include standard excipients such as mannitol, lactose, starch, magnesium stearate, sodium saccharin, cellulose, ethacrylic acid and derivative polymers thereof, and magnesium carbonate. In one embodiment, the excipients are of pharmaceutical grade. Suspensions, in addition to the active compounds, may contain suspending agents such as, for example, ethoxylated isostearyl alcohols, polyoxyethylene sorbitol and sorbitan esters, microcrystalline cellulose, aluminum metahydroxide, bentonite, agar-agar, tragacanth, etc., and mixtures thereof.

Dosage forms suitable for parenteral administration (e.g. intravenous, intramuscular, intraperitoneal, subcutaneous and intra-articular injection and infusion) include, for example, solutions, suspensions, dispersions, emulsions, and the like. They may also be manufactured in the form of sterile solid compositions (e.g. lyophilized composition), which can be dissolved or suspended in sterile injectable medium immediately before use. They may contain, for example, suspending or dispersing agents known in the art.

Inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) may be administered to a subject, by, for example, directly or indirectly contacting the mucosal tissues of the gastrointestinal tract. The gastrointestinal tract includes organs of the digestive system such as mouth, esophagus, stomach, duodenum, small intestine, large intestine and rectum and includes all subsections thereof (e.g. the small intestine may include the duodenum, jejunum and ileum; the large intestine may include the colon transversum, colon descendens, colon ascendens, colon sigmoidum and cecum). Various methods may be used to formulate and/or deliver the agents described herein to a location of interest. For example, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein may be formulated for delivery to one or more of the stomach, small intestine, large intestine and rectum and includes all subsections thereof (e.g. duodenum, jejunum and ileum, colon transversum, colon descendens, colon ascendens, colon sigmoidum and cecum). In some embodiments, the compositions described herein may be formulated to deliver to the upper or lower GI tract.

In some embodiments, the compositions of the invention are formulated for enteric delivery. For example, the compositions may be formulated as capsules or tablets for oral delivery, and may comprise a delayed-release coating containing one or more enteric agents. A delayed-release coating is substantially stable in gastric fluid and substantially unstable (e.g., dissolves rapidly or is physically unstable) in intestinal fluid, thus providing for substantial release of the active agent from the composition in the affected region of the small intestine, e.g., the duodenum, the jejunum, and/or the ileum or large intestine, e.g. the colon transversum, colon descendens, colon ascendens, colon sigmoidum and cecum.

The inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) are generally stable in gastric fluid or simulated intestinal fluid, that is, the compositions are stable in acidic environments. Thus, the compositions release less than 30% by weight of the active agent in gastric fluid with a pH of 5 or less, or simulated gastric fluid with a pH of 5 or less, in approximately 120 minutes. Compositions of the invention may release from about 0% to about 25%, or from about 0% to about 10% by weight of the active agent in gastric fluid with a pH of 5 or less, or simulated gastric fluid with a pH of 5 or less, in approximately 120 minutes. Compositions of the invention in certain embodiments release no more than about 1%, about 2%, about 3%,

about 4%, about 5%, about 6%, about 7%, about 8%, about 9%, or about 10% by weight of the active agent in gastric fluid, or simulated gastric fluid with a pH of 5 or less, in approximately 120 minutes. The pharmaceutical compositions generally release active agent to act locally at regions of the small or large intestine. In certain embodiments, the composition of the invention release about 70% or more by weight of the active agent in the small or large intestine within about 120 minutes. In certain embodiments, the composition releases 80% or more, or 90% or more, of the active agent in small or large intestine, within about ninety minutes or within about 120 minutes. In certain embodiments this release in the small or large intestine is mediated by pH of gastric fluid or simulated gastric fluid—for example, a release when the pH of about 5 or greater (e.g. pH of about 5.5–6.5 for release in the duodenum, pH of about 6–7 for release in the colon ascendens or jejunum, pH of about 6.5–7 for release in the ileum, pH of about 7–7.5 for release in the colon descendens).

The pharmaceutical composition may control intestinal release of the active agent through one or more delayed-release coating(s), which remain essentially intact, and/or which may be essentially insoluble, in gastric fluid. The stability of the delayed-release coating can be pH dependent. Delayed-release coatings that are pH dependent will be substantially stable in acidic environments (pH 5 or less), and substantially unstable in near neutral to alkaline environments (pH greater than 5). For example, the delayed-release coating may essentially disintegrate or dissolve in near neutral to alkaline environments, such as are found in the small intestine or large intestine, to thereby release active agent locally to diseased or affected tissue.

Examples of simulated gastric fluid and simulated intestinal fluid include, but are not limited to, those disclosed in the 2005 Pharmacopeia 23NF/28USP in Test Solutions at page 2858 and/or other simulated gastric fluids and simulated intestinal fluids known to those of skill in the art, for example, simulated gastric fluid and/or intestinal fluid prepared without enzymes.

Alternatively, the stability of the delayed-release coating may be enzyme-dependent. Delayed-release coatings that are enzyme dependent will be substantially stable in fluid that does not contain a particular enzyme and substantially unstable in fluid containing the enzyme. The delayed-release coating will essentially disintegrate or dissolve in fluid containing the appropriate enzyme. Enzyme-dependent control can be brought about, for example, by using materials which release the active ingredient only on exposure to enzymes in the intestine, such as galactomannans.

In some embodiments, the target organ for the release of the active agent from the compositions of the invention, which include gastric resistant capsules or tablets, is the small intestine, such as the duodenum and the jejunum or the large intestine, e.g. the colon transversum, colon descendens, colon ascendens, colon sigmoidum and cecum. See Remington's Pharmaceutical Sciences, 16th Ed., Eds. Osol, Mack Publishing Co., Chapter 89 (1980); Digenis et al., *J. Pharm. Sci.*, 83:915-921 (1994); Vantini et al., *Clinica Terapeutica*, 145: 445-451 (1993); Yoshitomi et al., *Chem. Pharm. Bull.*, 40:1902-1905 (1992); Thoma et al., *Pharmazie*, 46:331-336 (1991); Morishita et al., *Drug Design and Delivery*, 7:309-319 (1991); and Lin et al., *Pharmaceutical Res.*, 8:919-924 (1991) for examples of the preparation of such tablets or capsules (the contents of the above are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety).

In some embodiments, the compositions of the present invention may be formulated using the EUDRAGIT system,

as known in the art and described in *Pharma Polymer* No. 7, October 2000, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

The dosage of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein as well as the dosing schedule can depend on various parameters, including, but not limited to, the disease being treated, the subject's general health, and the administering physician's discretion. Any agent described herein, can be administered prior to (e.g., 5 minutes, 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 45 minutes, 1 hour, 2 hours, 4 hours, 6 hours, 12 hours, 24 hours, 48 hours, 72 hours, 96 hours, 1 week, 2 weeks, 3 weeks, 4 weeks, 5 weeks, 6 weeks, 8 weeks, or 12 weeks before), concurrently with, or subsequent to (e.g., 5 minutes, 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 45 minutes, 1 hour, 2 hours, 4 hours, 6 hours, 12 hours, 24 hours, 48 hours, 72 hours, 96 hours, 1 week, 2 weeks, 3 weeks, 4 weeks, 5 weeks, 6 weeks, 8 weeks, or 12 weeks after) the administration of an additional therapeutic agent, to a subject in need thereof. In various embodiments any agent described herein is administered 1 minute apart, 10 minutes apart, 30 minutes apart, less than 1 hour apart, 1 hour apart, 1 hour to 2 hours apart, 2 hours to 3 hours apart, 3 hours to 4 hours apart, 4 hours to 5 hours apart, 5 hours to 6 hours apart, 6 hours to 7 hours apart, 7 hours to 8 hours apart, 8 hours to 9 hours apart, 9 hours to 10 hours apart, 10 hours to 11 hours apart, 11 hours to 12 hours apart, no more than 24 hours apart or no more than 48 hours apart.

The amount of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein that is admixed with the carrier materials to produce a single dosage can vary depending upon the subject being treated and the particular mode of administration. In vitro or in vivo assays can be employed to help identify optimal dosage ranges.

In general, the doses that are useful are known to those in the art. For example, doses may be determined with reference *Physicians' Desk Reference*, 66th Edition, PDR Network; 2012 Edition (Dec. 27, 2011), the contents of which are incorporated by reference in its entirety. In some embodiment, the present invention allows a patient to receive doses that exceed those determined with reference *Physicians' Desk Reference*.

The dosage of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can depend on several factors including the severity of the condition, whether the condition is to be treated or prevented, and the age, weight, and health of the subject to be treated. Additionally, pharmacogenomic (the effect of genotype on the pharmacokinetic, pharmacodynamic or efficacy profile of a therapeutic) information about a particular subject may affect dosage used. Furthermore, the exact individual dosages can be adjusted somewhat depending on a variety of factors, including the specific combination of the agents being administered, the time of administration, the route of administration, the nature of the formulation, the rate of excretion, the particular disease being treated, the severity of the disorder, and the anatomical location of the disorder. Some variations in the dosage can be expected.

In specific embodiments, the concentration of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) is about 0.2 to about 20 g/L when administered orally or about 4 g/mL when administered intravenously.

In some embodiments, when orally administered to a mammal, the dosage of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents)

described herein may be about 0.001 mg/kg/day to about 100 mg/kg/day, about 0.01 mg/kg/day to about 50 mg/kg/day, or about 0.1 mg/kg/day to about 10 mg/kg/day. When orally administered to a human, the dosage of any agent described herein is normally about 0.001 mg to 1000 mg per day, about 1 mg to about 600 mg per day, or about 5 mg to about 30 mg per day. In one embodiment, 100 mg per day of the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions is administered orally to a human. For administration of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein by parenteral injection, the dosage is normally about 0.1 mg to about 250 mg per day, about 1 mg to about 20 mg per day, or about 3 mg to about 5 mg per day. Injections may be given up to four times daily. Generally, when orally or parenterally administered, the dosage of any agent described herein is normally about 0.1 mg to about 1500 mg per day, or about 0.5 mg to about 10 mg per day, or about 0.5 mg to about 5 mg per day. A dosage of up to about 3000 mg per day can be administered. In some embodiments, the dose may be about 1000 mg per day. In some embodiments, the following dose regimen can be used: 100 mg, four times a day.

In various embodiments, the dosage of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein is administered to achieve an intestinal concentration of from about 1 ng/ml to about 10,000 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 5,000 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 2,500 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 1,000 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 500 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 250 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 100 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 50 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 25 ng/ml, about 1 ng/ml to about 10 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 10,000 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 5,000 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 2,500 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 1,000 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 500 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 250 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 100 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 50 ng/ml, about 10 ng/ml to about 25 ng/ml, about 100 ng/ml to about 10,000 ng/ml, about 100 ng/ml to about 5,000 ng/ml, about 100 ng/ml to about 2,500 ng/ml, about 100 ng/ml to about 1,000 ng/ml, about 100 ng/ml to about 500 ng/ml, or about 100 ng/ml to about 250 ng/ml. In various embodiments, the intestinal concentration of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein is 10 ng/ml, 100 ng/ml, or 1,000 ng/ml.

In another embodiment, delivery can be in a vesicle, in particular a liposome (see Langer, 1990, *Science* 249:1527-1533; Treat et al., in *Liposomes in the Therapy of Infectious Disease and Cancer*, Lopez-Berestein and Fidler (eds.), Liss, New York, pp. 353-365 (1989).

Any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can be administered by controlled-release or sustained-release means or by delivery devices that are well known to those of ordinary skill in the art. Examples include, but are not limited to, those described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 3,845,770; 3,916,899; 3,536,809; 3,598,123; 4,008,719; 5,674,533; 5,059,595; 5,591,767; 5,120,548; 5,073,543; 5,639,476; 5,354,556; and 5,733,556, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety. Such dosage forms can be useful for providing controlled- or sustained-release of one or more active ingredients using, for example, hydropropyl cellulose, hydropropylmethyl cellulose, polyvinylpyrrolidone, other polymer matrices, gels, permeable membranes, osmotic systems, multilayer coatings, microparticles, liposomes, microspheres, or a combination thereof to provide the desired release profile in varying proportions. Suitable controlled- or sustained-release

formulations known to those skilled in the art, including those described herein, can be readily selected for use with the active ingredients of the agents described herein. The invention thus provides single unit dosage forms suitable for oral administration such as, but not limited to, tablets, capsules, gels, and caplets that are adapted for controlled- or sustained-release.

Controlled- or sustained-release of an active ingredient can be stimulated by various conditions, including but not limited to, changes in pH, changes in temperature, stimulation by an appropriate wavelength of light, concentration or availability of enzymes, concentration or availability of water, or other physiological conditions or compounds.

In another embodiment, polymeric materials can be used (see *Medical Applications of Controlled Release*, Langer and Wise (eds.), CRC Pres., Boca Raton, Fla. (1974); *Controlled Drug Bioavailability, Drug Product Design and Performance*, Smolen and Ball (eds.), Wiley, New York (1984); Ranger and Peppas, 1983, *J. Macromol. Sci. Rev. Macromol. Chem.* 23:61; see also Levy et al., 1985, *Science* 228:190; During et al., 1989, *Ann. Neurol.* 25:351; Howard et al., 1989, *J. Neurosurg.* 71:105).

In another embodiment, a controlled-release system can be placed in proximity of the target area to be treated, thus requiring only a fraction of the systemic dose (see, e.g., Goodson, in *Medical Applications of Controlled Release*, supra, vol. 2, pp. 115-138 (1984)). Other controlled-release systems discussed in the review by Langer, 1990, *Science* 249:1527-1533) may be used.

Administration of any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can, independently, be one to six times daily (e.g. 1, or 2, or 3, or 4, or 5, or 6 times per day) or one to four times per month or one to six times per year or once every two, three, four or five years. Administration can be for the duration of one day or one month, two months, three months, six months, one year, two years, three years, and may even be for the life of the subject. Chronic, long-term administration will be indicated in many cases. The dosage may be administered as a single dose or divided into multiple doses. In general, the desired dosage should be administered at set intervals for a prolonged period, usually at least over several weeks or months, although longer periods of administration of several months or years or more may be needed.

The dosage regimen utilizing any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can be selected in accordance with a variety of factors including type, species, age, weight, sex and medical condition of the subject; the severity of the condition to be treated; the route of administration; the renal or hepatic function of the subject; the pharmacogenomic makeup of the individual; and the specific compound of the invention employed. Any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can be administered in a single daily dose, or the total daily dosage can be administered in divided doses of two, three or four times daily. Furthermore, any inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) described herein can be administered continuously rather than intermittently throughout the dosage regimen.

In various aspects, the present invention provides methods for treating or preventing an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein to a patient in need thereof. In one aspect, the present invention provides methods

for preventing an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein to a patient in need thereof (by way of non-limiting example, a patient that is being administered or will be administered an antibiotic, including those described herein). In various aspects, the present invention provides methods for treating or preventing *C. difficile* infection (CDI) and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein to a patient in need thereof. In one aspect, the present invention provides methods for preventing *C. difficile* infection (CDI) and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein to a patient in need thereof (by way of non-limiting example, a patient that is being administered or will be administered an antibiotic, including those described herein).

In various embodiments, the antibiotic-induced adverse effect and/or CDI or *C. difficile*-associated disease is one or more of: antibiotic-associated diarrhea, *C. difficile* diarrhea (CDD), *C. difficile* intestinal inflammatory disease, colitis, pseudomembranous colitis, fever, abdominal pain, dehydration and disturbances in electrolytes, megacolon, peritonitis, and perforation and/or rupture of the colon.

In various aspects, the present invention provides methods for protecting a subject's gastrointestinal microbiome, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein. In various embodiments, the subject is undergoing treatment or has recently undergone treatment with an antibiotic. In various embodiments, the beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein is capable of degrading or inactivating the antibiotic.

In various embodiments, the subjects include, but are not limited to, subjects that are at a particular risk for a microbiome-mediated disorder, such as, by way of non-limiting example, those undergoing treatment or having recently undergone treatment with an antibiotic. For example, the subject may have taken an antibiotic during the past about 30 or so days and/or have an immune system that is weak (e.g. from a chronic illness) and/or is a woman and/or is elderly (e.g. over about 65 years old) and/or is an elderly woman and/or is undergoing (or has undergone) treatment with for heartburn or stomach acid disorders (e.g. with agents such as PREVACID, TAGAMET, PRILOSEC, or NEXIUM and related drugs) and/or has recently been in the hospital, including in an intensive care unit, or lives in a nursing home. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention treat or prevent a nosocomial infection and/or a secondary emergent infection and/or a hospital acquired infection (HAI).

In various embodiments, the methods of the invention comprise treating or preventing a microbiome-mediated disorder. Illustrative microbiome-mediated disorder includes, but are not limited to, for example, those found in Table 3 of WO 2014/121298, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference. For example, the microbiome-mediated disorder may be selected from an antibiotic-induced adverse effect, a *C. difficile* infection (CDI), a *C. difficile*-associated disease, ulcerative colitis, Crohn's disease, and irritable bowel syndrome. In various embodiments, the microbiome-mediated disorder is an antibiotic-induced adverse effect, a *C. difficile* infection (CDI), or a *C. difficile*-

associated disease. In an embodiment, the present invention provides methods for treating an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein to a subject who is undergoing treatment or has recently undergone treatment with an antibiotic. In another embodiment, the present invention provides methods for preventing an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase and/or pharmaceutical composition (and/or additional agent) described herein to a subject who is undergoing treatment or has recently undergone treatment with an antibiotic.

In various embodiments, the present uses and methods pertain to co-treatment (simultaneously or sequentially) with the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the present invention and any additional agent described herein and/or any initial and/or adjunctive therapy, or treatment with a co-formulation of the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the present invention and any additional agent described herein and/or any initial and/or adjunctive therapy for treatment of the various diseases described herein, or methods of treating the various diseases described herein in a patient undergoing treatment with any additional agent described herein and/or any initial and/or adjunctive therapy described herein by administering a beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the present invention to the patient.

In various embodiments, the CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease is treated or prevented in the context of initial onset or relapse/recurrence (e.g. due to continued or restarted antibiotic therapy). For example, in a patient that has previously suffered from CDI, the present beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) may be administered upon the first symptoms of recurrence. By way of non-limiting example, symptoms of recurrence include, in a mild case, about 5 to about 10 watery bowel movements per day, no significant fever, and only mild abdominal cramps while blood tests may show a mild rise in the white blood cell count up to about 15,000 (normal levels are up to about 10,000), and, in a severe case, more than about 10 watery stools per day, nausea, vomiting, high fever (e.g. about 102-104° F.), rectal bleeding, severe abdominal pain (e.g. with tenderness), abdominal distention, and a high white blood count (e.g. of about 15,000 to about 40,000).

Regardless of initial onset or relapse/recurrence, CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease may be diagnosed via any of the symptoms described herein (e.g. watery diarrhea about 3 or more times a day for about 2 days or more, mild to bad cramping and pain in the belly, fever, blood or pus in the stool, nausea, dehydration, loss of appetite, loss of weight, etc.). Regardless of initial onset or relapse/recurrence, CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease may also be diagnosed via enzyme immunoassays e.g. to detect the *C. difficile* toxin A or B antigen and/or glutamine dehydrogenase (GDH), which is produced by *C. difficile* organisms), polymerase chain reaction (e.g. to detect the *C. difficile* toxin A or B gene or a portion thereof (e.g. tcdA or tcdB), including the ILLUMIGENE LAMP assay), a cell cytotoxicity assay. For example, any one of the following tests may be used may be used: Meridian ImmunoCard Toxins A/B; Wampole Toxin A/B Quik Chek; Wampole *C. diff* Quik Chek Complete; Remel Xpect *Clostridium difficile* Toxin A/B; Meridian Premier Toxins A/B; Wampole *C. difficile* Tox A/B II; Remel Prospect Toxin A/B EIA; Biomerieux Vidas *C. difficile* Toxin A&B; BD

Geneohm *C. diff*; Prodesse Progestro CD; and Cepheid Xpert *C. diff*. In various embodiments, the clinical sample is a patient stool sample.

Also a flexible sigmoidoscopy “scope” test and/or an abdominal X-ray and/or a computerized tomography (CT) scan, which provides images of your colon, may be used in assessing a patient (e.g. looking for characteristic creamy white or yellow plaques adherent to the wall of the colon). Further, biopsies (e.g. of any region of the GI tract) may be used to assess a potential CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease patient.

Furthermore, the patients of the invention include, but are not limited to, patients that are at a particular risk for CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease, such as those which have been taking an antibiotic during the past 30 or so days and/or have an immune system that is weak (e.g. from a chronic illness) and/or are women and/or are elderly (e.g. over about 65 years old) and/or are elderly woman and/or undergo treatment with for heartburn or stomach acid disorders (e.g. with agents such as PREVACID, TAGAMET, PRILOSEC, or NEXIUM and related drugs) and/or have recently been in the hospital, including in an intensive care unit, or live in a nursing home. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention treat or prevent a nosocomial infection and/or a secondary emergent infection and/or a hospital acquired infection (HAI).

In some embodiments, the methods of the invention treat or prevent a ceftriaxone-associated adverse effect (e.g. diarrhea, nausea, vomiting, dysgeusia, and pseudomembranous colitis disease and/or symptoms).

In some embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention relate to a patient is undergoing treatment or has recently undergone treatment with one or more primary antibiotic. A “primary antibiotic” refers to an antibiotic that is administered to a patient and which may result in CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease. These include the antibiotics that most often lead to CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease: fluoroquinolones, cephalosporins, clindamycin and penicillins.

In some embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention relate to the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) which hydrolyze a primary antibiotic before it enters the large intestine. In some embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention relate to the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) which hydrolyze excess antibiotic residue in the GI tract. In some embodiments, methods and uses of the present invention relate to the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) which maintain a normal intestinal microbiota and/or prevents the overgrowth of one or more pathogenic microorganisms in the GI tract of a patient. In various embodiments, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) do not substantially interfere with plasma levels of a primary antibiotic. For example, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) of the present invention allow for a patient to receive a primary antibiotic that might be required for an infection and do not interfere with the systemic utility of the antibiotic. Rather, the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) inactivate excess antibiotic that may populate parts of the GI tract and in doing so, prevent the disruption of the microbiota that is linked to the various disease states described herein.

In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional

agents) are not systemically absorbed. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) do not substantially interfere with the activity of systemically administered antibiotics. In various embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) function to eliminate antibiotics from interfering with the microbiota of a microbiome (e.g. the gut, including the large intestine). In some embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) do not interfere with the antibiotic absorption from the gut and/or enterohepatically sufficiently to alter the half-lives of antibiotic circulation. In some embodiments, the inventive beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) do not interfere with the antibiotic absorption from the gut and/or enterohepatically enough to be clinically important.

In some embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention include those in which an initial and/or adjunctive therapy is administered to a patient. Initial and/or adjunctive therapy indicates therapy that is used to treat CDI and/or *C. difficile* associated disease upon detection of such disease. In some embodiments, the initial and/or adjunctive therapy is one or more of metronidazole, vancomycin, fidaxomicin, rifaximin, fecal bacteriotherapy, probiotic therapy, and antibody therapy, as described herein. In various embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention include use of the inventive beta-lactamases as an adjuvant to any of these initial and/or adjunctive therapies (including co-administration or sequential administration). In various embodiments, the methods and uses of the present invention include use of the inventive beta-lactamases in a patient undergoing initial and/or adjunctive therapies.

In other aspects, the present invention provides the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions for use in treating an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract and/or prevention or treatment of *C. difficile* infection (CDI) and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease. In other aspects, there are provided uses of the beta-lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions for treating an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract and/or preventing or treating a *C. difficile* infection (CDI) and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease. Further, some aspects provide for the use of the disclosed beta-lactamases in the manufacture of a medicament for use in treating an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract and/or prevention or treatment of *C. difficile* infection (CDI) and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease.

In various embodiments, the present invention provides for compositions and methods that mitigate or prevent the overgrowth of various coliforms in a patient’s gut (including coliforms that are virulent and/or antibiotic resistant). In various aspects, the methods and compositions described herein prevent or diminish secondary infections with resistant organisms and may, in some embodiments, diminish beta-lactam resistance development. Further, the methods and compositions described herein may allow for use of beta-lactam antibiotics which are currently avoided due to resistance concerns and/or reduce the need for co-administration or co-formulation with one or more beta-lactamase inhibitors (e.g. AUGMENTIN is a mixture of amoxicillin and clavulanic acid).

In some embodiments, the terms “patient” and “subject” are used interchangeably. In some embodiments, the subject and/or animal is a mammal, e.g., a human, mouse, rat, guinea pig, dog, cat, horse, cow, pig, rabbit, sheep, or non-human primate, such as a monkey, chimpanzee, or baboon. In other embodiments, the subject and/or animal is a non-mammal,

such, for example, a zebrafish. In some embodiments, the subject and/or animal may comprise fluorescently-tagged cells (with e.g. GFP). In some embodiments, the subject and/or animal is a transgenic animal comprising a fluorescent cell.

In some embodiments, the subject and/or animal is a human. In some embodiments, the human is a pediatric human. In other embodiments, the human is an adult human. In other embodiments, the human is a geriatric human. In other embodiments, the human may be referred to as a patient.

In certain embodiments, the human has an age in a range of from about 6 to about 18 months old, from about 18 to about 36 months old, from about 1 to about 5 years old, from about 5 to about 10 years old, from about 10 to about 15 years old, from about 15 to about 20 years old, from about 20 to about 25 years old, from about 25 to about 30 years old, from about 30 to about 35 years old, from about 35 to about 40 years old, from about 40 to about 45 years old, from about 45 to about 50 years old, from about 50 to about 55 years old, from about 55 to about 60 years old, from about 60 to about 65 years old, from about 65 to about 70 years old, from about 70 to about 75 years old, from about 75 to about 80 years old, from about 80 to about 85 years old, from about 85 to about 90 years old, from about 90 to about 95 years old or from about 95 to about 100 years old.

In other embodiments, the subject is a non-human animal, and therefore the invention pertains to veterinary use. In a specific embodiment, the non-human animal is a household pet. In another specific embodiment, the non-human animal is a livestock animal.

The invention provides kits that can simplify the administration of any agent described herein. An exemplary kit of the invention comprises any composition described herein in unit dosage form. In one embodiment, the unit dosage form is a container, such as a pre-filled syringe, which can be sterile, containing any agent described herein and a pharmaceutically acceptable carrier, diluent, excipient, or vehicle. The kit can further comprise a label or printed instructions instructing the use of any agent described herein. The kit may also include a lid speculum, topical anesthetic, and a cleaning agent for the administration location. The kit can also further comprise one or more additional agent described herein. In one embodiment, the kit comprises a container containing an effective amount of a composition of the invention and an effective amount of another composition, such those described herein.

This invention is further illustrated by the following non-limiting examples.

EXAMPLES

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

Mutations relative to P1A (based on the Ambler classification)	Name
Wild type	RS310 (or P1A)
D276N	IS118 (or P3A)
I72S	IS222
T160F	IS203
R244T	IS217
R244T D276K	IS215
Q135M	IS197
G156R A238T	IS235
F33Y D276N	IS158
F33Y S240P D276N	IS230 (or IS181)
F33Y A238T D276N	IS232 (or IS180)
I72S Q135M T160F (Block 1 mutants)	IS227
A232G A237S A238G S240D (Block 2 mutants)	IS191

-continued

Mutations relative to P1A (based on the Ambler classification)	Name
A232G A237S A238G S240D R244T	IS229
A232G A237S A238G S240D D276R	IS219
A232G A237S A238G S240D D276K	IS221
A232G A237S A238G S240D Q135M	IS224
A238T	IS233
T243I S266N D276N	IS234 (or IS176)
A232G A237S A238G S240D D276N	IS288 (or P4A)

Example 1

Materials and Methods

Different P1A mutants were made either with site-directed mutagenesis using SOE or QUIKCHANGE Multi Site-Directed Mutagenesis Kit (Stratagene, Calif., USA) or with random mutagenesis using GeneMorph® II Random Mutagenesis Kit (Stratagene, Calif., USA). Mutated DNA was transformed into bacteria, either *E. coli* or *B. subtilis*, which were screened on cefotaxime (site-directed mutants) or ceftriaxone (random mutants). The presence of β -lactamase in colonies was further confirmed with a nitrocefin test and the positive colonies were selected for further analysis. The DNA sequences of the mutant β -lactamases were confirmed by sequencing.

β -lactamase activity of the mutants was further characterized from *E. coli* cell lysates and *B. subtilis* growth supernatant with ampicillin, cefotaxime, ceftriaxone, cefuroxime, ceftazidime, meropenem and imipenem. The activities were determined using only one substrate concentration of each antibiotic tested. Selection of the antibiotic concentration was done with the antibiotic concentration as high as was practical, $[S] \gg K_m$. Based on these preliminary experiments, more accurate kinetic parameters were determined for a couple of mutants from both the site-directed and the random mutagenesis research lines. All the mutant enzymes selected for more detailed study were expressed in the *B. subtilis* host strain RS303. The cells carrying the mutated proteins were grown in minimal medium over-night after which the cells were harvested and the supernatant was concentrated in 1:10 with Amicon Ultra-4 centrifugal devices, MWCO 10000 (Amicon). Protein concentration in each culture supernatant was estimated from 12% SDS-PAGE (Criterion XT Bis-Tris, Bio-Rad, Calif., USA) using the P1A reference material A18K31 as a standard. Kinetic parameters were measured for cefotaxime, ceftriaxone and cefuroxime for each selected mutant strain. The site-directed mutants were designed to hydrolyze cefotaxime and random mutants were screened with ceftriaxone, which made these antibiotics natural choices for determining kinetic parameters.

P1A Modifications

A series of mutations in P1A were made, including:

TABLE 1

Mutations on P1A from structure-based design and construction of cefotaxime degrading P1A derivatives,	
Block 1	I72S, Q135M, T160F
Block 2	A232, A237S, A238G, S240D
	R244T
	D276R/K
	and different combinations of these

Parallel to the site-directed mutagenesis, random mutagenesis was done on P1A and P3A with ceftriaxone as a screening antibiotic.

There are also two modification mutants of P1A that were made for the quality control studies: P1A-N293D (IS205, “the deamidation mutant”) and P1A-ΔMNGK (IS206, “the deletion mutant”). Both of these strains grew equally well as P1A-strain RS310 and the protein production was about the same as well. These mutations did not affect the crystallizability of the protein either.

Sequences of selected CTX-M-enzymes were derived from Swiss-Prot protein sequence data bank and the 3D structures were derived from the Protein Data Bank (PDB). Accession codes for individual sequences and structures are represented below. In some instances, this data was used to predict structure functional activity.

Illustrative Swiss-Prot or TrEMBL, GenBank and Protein Data Bank (PDB) accession codes for enzymes used in the study.

	Swiss-Prot/ TrEMBL	GenBank	PDB
CTX-M-9	Q9L5C8_ECOLI (TrEMBL)	AF174129	1YLJ
CTX-M-14	Q9L5C7_ECOLI (TrEMBL)	AF252622	1YLT
CTX-M-15	Q9EXV5_ECOLI (TrEMBL)	AY044436	—
CTX-M-16	Q939K2_KLEPN (TrEMBL)	AY029068	1YLW
CTX-M-25	Q8KSA6_ECOLI (TrEMBL)	AF518567	—
CTX-M-44	Q47066 (Swiss-Prot)	D37839	1IYO

A Linux workstation and Fedora Core 5 operating system was used as the study platform. The sequence alignments and analysis as well as the modelling and 3D structure analysis were performed with Bodil molecular modelling environment.

Additionally, several other P1A mutants were designed and made. One of these mutants was IS288, which has following mutations: A232G, A237S, A238G, A240S and D276N. The four mutations A232G, A237S, A238G and A240S are a so-called “Block2”-mutation. The fifth mutant, D276N, is the “P3A”-mutation, which alone gives the protein’s ability to degrade ceftriaxone. The P1A variant IS288 was a result of two rounds of mutagenesis on the P1A gene and preliminary activity assays of secreted P1A variants. Several P1A variants made by site-directed mutagenesis were cloned into the *B. subtilis* production host and produced in shaker flask cultivations. The growth supernatants of these mutant strains were concentrated and used to measure each of the strains’ ability to degrade selected cephalosporins. IS288 was produced in larger scale and purified using ammonium sulphate precipitation, hydrophobic interaction chromatography and ultra filtration. The study was set up to characterize the selected P1A variant IS288 in more detail.

In addition to purifying with HIC, methods were developed to further desalt and characterize the amount and purity of protein in the eluted protein peak.

Hydrophobic interaction chromatography, i.e. HIC, is a method, where the separation of bio-molecules is based on interplay between the hydrophobicity of the medium, the nature and composition of the sample, the prevalence and distribution of surface-exposed hydrophobic amino acid residues, and the type and concentration of salt in the binding buffer. The adsorption of protein into the gel matrix is dependent on the concentration of anti-chaotropic salts such as $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ and Na_2SO_4 ; the higher the salt concentration the stronger the adsorption capacity of the HIC medium. The HIC matrix can have different types of hydrophobic substituents,

like butyl, octyl, or phenyl groups. Butyl sepharose was selected as the HIC matrix as P1A binds tightly to octyl sepharose that it is not properly eluted.

IS288 Purification Procedure:

The first day, a small amount of a frozen IS288 *Bacillus subtilis* cell culture was streaked on a LB-agar plate containing 10 $\mu\text{g/ml}$ kanamycin. The following morning single cultures were taken from this plate and inoculated into 10 $\times$ 3 ml of minimal growth medium for shaker flask cultivation. In the afternoon of the same day, a volume resulting in a 0.01 starting OD₆₀₀ in the 100 ml overnight (o/n) culture was taken from the 3 ml pre-culture. The 100 ml cultures were incubated in a shaker at +37° C. over night. From a couple of 3 ml pre-cultures OD₆₀₀=1 glycerol stocks (10% glycerol) were made. The glycerol stocks were stored at -70° C.

On the third day after ~16 hours of cultivation, the final OD₆₀₀ of the shaker flask cultivations were measured and cells were centrifuged (Sorvall RC6) with SLA-3000 rotor, 7000 rpm, 10 minutes at +4° C.). Culture supernatants were collected and combined and then filtrated with a 0.2 μm filter. The volume of the filtrate was measured to ~745 ml. 326.86 g of solid $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ resulting in 70% $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ saturation was weighed and added as ~33 g aliquots into the supernatant while continuously mixing. Once all salt had dissolved, the solution was transferred to a +4° C. refrigerator.

The following morning, the ammonium sulphate solution was centrifuged (Sorvall RC6) SLA-3000 rotor, 90 minutes, 10500 rpm, +4° C., acceleration 9 and deceleration 4). After centrifugation, the supernatants were combined and filtered through a 0.2 μm sterile filter. 72.5 ml of the filtrate was taken for hydrophobic interaction chromatography (HIC). The rest of the filtrate was divided into 17 $\times$ 50 ml aliquots and stored first at +4° C. and later transferred to -20° C. Moreover, two 1 ml samples of the filtrate were taken and stored at first at +4° C. and later transferred to -20° C.

The $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ concentration of the ammonium sulphate filtrate was estimated to be ~2.7 M and it was diluted so that the concentration of $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ decreased to ~2 M with 190 mM Na-H-Phosphate buffer, pH 6.8. The filtrate was subjected to HIC in a 5 ml HiTrap Butyl FF column equilibrated with 50 mM Na-H-Phosphate, pH 6.9, 2 M $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$. A total of 50 ml of sample was pumped through the column and the flow-through was collected as 5 ml fractions. Unbound sample was washed out with 50 mM Na-H-Phosphate, pH 6.9, 2 M $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$. Bound IS288 was eluted with decreasing $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ concentration using step gradient and 50 mM Na-H-Phosphate, pH 6.8. In the first run, elution fractions were 1 ml. Fractions containing the eluted protein were combined in three different sets; C3-C8, C9-D1 and D2-D8. Flow-through fractions and the rest of the elution fractions were stored at +4° C. Samples were taken from flow-through fractions B1 and B8 as well as the pooled protein fractions and stored at +4° C.

The HIC step was repeated two times for different sample volumes, namely 65 ml and 125 ml of equilibrated ammonium sulphate filtrate. These later HIC runs were somewhat modified from the first run. The wash volume for unbound sample was 3 and 4 CV, the volume of flow-through fractions was increased to 10 ml and the volume of the elution fractions was increased to 1.5 ml. No other modifications were made to the running conditions.

Pooled protein fractions as well as flow-through fractions of B1 and B8 of the first run were ultra filtrated and concentrated using Amicon Ultra-4 concentrators with 10000 NMWL. The samples were centrifuged six times and after each centrifugation, except the last one, the rest of the sample or buffer was added into the retentate so as to gain 4 ml

volume. After the sixth concentration step, retentates were collected, measured and stored at +4° C. Samples from succeeding HIC runs, as well as one more flow through fraction from the first run were ultra filtrated and concentrated with Amicon Ultra-15 with 10000 NMWL and only four centrifugation rounds were needed. These samples were also stored at +4° C. Ammonium sulphate filtrates were ultra filtrated and concentrated, and flow through fractions were once more concentrated with MultiScreen filter plates with Ultracell-10 membrane, 10000 NMWL. Protein concentration of the flow through samples was measured before this last concentration step whereas no protein concentration was measured for ammonium sulphate filtrates.

The protein concentration of the samples was measured with BCA Protein Assay-kit. Based on the elution peak obtained from Äkta, eluted protein fractions were diluted ~1:20 and ~1:40 while the flow-through fractions were used as such (1:1 dilution) or diluted in half (1:2 dilution).

Finally, samples from all three purifications were run on a Criterion XT 12% Bis-Tris SDS-PAGE using MOPS running buffer to optimally separate proteins of 6-66 kDa in size. The maximum amount of sample was added for ammonium sulphate filtrates and all flow through fractions except for B1₁₂₁₁₀₈ for which the protein content was determined to be 0.21 µg/µl in the 33× concentrated sample. The amount of protein peak fractions pipetted was calculated so that 0.5 µg of protein would be loaded on the gel.

A purified protein solution of IS288 was used to determine the activity of IS288 per mass unit. The stability of IS288 in storage conditions was examined to find out if the protein is degraded or by some other way modified during storage. The stability of the protein at the target site matrix was also determined. The results from the stability assay in target site matrix were combined with the results from the activity assay to estimate the time it takes for IS288 to eliminate antibiotic residues in the small intestine.

In addition to getting more detailed information on P1A variant IS288, the characterization scheme created during the study was used in the characterization of other subsequent P1A variants.

Method to Study Production Levels of P1A Variant IS288

During the *Bacillus subtilis* shaker flask cultivation, samples were taken at various time points to evaluate the production level of IS288. The OD₆₀₀ value was measured for each of the time points as well to see how the cells were growing. The amount of produced protein was estimated on SDS-PAGE.

Method to Study Enzyme Efficacy and Antibiotic Spectrum at Different pH Levels

The antibiotics used in this study were a selection of, e.g., intravenously administered cephalosporins. The concentrations of selected antibiotics were, without wishing to be bound by theory, set to as close to the in literature reported concentrations in bile or duodenum as possible. This experiment was also performed at varying pHs.

Method to Study Enzyme Stability in Human Ileal Chyme

Different amounts of purified enzyme were incubated in human ileal chyme at the appropriate temperature for a set period of time. Samples were taken at different time points. The degradation pattern of IS288 was analysed with SDS-PAGE and the activity of IS288 was analysed using nitrocefin as a substrate.

Compounds and Bacterial Strain: Ampicillin, Ceftriaxone, Cefazidime, Meropenem, Cefepime, Cefazolin, Amp/Sulbactam, Cefoperazone, Cefotaxime, and Cefuroxime were purchased from commercial sources and stored as frozen stocks of 15 mg/mL and 10 mg/mL, respectively. P1A was

supplied by Synthetic Biologics as a stock concentration of 32 mg/mL and stored at -80° C. *Escherichia coli* ATCC 25922 was obtained from American Type Culture Collection (ATCC, Manassas, Va.).

Determination of the Effective Inhibitory Concentration in the Absence and Presence of P1A (RS310), P3A (IS118), and P4A (IS288): The effective inhibitory concentrations (EC₅₀, 90) of ampicillin, ceftriaxone, ceftazidime, meropenem, cefepime, cefazolin, amp/sulbactam, cefoperazone, cefotaxime, and cefuroxime were determined by microbroth dilution analysis according to the CLSI guidelines (M07-A9: Methods for Dilution Antimicrobial Susceptibility Tests for Bacteria That Grow Aerobically; Approved Standard—Ninth Edition). *Escherichia coli* strain 25922 was cultured from glycerol stocks to logarithmic growth in cation adjusted Mueller-Hinton broth at 37° C. in an atmospheric environment and diluted in cation adjusted Mueller-Hinton broth to achieve a starting in well concentration of 5×10⁵ CFU/mL. Serial 2-fold dilution of antimicrobial compounds were prepared in cation adjusted Mueller-Hinton broth to achieve final in well concentration of 128 µg/mL to 0.13 µg/mL for ampicillin and 4 µg/mL 4 ng/mL in the absence or presence of serial 10-fold dilutions of P1A, P3A, or P4A β-lactamase standard, 5 pg/mL to 50 ng/mL for ampicillin and 50 pg/mL to 500 ng/mL for ceftriaxone, ceftazidime, meropenem, cefepime, cefazolin, amp/sulbactam, cefoperazone, cefotaxime, and cefuroxime. Antibiotics were either added to the P1A and incubated for 30 min at 37° C. (pre-incubation) prior to addition of bacteria, or added to the plates following the addition of P1A, P3A, P4A, and bacteria (simultaneous). All concentrations and combinations were evaluated in triplicate in a 96-well plate format that contained media only, compound plus media only (colorimetric control), and untreated bacterial controls. Following overnight incubation, the OD₆₂₅ of the plates was measured in a Spectramax 384 plate reader and the data were imported into a customized Excel spreadsheet for the determination of the effective concentration that inhibited bacterial growth by 50%, 90% and 99% (EC₅₀, 90, 99) by linear regression analysis.

Example 2

Results of Mutagenesis

Mutation design was based on, inter alia, structural data (e.g. crystal structure data, homolog models, etc.) of the following: P1A crystal structure (Knox and Moews, *J. Mol Biol.*, 220, 435-455 (1991)), CTX-M-44 (1BZA (Ibuka et al. *Journal of Molecular Biology* Volume 285, Issue 5 2079-2087 (1999)), 1IYS (Ibuka et al. *Biochemistry*, 2003, 42 (36): 10634-43), 1IYO, 1IYP and 1IYQ (Shimamura et al. 2002 *J. Biol. Chem.* 277:46601-08), *Proteus vulgaris* K1 (1HZO, Nugaka et al. *J Mol Biol.* 2002 Mar. 15;317(1):109-17) and *Proteus penneri* HugA (Liassine et al. *Antimicrob Agents Chemother.* 2002 January;46(1):216-9. 2002), and reviewed in Bonnet, *Antimicrob. Agents Chemother* 48(1): 1-14 (2004) (for CTM-X), the contents of all of these documents are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety). In some embodiments, the present mutations are informed by analysis of structural data (e.g. crystal structure data, homolog models, etc.) of any one of the following β-lactamases: P1A, P2A, P3A, CTX-M-3, CTX-M-4, CTX-M-5, CTX-M-9, CTX-M-10, CTX-M-14, CTX-M-15, CTX-M-16, CTX-M-18, CTX-M-19, CTX-M-25, CTX-M-26, CTX-M-27, CTX-M-32, CTX-M-44, CTX-M-45, and CTX-M-54. Such information

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is available to one skilled in the art at known databases, for example, Swiss-Prot Protein Sequence Data Bank, NCBI, and PDB.

Results from site-directed and random mutagenesis are summarized in Tables 2 and 3, respectively. Enzymatic activity for selected mutants is presented in Table 4 and kinetic parameters are represented in Table 5. Kinetic parameters for previous enzymes P1A, P3A and P2A are also included in that table.

Mutation Block 1. I72S, Q135M and T160F

The first block of mutations including I72S, Q135M and T160F were introduced in mutagenic primers in one reaction using The QUIKCHANGE Multi Site-Directed mutagenesis kit (for short later called Multi kit), Stratagene. Plasmid carrying the penP gene was used as template in the mutagenesis reaction. Mutant single-stranded plasmids were transformed into *E. coli* XL10Gold and selected with kanamycin/chloramphenicol. Competent XL10 Gold cells are provided with the Multi kit. Colonies (10-30) were picked and tested with nitrocefin to verify β -lactamase activity. Part of the colony was used as template in PCR and the resulting fragment, if clean, was sent to DNA sequencing. The rest of the colony was cultivated in Luria supplemented with appropriate antibiotic, overnight, at 37° C., and a part of the culture was stored in glycerol ($\leq 10\%$, final), another part is used for plasmid isolation. After the desired mutations were confirmed with DNA sequencing, the mutant clones were characterized in more detail. Periplasmic lysates were prepared and analyzed in SDS PAGE and the kinetics of cefotaxime hydrolysis were measured spectrophotometrically.

Mutation Block 2. A232G, A237S, A238G and S240D

The target amino acids of the B3 β -strand of P1A are so closely situated to each other that the Multi-Site protocol was not suitable, at least in one round. Instead, all four amino acids were exchanged using the SOE technique. The region encompassing the exchanges contained 24 nucleotides (8 amino acid codons) and was included in the overlap extension part of two PCR primers. The mutated penP gene was first PCR'ed in two parts, using primers A+B and C+D (FIG. 7). The two PCR products were then combined and amplified using primers A and D, complementary to the 5' and 3' parts of the penP gene. Cloning sites were included in primers A and D. Once the construct was ready, further mutations were added using the Multi kit.

Further Mutations, R244T and D276R(K)

These mutations were added using the Multi-Site kit technique and the previously made mutant plasmids as templates. A list of the constructed mutations is shown in Table 1. The number of mutation combinations was increased easily and consequently, the characterization was done with more robust methods than measuring the cefotaxime degradation kinetics of individual clones. Primary characterization was the determination of the cefotaxime MIC.

TABLE 1

Constructed mutations and other possible combinations		
Clone	Technique	Amino acid replacements
Block 1	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F
	Multi kit	I72S, T160F
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M
	Multi kit	I72S
	Multi kit	Q135M
Block 2	Multi kit	T160F
	SOE	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + R244T
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + D276R(K)
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + R244T + D276R(K)

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TABLE 1-continued

Constructed mutations and other possible combinations		
Clone	Technique	Amino acid replacements
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + R244T + D276R(K)
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + I72S, Q135M, T160F
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + I72S, Q135M, T160F + D276R(K)
	SOE + Multi kit	A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D + I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	R244T
	Multi kit	D276R(K)
	Multi kit	R244T + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T + D276R(K)
	Multi kit	I72S, Q135M, T160F + R244T + D276R(K)

TABLE 2

P1A mutants made using site-directed mutagenesis. <i>B. subtilis</i> and <i>E. coli</i> strain numbers, mutations and plasmid names are marked.			
<i>B. subtilis</i> strain	Amino acid replacements	Plasmid name in <i>B. subtilis</i>	<i>E. coli</i> strain
IS191	Block 2 = A232G, A237S, A238G, S240D	pCTX-42	IS189
IS197	Q135M	pIS197	IS193
IS215	R244T + D276K	pIS215	IS207
IS217	R244T	pIS217	IS108
IS219	Block 2 + D276T	pIS219	IS209
IS221	Block 2 + D276K	pIS221	IS210
IS222	I72S	pIS222	IS212
IS224	Block 2 + Q135M	pIS224	IS214
IS227	Block 1 = I72S, Q135M, T160F	pRSH227	SOE
IS229	Block 2 + R244T	pRSH229	SOE

TABLE 3

P1A mutants generated with random mutagenesis. <i>B. subtilis</i> and <i>E. coli</i> strain numbers, mutations and plasmid names are marked.			
<i>B. subtilis</i> strain	Amino acid replacements	Plasmid name in <i>B. subtilis</i>	<i>E. coli</i> strain
IS158	F33Y, D276N	pRSH158	
IS230	F33Y, S240P, D276N	pRSH230	IS181
IS232	F33Y, A238T, D276N	pRSH232	IS180
IS234	R55R, A123A, T2431, S266N, D276N	pRSH234	IS176

TABLE 4

Preliminary enzymatic activities of P1A mutants measured from <i>B. subtilis</i> supernatants. Values are represented as multiples of P1A. AMP = ampicillin, CTX = cefotaxime, CRO = ceftriaxone, CXM = cefuroxime and CAZ = ceftazidime. P1A values used for the calculations are means of two different experiments.						
<i>B. subtilis</i> strain	Amino acid replacements	AMP	CTX	CRO	CXM	CAZ
RS310	P1A strain	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
IS191	A232G A237S A238G S240D	0.16	2.17	2.91	3.22	1.28
IS197	Q135M	0.15	1.32	1.09	1.83	0.55
IS203	T160F	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.00	0.13
IS215	R244T D276K	0.44	0.50	0.93	0.81	0.26
IS217	R244T	0.22	0.00	0.00	0.05	0.11
IS219	A232G A237S A238G S240D D276R	0.05	7.22	15.99	7.67	0.27
IS221	A232G A237S A238G S240D D276K	0.06	9.39	15.95	9.87	0.38
IS222	I72S	0.71	0.00	0.15	0.18	0.00
IS224	A232G A237S A238G S240D Q135M	0.02	4.74	5.18	6.37	1.24
IS230	F33Y S240P D276N	0.02	8.07	9.26	4.76	8.98
IS232	F33Y A238T D276N	0.08	12.34	9.14	5.71	26.73
IS233	A238T	0.07	4.17	5.25	4.76	12.70
IS234	T243I S266N D276N	0.57	6.04	11.03	6.86	11.23
IS235	G156R A238T	0.03	1.66	2.09	1.34	5.42

TABLE 5

Kinetic parameters measured for the P1A mutant strains. Kinetic parameters for IS230 degrading cefuroxime are not reliable as the original curve did not obey Michaelis-Menten kinetics. Moreover, it should be noted that kinetic parameters for IS219 and IS221 are near one another except when cefotaxime is degraded; when the V_{max} for IS219 is increased, it is decreased for IS221. On the other hand, the affinity of IS219 towards cefotaxime has not increased with the same amount as IS221's. Low = not enough activity for measurements; ND or empty cell = not done.												
	Ceftriaxone				Cefotaxime				Cefuroxime			
	V_{max} (nmol/s)	K_m (mM)	k_{cat} (1/s)	k_{cat}/K_m ($M^{-1} * s^{-1}$)	V_{max} (nmol/s)	K_m (mM)	k_{cat} (1/s)	k_{cat}/K_m ($M^{-1} * s^{-1}$)	V_{max} (nmol/s)	K_m (mM)	k_{cat} (1/s)	k_{cat}/K_m ($M^{-1} * s^{-1}$)
P1A (A18K31)	2.81	179	25	$1.41 * 10^5$	1.18	232	16	$6.8 * 10^4$	1.25	107	23	$2.11 * 10^5$
IS219	0.37	47	171	$3.62 * 10^6$	1.51	164	60	$3.68 * 10^5$	0.94	140	126	$8.98 * 10^5$
IS221	0.30	30	103	$3.46 * 10^6$	0.43	66	43	$6.47 * 10^5$	0.90	108	89	$8.22 * 10^5$
IS227	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low				
IS229	Low	Low	Low	Low	3.10	574	136	$2.37 * 10^5$				
P3A ⁽¹⁾	0.25	55	54	$9.89 * 10^5$	0.24	230	17	$7.3 * 10^4$	ND	ND	ND	ND
IS158	1.27	33	45	$1.36 * 10^6$	0.57	144	20	$1.41 * 10^5$	ND	ND	ND	ND
IS232 (IS180)	0.47	4	27	$6.25 * 10^6$	0.31	14	23	$1.69 * 10^6$	low	low	low	low
IS234 (IS176)	1.09	37	53	$1.45 * 10^6$	0.61	33	30	$8.88 * 10^5$	0.77	17	38	$2.19 * 10^6$
IS230 (IS181)	0.66	18	32	$1.80 * 10^6$	0.47	21	23	$1.09 * 10^6$	0.50	7	24	$3.27 * 10^6$
P2A ⁽¹⁾		68	95	$1.40 * 10^6$	0.79	66	479	$7.28 * 10^6$	0.37	27	221	$7.99 * 10^6$

TABLE 6

V_{max} and K_m values of selected mutants represented as relative values of P1A activities. If $K_m < 1.0$, the mutant's affinity towards its ligand increased. If $K_m > 1.0$, the affinity decreased. The opposite is true for k_{cat} and V_{max} . Low = low activity; — = not done.												
	Ceftriaxone				Cefotaxime				Cefuroxime			
	V_{max}	K_m	k_{cat}	k_{cat}/K_m	V_{max}	K_m	k_{cat}	k_{cat}/K_m	V_{max}	K_m	k_{cat}	k_{cat}/K_m
P1A (A18K31)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
IS219	0.13	0.26	6.76	25.64	1.29	0.71	3.81	5.39	0.75	1.31	5.56	4.25
IS221	0.11	0.17	4.09	24.46	0.37	0.29	2.70	9.48	0.71	1.01	3.93	3.89
IS227	low	low	low	low	low	low	low	low	—	—	—	—
IS229	low	low	low	low	2.64	2.47	8.58	3.47	—	—	—	—
P3A	0.09	0.31	2.15	7.00	0.20	0.99	1.07	1.07	—	—	—	—
IS158	0.45	0.19	1.80	9.63	0.48	0.62	1.28	2.06	—	—	—	—
IS232 (IS180)	0.17	0.02	1.08	44.25	0.26	0.06	1.44	24.70	—	—	—	—

TABLE 6-continued

V_{max} and K_m values of selected mutants represented as relative values of P1A activities. If $K_m < 1.0$, the mutant's affinity towards its ligand increased. If $K_m > 1.0$, the affinity decreased. The opposite is true for k_{cat} and V_{max} . Low = low activity; — = not done.												
	Ceftriaxone				Cefotaxime				Cefuroxime			
	V_{max}	K_m	k_{cat}	k_{cat}/K_m	V_{max}	K_m	k_{cat}	k_{cat}/K_m	V_{max}	K_m	k_{cat}	k_{cat}/K_m
IS234 (IS176)	0.39	0.20	2.10	10.26	0.52	0.14	1.87	13.00	0.61	0.16	1.66	10.38
IS230 (IS181)	0.24	0.10	1.27	12.70	0.40	0.09	1.45	15.99	0.40	0.07	1.08	15.48
P2A	—	0.38	3.76	9.87	0.67	0.28	30.18	106.55	0.29	0.25	9.78	37.81

Enzymatic Activity and Kinetic Parameters

From the kinetic parameters measured for P1A against cefotaxime, ceftriaxone and cefuroxime, without wishing to be bound by theory, it was deduced that P1A has a low intrinsic cephalosporinase activity. In general, the mutants' affinity towards ligands has increased (i.e. decreased K_m). V_{max} increased and the affinity decreased (K_m increased) in the IS229 (Block 2+R244T) mutant (Table 5). For IS229, the k_{cat} increased the most.

The random mutagenesis screen with ceftriaxone preferred mutants with low K_m (high affinity) towards the antibiotic.

Decrease in K_m by subsequent mutation rounds was seen in the mutation series P3A→IS158→IS232; IS232 had extremely high affinity towards ceftriaxone. The V_{max} for ceftriaxone did not decrease sequentially being the highest for IS158 but k_{cat} , nevertheless, decreased through the mutation rounds. The first two mutants of this round did not have cefotaximase activity but IS232 with additional A238T had cefotaximase activity.

Site-directed Block2 (IS191) mutations alone did not markedly increase P1A-derivative's activity towards cephalosporins but the activity towards ampicillin was reduced 20 fold (Table 4). The cephalosporinase activity of Block2+D276R/K (IS219/IS221) was considerably better than that of IS191's. The kinetic parameters of the IS219 and IS221 site-directed mutants revealed that the site-directed mutagenesis preferably increased the enzyme's affinity towards the target antibiotics.

Stability Assay/Glucose Stress Test

To test the stability of mutants in *B. subtilis* growth conditions, a shaker flask cultivation with RS310, IS219 and IS232 was performed. The cultivation was made in two different glucose concentrations of 5 g/l and 10 g/l.

P1A (RS310) and the two mutants IS219 and IS232 were cultivated in shaker flasks (100 ml) in minimal medium with 5 or 10 g/l glucose. The condition of the cells was monitored with microscope, the glucose consumption measured from 5 g/l growth and samples from the culture supernatants (concentrated and non-concentrated) were run on 12% Bis-Tris SDS-PAGE (Criterion, BioRad) (FIGS. 1 and 2). The ODs of the cell cultures were also monitored.

In 10 g/l glucose cultures, P1A and IS232 were produced in comparable amounts but the production of IS219 was lower (lanes 2-4, FIG. 1). During concentration, the IS219 yield was further reduced (lanes 6, 9 and 16, FIG. 1). A faint band ~29 kDa can be seen on lane 16 in FIG. 1. P1A and IS232, again, could be concentrated (lanes 5, 7, 8, 10, 15 and 16 FIG. 1).

In the presence of 5 g/l glucose, P1A strain RS310 started growing slower than the other two strains. However, by the end of the cultivation the amount of P1A had superseded the amount of the other proteins (FIG. 2). The mutant strain IS219 started to produce roughly at the same velocity as the

strain IS232 but by 10 hours of cultivation its production had started to lag behind IS232 and its amount was decreased over time. All glucose was consumed by 9.5 hours of cultivation both in IS219 and IS232 cultivations and from that point on it is assumed that the amount of proteases started to increase. Because RS310 grew slower, it still had some glucose left at 11 hours of cultivation but also RS310 had consumed all glucose by the following morning. Because no samples were taken from RS310 during the night, the exact time-point at which RS310 had used all its glucose and started to produce proteases cannot be stated. By 27.5 hours of cultivation the amount of P1A had increased but the amount of both IS219 and IS232 had decreased from the previous day. From the study, without wishing to be bound by theory, it can be deduced that IS232 tolerates proteases better than IS219, which does not tolerate them at all.

Based both on 10 g/l glucose and 5 g/l glucose cultivations, without wishing to be bound by theory, it can be said that modifications to P1A reduce the protein's protease tolerance. Glucose deprivation lead to the appearance of degradation products in the case of IS219 and IS232 and the amount of degradation products was increased after all glucose was consumed. IS219 protein was more sensitive to degradation as its amount decreased more than that of IS232. Without wishing to be bound by theory, this may indicate either lower secretability or greater sensitivity to *Bacillus* proteases, or both. In conclusion, production of IS219 was not possible using the same growth conditions as for RS310 and IS232. The glucose stress test also demonstrated that this test can be used to estimate the protease tolerance of the generated mutants.

With the glucose stress test it was demonstrated that Block2+D276R=IS219 (and most likely Block2+D276K=IS221) mutation decreases the enzyme's protease tolerance. Most likely, without wishing to be bound by theory, the instability is due to D276R mutation, which creates a protease cleavage site on the surface of the protein.

A D276N mutation on IS191, which would result in a Block2+D276N-mutant was made. Without wishing to be bound by theory, an aspartic acid to asparagine mutation is expected to increase the ceftriaxone (and maybe cefotaxime) activity of IS191 but at the same time keep the enzyme more resistant to proteases than IS219 (and IS221) is. R244T mutation could be combined with Block2 and D276N to see whether we can increase the V_{max} (and k_{cat}) with this mutation. R244T mutation could also be combined with IS219 and IS221.

An activity assay (Table 4) R244T (IS217) mutation abolished nearly all enzymatic activity of P1A. Some of the activity was gained with a double mutant R244T+D276K (IS215),

but not to the level of the wild type enzyme. Thus, R244T mutation alone cannot provide P1A with cephalosporinase activity.

Based on kinetic data (Table 5) Block1 mutation (I72S/Q135M/T160F, IS227) did not improve P1A's ability to hydrolyze cephalosporins. In other activity assays neither did Q135M or T160F alone increase P1A's ability to hydrolyze cephalosporins, instead, both single mutations abolished nearly all P1A's enzymatic activity, even towards ampicillin. There was, however, a Block2+Q135M-mutant (IS224), which had an activity towards cefotaxime and ceftriaxone between Block2 (IS191) and Block2+D276R/K (IS219/IS221) mutants. Without wishing to be bound by theory, Block1 may "loosen" the Ω -loop where the catalytic Glu166 is located. T160F mutation is quite a large modification in the core of a protein's structure. It might disrupt the structure totally or at least incapacitate the protein from functioning properly. To avoid this possibility, two compensatory mutations were added to accompany T160F mutation in P1A, namely I72S and Q135M and this combination of mutations was called "Block1".

Example 3

Results from Production and Purification of P1A Mutant IS288

The results of the purification are reported as elution peak figures (FIGS. 3, 4, and 5) and peak tables, as protein concentration and as SDS-PAGE picture(s) (FIG. 6). Chromatograms from Hydrophobic Interaction Chromatography

Hydrophobic interaction chromatography (HIC) was run on three separate occasions with differing parameters. In the first run (16.10.08, FIG. 3) the sample volume was ~50 ml, volume of flow through fractions 5 ml, wash volume for the unbound sample 2 CV, and the volume of eluted fractions 1.0 ml. In the following HIC run (4.11.08, FIG. 4) the sample volume was increased to 65 ml, flow-through fraction volume to 10 ml, and wash volume for unbound sample to 3 CV and fraction size to 1.5 ml. In the last run (12.11.08, FIG. 5) only the sample volume and wash volume for unbound sample differed from the preceding run being 125 ml and 4 CV, respectively.

All the graphs of HIC runs (FIGS. 3, 4, and 5) represent the same overall form. The flow through fraction gave constant absorbance ~700 mAU at 280 nm throughout the sample application while during washing of unbound sample, the absorbance at 280 nm dropped to zero rising again when the bound protein was eluted. The conductivity of the sample was

slightly lower in samples applied in FIG. 3 and FIG. 4 than in running buffer A containing 2 M $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ while in the run on 12.11.2008 it stayed the same as in the A-buffer. In the two first runs the $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ concentration of the ammonium sulphate filtrate was estimated as 2.7 M and in the last run 2.6 M. It seems that the 2.6 M estimation was closer to the actual $(\text{NH}_4)_2\text{SO}_4$ concentration of the ammonium sulphate filtrate as the conductivity of the out coming solution did not drop during sample application (FIG. 5).

The elution that started right after the elution buffer (buffer B) was applied on the column. This indicated that the protein in the sample was barely bound to the column as it eluted so early in the gradient. Thus, it was vital that the conductivity of the sample never got less than ~240 mS/cm.

The bound protein eluted as a typical elution peak with steep ascending slope and a gentle descending slope giving slightly asymmetrical peak. The size of the peak was largest in the first run, ~18 ml (18×1 ml fractions) (FIG. 3). This peak was collected in three sets: first of 6 ml (fractions C3-C8), second of 5 ml (fractions C9-D1) and third of 7 ml (fractions D2-D8) as there was a "shoulder" in the elution peak between fractions C8 and C9 and it was considered that the last 7 fractions could be too diluted for concentration. In the two subsequent HIC runs (4.11.2008 and 12.11.2008, FIGS. 4 and 5, respectively) the elution peak was 13.5 ml (9×1.5 ml fractions, 4.11.2008) and 12 ml (8×1.5 ml fractions, 12.11.2008) and the whole peak was pooled to one fraction.

In Table 7, the statistical values for A_{280} graphs of the three HIC runs are given. The area of the peak was used to estimate the protein content of that sample and it was used in estimating the dilution factor for different samples in the BCA assay. The calculations required the theoretical extinction coefficient of the protein, which was calculated using ProtParam-Tool at ExPASy web service. For IS288, this coefficient was 25440 $\text{M}^{-1}\text{cm}^{-1}$ and gave A_{280} 0.869 for 0.1% (=1 g/l) solution.

Using the proportion above, the amounts of protein in eluted protein samples and the known volumes of these samples, the protein amount eluted from the column was calculated. The formula used was: $((\text{mAU} \cdot \text{ml}) \cdot 10^{-3} / V_{\text{fraction}}) / 0.869 \cdot V_{\text{fraction}} \rightarrow (\text{mAU} \cdot \text{ml}) \cdot 10^{-3} / 0.869$, which resulted in: 3.36 mg protein 161008, 2.95 mg 041108, and 3.60 mg 121108.

Table 7: Peak Table from Three Separate HIC Runs

The date of the run, peak name, retention time i.e. the volume at which the peak reaches its top, area of the peak, and the maximum height of the peak are given. The area of the peak was used to estimate the amount of eluted protein in the elution fraction.

TABLE 7

Peak table from three separate HIC runs					
The date of the run, peak name, retention time i.e. the volume at which the peak reaches its top, area of the peak, and the maximum height of the peak are given. The area of the peak was used to estimate the amount of eluted protein in the elution fraction.					
Date	Peak name	Retention (ml)	Area (mAU * ml)	Height (mAU)	Estimated protein amount (mg)
16 Oct. 2008	Flow through fraction	84.48	44814.9666	816.803	3.36
	Wash unbound sample	86.54	4640.2506	659.512	
	Eluted sample	93.08	2923.2825	814.968	
4 Nov. 2008	Flow through fraction	27.94	42450.2080	673.843	2.95
	Eluted sample	87.01	2562.0783	953.277	
12 Nov. 2008	Flow-through fraction	23.40	78004.2505	658.094	3.60
	Eluted protein	152.03	3126.5816	1214.232	

Ultra Filtration and Concentration of Flow-Through and Eluted Protein Fractions

From each of the purifications one, two or three of the flow-through fractions were selected for concentration as well as all fractions containing the eluted protein peak. The selected samples are represented in Table 8. Also represented in the table are the starting volume of that sample as well as final volume and concentration factor.

Table 8: Samples Selected for Ultra Filtration and Concentration With Amicon Ultra-4, 10000 NMWL

The original volume of the sample and the final volume of the sample after concentration as well as the concentration factor are presented. The concentration factor was calculated by dividing the original volume by the final volume of the sample after concentration.

TABLE 8

Samples selected for ultra filtration and concentration with Amicon Ultra-4, 10000 NMWL				
The original volume of the sample and the final volume of the sample after concentration as well as the concentration factor are presented. The concentration factor was calculated by dividing the original volume by the final volume of the sample after concentration.				
Date of purification	Selected fractions	Original volume (ml)	Final volume (μl)	Conc. factor
16 Oct. 2008	B1 (FT)	5	750	6.7 X
	B7 (FT)	4.5	1000	4.5 X
	B8 (FT)	5	750	6.7 X
	C3-C8 (Protein Peak)	6	900	6.7 X
	C8-D1 (Protein Peak)	5	900	5.6 X
4 Nov. 2008	D2-D8 (Protein Peak)	7	900	7.8 X
	A2 (FT)	9.5	750	12.7 X
	A7 (FT)	9.5	750	12.7 X
	B2-B10 (Protein Peak)	13	700	18.6 X
12 Nov. 2008	B1 (FT)	9.5	900	10.6 X
	B8-C3 (Protein Peak)	11	1200	9.2 X

Flow-through fractions selected for the ultra filtration were from the beginning (B1₁₆₁₀₀₈ and A2₀₄₁₁₀₈) and from the end of sample application (B7₁₆₁₀₀₈, B8₁₆₁₀₀₈, A7₀₄₁₁₀₈ and B1₁₂₁₁₀₈). These samples were analysed in order to see if the capacity of the column was exceeded with that particular sample amount.

Moreover, ammonium sulphate filtrates for each of the purifications were ultra filtrated and concentrated and the once concentrated flow through fractions were still further concentrated with MultiScreen plates with Ultracell-10 membrane, 10000 NMWL. The results of that concentration are presented in Table 9.

Table 9: Samples Selected for Ultra Filtration and Concentration With MultiScreen Filter Plates With Ultracell-10 Membrane, 10000 NMWL

Both the original volume and the volume of the sample after concentration are indicated. Concentration factor was calculated by dividing the original sample volume with the final sample volume.

TABLE 9

Samples selected for ultra filtration and concentration with MultiScreen Filter Plates with Ultracell-10 membrane, 10000 NMWL				
Both the original volume and the volume of the sample after concentration are indicated. Concentration factor was calculated by dividing the original sample volume with the final sample volume.				
Date of purification	Selected fractions	Original volume (ml)	Final volume (μl)	Conc. factor
16 Oct. 2008	AS-sup 161008	500	420	1.2 X
	B1 (FT)	400	125	3.2 X
	B7 (FT)	1200	300	4.0 X
	B8 (FT)	380	115	3.3 X
4 Nov. 2008	AS-sup 041108	500	440	1.1 X
	A2 (FT)	360	115	3.1 X
	A7 (FT)	700	265	2.1 X
12 Nov. 2008	AS-sup 121108	500	455	1.1 X
	B1 (FT)	430	165	2.6 X

The flow through fractions of the HIC runs were, thus, concentrated by a factor of 16 or more. The final concentration factors of the flow through fractions are listed in Table 10. Table 10: Final Concentration Factors of Flow Through Samples

The final concentration factors were calculated by multiplying the concentration factor of the first concentration with the concentration factor of the second concentration.

TABLE 10

Final concentration factors of flow through samples		
The final concentration factors were calculated by multiplying the concentration factor of the first concentration with the concentration factor of the second concentration.		
Date of purification	Selected fractions	Conc. factor
16 Oct. 2008	B1 (FT)	20.0 X
	B7 (FT)	16.7 X
	B8 (FT)	21.2 X
	A2 (FT)	39.1 X
4 Nov. 2008	A7 (FT)	35.8 X
12 Nov. 2008	B1 (FT)	33.0 X

BCA Assay Results

Results from the BCA assay are presented in Table 11. The protein concentration of the flow through fractions was measured before the last concentration step with MultiScreen plates with Ultracell-10 membrane.

Table 11: Protein Concentrations of HIC Flow-Through and Peak Fractions

The protein concentration was determined from two replicates of two different dilutions of a given sample. The final volume of the sample was measured after concentration.

TABLE 11

Protein concentrations of HIC flow-through and peak fractions			
The protein concentration was determined from two replicates of two different dilutions of a given sample. The final volume of the sample was measured after concentration.			
Sample name	Protein concentration in the sample (mg/ml)	Final volume of the sample (ml)	Amount of protein in the sample (mg)
B1 ₁₆₁₀₀₈	0.02	0.75	0.015
B8 ₁₆₁₀₀₈	0.01	0.75	0.008

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TABLE 11-continued

Protein concentrations of HIC flow-through and peak fractions The protein concentration was determined from two replicates of two different dilutions of a given sample. The final volume of the sample was measured after concentration.			
Sample name	Protein concentration in the sample (mg/ml)	Final volume of the sample(ml)	Amount of protein in the sample (mg)
C3-C8 ₁₆₁₀₀₈	9.59	0.9	8.63
C9-D1 ₁₆₁₀₀₈	0.10	0.9	0.09
D2-D8 ₁₆₁₀₀₈	0.72	0.9	0.65
Total protein amount in fractions C3-D8			9.37
A2 ₀₄₁₁₀₈	0.00	0.75	0.00
B2-B10 ₀₄₁₁₀₈	9.45	0.7	6.62
B1 ₁₂₁₁₀₈	0.08	0.9	0.07
B8-C3 ₁₂₁₁₀₈	7.56	1.2	9.07

Chromatograms from HIC runs gave rather high, ~700 mAU, A₂₈₀ values throughout sample application for the out coming solution. The eluted protein peaks contained sufficient amounts of protein. They were near the presumed binding capacity of the column, 10 mg. The area of the peak from the Äkta gave three times lower estimates for protein amount than the BCA assay.

SDS-PAGE

The maximum volume (17.5 µl) of sample was loaded on the SDS-PAGE (FIG. 6) for ammonium sulphate filtrates and flow through fractions, except for B1₁₂₁₁₀₈ for which 6.5 µl was loaded. The volume of the samples from protein peaks was calculated so that there would be ~0.5 µg of protein per lane and assumed that all protein in the sample would be P1A derivative IS288. The SDS-PAGE is represented in FIG. 6.

Ammonium sulphate filtrate samples all contain a double band near 30 kDa (MW of IS288 is 29288 Da, and of P1A 29273 Da). The same double band accompanied by a slightly smaller extra band can be clearly seen in flow through fraction B1₁₂₁₁₀₈ and somewhat more faintly in flow through fraction A7₀₄₁₁₀₈. On the other hand, both of these extra bands have been removed from eluted protein peaks. Some minor impurities can be seen on the last pooled fractions of purification D2-D8 161008, when ~10 times the intended amount of protein was loaded. It can be concluded that the purified protein was the major protein form and that by molecular weight analysis it was the P1A variant IS288.

Example 4

Test of a Microbiological Screening Assay for Beta-Lactamase Activity

The 50% effective inhibitory concentration (EC₅₀) of ampicillin and ceftriaxone against *Escherichia coli* was determined in the absence and presence of P1A β-lactamase. For the purposes of these studies, the stated effective concentration was the initial concentration of ampicillin or ceftriaxone added at the beginning of the experiment, and not a concentration measured during the course of the experiment or at the end of the incubation period. The results of the analysis are presented in Tables 12-14.

Initial evaluation utilized P1A at concentrations of 0.5 ng/mL to 5 µg/mL and ampicillin or ceftriaxone at concentrations of 0.13 µg/mL to 128 µg/mL. Addition of the lowest

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concentration of P1A (0.5 ng/mL) shifted the EC₅₀ of ampicillin from 16 µg/mL to greater than the highest test concentration of 128 µg/mL when added simultaneously and to 64 µg/mL when P1A was pre-incubated with ampicillin prior to addition of the bacteria (Table 12). Using the same concentrations of P1A with 0.13 µg/mL to 128 µg/mL of ceftriaxone, it was observed that ceftriaxone was completely inhibitory at the lowest concentration (EC₉₉ < 0.13 µg/mL) and the EC₅₀ of ceftriaxone was shifted to 0.25 µg/mL in the presence of 5 ng/mL P1A when added simultaneously and to 128 µg/mL when 50 ng/mL P1A was preincubated with the antibiotic. Based on this analysis, the concentrations of P1A and ceftriaxone were adjusted to bracket the inhibitory concentrations of both.

Using concentration of P1A from 5 pg/mL to 50 ng/mL with 0.13 µg/mL to 128 µg/mL of ampicillin, the EC₅₀ of ampicillin was shifted from 16 µg/mL in the absence of P1A to 128 µg/mL in the presence of 50 pg/mL when pre-incubated or added simultaneously. Lower concentrations of P1A (5 pg/mL) had no effect on the ampicillin EC₅₀. The EC₅₀ of ceftriaxone was shifted from 0.03 µg/mL in the absence of P1A to greater than 4 µg/mL in the presence of 50 ng/mL or greater P1A when preincubated or added simultaneously (Table 13). Lower concentrations of P1A (50 pg/mL to 5 ng/mL) had no effect on the ceftriaxone EC₅₀. Results with the simultaneous addition of P1A with ampicillin or ceftriaxone were confirmed through repeat analysis (Table 14).

TABLE 12

Effective inhibitory concentration (EC ₅₀) of ampicillin and ceftriaxone in the absence and presence of P1A determined by micro broth dilution analysis.				
P1A	Ampicillin EC ₅₀ (µg/mL)		Ceftriaxone EC ₅₀ (µg/mL)	
Con- centration	Pre incubation	Simultaneous	Pre incubation	Simultaneous
0	16	16	<0.13	<0.13
0.5 ng/mL	64	>128	<0.13	<0.13
5 ng/mL	128	>128	<0.13	0.25
50 ng/mL	>128	>128	>128	>128
500 ng/mL	>128	>128	>128	>128
5 µg/mL	>128	>128	>128	>128

Antibiotics were either added to the P1A and incubated for 30 min at 37° C. (Pre-incubation) prior to addition of bacteria, or added to the plates following the addition of P1A and bacteria (Simultaneous). All concentrations and combinations were evaluated in triplicate in a 96-well plate format. Following overnight incubation, the OD₆₂₅ of the plates was measured in a Spectramax 384 plate reader and the data were imported into a customized Excel spreadsheet for the determination of the 50% effective inhibitory concentration at (EC₅₀) by linear regression analysis. For the purposes of these studies, the stated effective concentration is the initial concentration of ampicillin or ceftriaxone added at the beginning of the experiment, and not a concentration measured during the course of the experiment or at the end of the incubation period.

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TABLE 13

Effective inhibitory concentration (EC ₅₀) of ampicillin and ceftriaxone in the absence and presence of P1A determined by micro broth dilution analysis.				
P1A	Ampicillin EC ₅₀ (μg/mL)		Ceftriaxone EC ₅₀ (μg/mL)	
Con- centration	Pre incubation	Simultaneous	Pre incubation	Simultaneous
0	16	16	0.02	0.02
5 pg/mL	16	16	NA	NA
50 pg/mL	128	128	0.02	0.02
500 pg/mL	>128	>128	0.03	0.03
5 ng/mL	>128	>128	0.03	0.03
50 ng/mL	>128	>128	>4	>4
500 ng/mL	NA	NA	>4	>4

Antibiotics were either added to the P1A and incubated for 30 min at 37° C. (Pre-incubation) prior to addition of bacteria, or added to the plates following the addition of P1A and bacteria (Simultaneous). All concentrations and combinations were evaluated in triplicate in a 96-well plate format. Following overnight incubation, the OD₆₂₅ of the plates was measured in a Spectramax 384 plate reader and the data were imported into a customized Excel spreadsheet for the determination of the 50% effective inhibitory concentration (EC₅₀).

TABLE 14

Effective inhibitory concentration (EC ₅₀) of ampicillin and ceftriaxone in the absence and presence of P1A determined by microbroth dilution analysis.		
P1A Concentration	Ampicillin EC ₅₀ (μg/mL) Simultaneous	Ceftriaxone EC ₅₀ (μg/mL) Simultaneous
0	16	0.03
5 pg/mL	16	NA
50 pg/mL	128	0.03
500 pg/mL	>128	0.03
5 ng/mL	>128	0.03
50 ng/mL	>128	>4
500 ng/mL	NA	>4

Antibiotics were added to the P1A bacteria (Simultaneous). All concentrations and combinations were evaluated in triplicate in a 96-well plate format. Following overnight incubation, the OD₆₂₅ of the plates was measured in a Spectramax 384 plate reader and the data were imported into a customized Excel spreadsheet for the determination of the 50% effective inhibitory concentration at (EC₅₀) by linear regression analysis.

These results demonstrated that P1A effectively inhibited the activity of ampicillin and ceftriaxone in an in vitro microbiological assay and indicated that P1A is 1,000-fold more active against ampicillin than ceftriaxone in the microbiological assay.

Next, the 90% effective inhibitory concentration (EC₉₀) of ampicillin, ceftriaxone, ceftazidime, meropenem, cefepime, cefazolin, amp/sulbactam, cefoperazone, cefotaxime, and cefuroxime against *Escherichia coli* was determined in the absence and presence of P1A, P3A, or P4A β-lactamase. For the purposes of these studies, the stated effective concentration was the initial concentration of ampicillin, ceftriaxone, ceftazidime, meropenem, cefepime, cefazolin, amp/sulbactam, cefoperazone, cefotaxime, and cefuroxime added at the beginning of the experiment, and not a concentration measured during the course of the experiment or at the end of the incubation period. The results of the analysis are presented in Tables 15-17. Each box in the below tables (Tables 15-17) has

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two numbers separated by a slash-the two numbers are duplicate assays, all of which showed tight agreement.

Specifically, the assay was performed by diluting (2-fold steps) the chosen antibiotic across the rows of a 96 well dish. The MIC was determined as the point at which the diluted antibiotic transitions from killing to not killing the bacteria (in this case, an *E. coli* strain that is sensitive to all antibiotics). P1A, P3A, and P4A were diluted (10 fold steps) down the columns (the β-lactamase concentrations increased down the columns). As the β-lactamase concentration increased, it reached a level at which it degraded the antibiotic sufficiently to alter the apparent MIC reading (the MIC didn't actually change, but it appeared to change because the amount of antibiotic remaining in the well was less than the amount loaded into the well). In most cases, there were two break points, the first in which the MIC appeared to increase a bit, and then at ten-fold concentration higher where the MIC exceeded the maximum amount of antibiotic tested. The latter point was used as the cut-off point. It is important to note that with this *E. coli*, the MIC was different for each antibiotic. However, for this assay, the absolute MIC is not the most important parameter. The most relevant readout was the β-lactamase concentration at which the apparent MIC increases to the maximum amount of antibiotic tested.

When the cut-off point occurred at low β-lactamase concentration, this implied that the β-lactamase was potent at degrading that antibiotic. When it took a lot of β-lactamase to move the MIC, then the β-lactamase was relatively weak for that antibiotic. This assay was designed, without wishing to be bound by theory to provide predictions of in vivo efficacy for each β-lactamase for a given antibiotic. These data can be combined with the in vitro kinetic data.

TABLE 15

Antibiotic activity of ampicillin and ceftriaxone in the presence of bacterial culture supernatants from <i>Bacillus</i> strains expressing soluble β-lactamase proteins P1A (RS310), P3A (IS118), or P4A (IS288).				
	Ampicillin EC ₅₀ (μg/mL)		Ceftriaxone EC ₅₀ (μg/mL)	
	Rep 1	Rep 2	Rep 1	Rep 2
RS310 Concentration				
0	2	4	0.008	0.02
5 pg/mL	4	16	NA	NA
50 pg/mL	32	128	0.008	0.008
500 pg/mL	>128	>128	0.008	0.008
5 ng/mL	>128	>128	0.06	0.008
50 ng/mL	>128	>128	>4	>4
500 ng/mL	NA	NA	>4	>4
IS118 Concentration				
0	2	4	0.008	0.02
5 pg/mL	4	8	NA	NA
50 pg/mL	16	64	0.008	0.008
500 pg/mL	>128	>128	0.5	0.06
5 ng/mL	>128	>128	NA	>4
50 ng/mL	>128	>128	>4	>4
500 ng/mL	NA	NA	>4	>4
IS288 Concentration				
0	2	4	0.02	0.02
5 pg/mL	2	16	NA	0.03
50 pg/mL	4	32	0.5	0.13
500 pg/mL	64	128	>4	4
5 ng/mL	>128	>128	>4	>4
50 ng/mL	>128	>128	>4	>4
500 ng/mL	NA	NA	>4	NA

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E. coli 29522 was incubated overnight in the presence of serial dilutions of antibiotic and the indicated amounts of β -lactamase protein from cell culture supernatants in a 96 well plate. Bacterial density (OD_{625}) of the cultures was measured and the concentration at which the density was reduced by 90% relative to an untreated bacterial control (EC_{90}) was determined. The assay was performed on two separate days and the data reported as Rep1 and Rep2. NA=not assayed.

TABLE 16

Antibiotic activity of ceftazidime, meropenem, cefepime, and ceftriazone in the presence of bacterial culture supernatants from <i>bacillus</i> strains expressing soluble β -lactamase proteins P1A (RS310), P3A (IS118), or P4A (IS288).				
	Ceftazidime EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 4 μ g/mL)	Meropenem EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 1 μ g/mL)	Cefepime EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 2 μ g/mL)	Ceftriazone EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 1 μ g/mL)
PS310 Concentration				
0	0.13/0.5	0.06/0.06	0.06/0.03	0.06/0.06
50 pg/mL	0.25/0.25	0.06/0.03	0.03/0.03	0.06/0.06
500 pg/mL	0.13/0.25	0.06/0.06	0.06/0.06	0.06/0.13
5 ng/mL	0.13/0.25	0.06/0.06	0.13/0.25	0.25/1.0
50 ng/mL	0.5/0.5	0.03/0.06	>2.0/>2.0	>1.0/>1.0
500 ng/mL	>4.0/>4.0	0.03/0.03	>2.0/>2.0	>1.0/>1.0
IS118 Concentration				
0	0.13/0.13	0.06/0.03	0.06/0.03	0.06/0.06

66

TABLE 16-continued

Antibiotic activity of ceftazidime, meropenem, cefepime, and ceftriazone in the presence of bacterial culture supernatants from <i>bacillus</i> strains expressing soluble β -lactamase proteins P1A (RS310), P3A (IS118), or P4A (IS288).				
	Ceftazidime EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 4 μ g/mL)	Meropenem EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 1 μ g/mL)	Cefepime EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 2 μ g/mL)	Ceftriazone EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 1 μ g/mL)
10				
50 pg/mL	0.13/0.25	0.06/0.03	0.03/0.03	0.06/0.13
500 pg/mL	0.25/0.25	0.06/0.03	0.06/0.03	1.0/0.25
5 ng/mL	0.13/0.25	0.06/0.06	0.13/0.13	>1.0/>1.0
50 ng/mL	1.0/2.0	0.03/0.06	>2.0/>2.0	>1.0/>1.0
500 ng/mL	>4.0/>4.0	0.06/0.06	>2.0/>2.0	>1.0/>1.0
15 IS288 Concentration				
0	0.13/0.5	0.06/0.06	0.03/0.03	0.06/0.06
50 pg/mL	0.25/0.25	0.06/0.03	0.03/0.03	0.13/>1.0
500 pg/mL	0.13/0.25	0.06/0.03	0.06/0.06	>1.0/>1.0
5 ng/mL	0.25/0.5	0.25/0.25	0.13/0.25	>1.0/>1.0
50 ng/mL	>4.0/>4.0	0.03/0.06	>2.0/>2.0	>1.0/>1.0
500 ng/mL	>4.0/>4.0	0.06/0.06	>2.0/>2.0	>1.0/>1.0

E. coli 29522 was incubated overnight in the presence of serial dilutions of antibiotic and the indicated amounts of β -lactamase protein from cell culture supernatants in a 96 well plate. Bacterial density (OD_{625}) of the cultures was measured and the concentration at which the density was reduced by 90% relative to an untreated bacterial control (EC_{90}) was determined. The assay was performed on two separate days and the data reported as two numeric values separated by a slash. NA=not assayed.

TABLE 17

Antibiotic activity of cefazolin, amp/sublactam, cefoperazone, cefotaxime, cefuroxime, and ceftriazone in the presence of bacterial culture supernatants from <i>bacillus</i> strains expressing soluble β -lactamase proteins P1A (RS310), P3A (IS118), or P4A (IS288).						
Project 307-04-04 Results Tables 27 March 2014						
	Cefazolin EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 64 μ g/mL)	Amp. Sublactam EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 128:64 μ g/mL)	Cefoperazone EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 8 μ g/mL)	Cefotaxime EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 2 μ g/mL)	Cefuroxime EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 128 μ g/mL)	Ceftriazone EC_{50} (μ g/mL) (high test 1 μ g/mL)
RS310 Concentration						
0	2.0/2.0	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	0.25/0.13	0.004/0.008	4.0/4.0	0.03/0.03
50 pg/mL	2.0/4.0	4.0:2.0/8.0:4.0	0.5/0.25	0.008/0.004	4.0/2.0	0.03/0.06
500 pg/mL	16/16	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	2.0/4.0	0.004/0.004	4.0/4.0	0.13/0.13
5 ng/mL	>64/>64	8.0:4.0/16:8.0	>8.0/>8.0	0.008/0.008	32/32	0.13/0.13
50 ng/mL	>64/>64	32:16/32:16	>8.0/>8.0	1.0/0.25	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0
500 ng/mL	>64/>64	128:64/128:64	>8.0/>8.0	>2.0/>2.0	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0
IS118 Concentration						
0	2.0/2.0	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	0.25/0.25	0.004/0.004	2.0/4.0	0.03/0.03
50 pg/mL	4.0/4.0	4.0:2.0/8.0:4.0	0.5/0.5	0.004/0.004	8.0/4.0	0.13/0.13
500 pg/mL	64/64	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	8.0/>8.0	0.008/0.008	8.0/8.0	0.25/0.5
5 ng/mL	>64/>64	8.0:4.0/16:8.0	>8.0/>8.0	0.06/0.03	128/128	>1.0/>1.0
50 ng/mL	>64/>64	32:16/32:16	>8.0/>8.0	>2.0/>2.0	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0
500 ng/mL	>64/>64	128:64/128:64	>8.0/>8.0	>2.0/>2.0	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0
IS288 Concentration						
0	2.0/2.0	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	0.25/0.13	0.004/0.004	4.0/2.0	0.03/0.06
50 pg/mL	4.0/4.0	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	0.5/0.5	0.02/0.008	8.0/8.0	0.25/0.25
500 pg/mL	>64/>64	4.0:2.0/4.0:2.0	>8.0/>8.0	0.25/0.25	32/32	>1.0/>1.0
5 ng/mL	>64/>64	4.0:2.0/8.0:4.0	>8.0/>8.0	>2.0/>2.0	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0
50 ng/mL	>64/>64	8.0:4.0/8.0:4.0	>8.0/>8.0	>2.0/>2.0	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0
500 ng/mL	>64/>64	32:16/32:16	>8.0/>8.0	>2.0/>2.0	>128/>128	>1.0/>1.0

E. coli 29522 was incubated overnight in the presence of serial dilutions of antibiotic and the indicated amounts of β -lactamase protein from cell culture supernatants in a 96 well plate. Bacterial density (OD_{625}) of the cultures was measured and the concentration at which the density was reduced by 90% relative to an untreated bacterial control (EC90) was determined. The assay was performed on two separate days and the data reported as two numeric values separated by a slash. NA=not assayed.

Without wishing to be bound by theory, these data suggest more activity in vitro than predicted from the corresponding kinetic data. For example, the ceftazidime kinetic data predicted a lack of therapeutic efficacy, but these data showed activity at 500 ng/ml with a 10-fold improvement for P4A. Next, it was observed that P1A and P3A were quite effective for ampicillin, while P4A lost some activity for ampicillin. The amp/sulbactam data verified that sulbactam effectively inhibited P1A, P3A, and P4A. Whereas the amp/sulbactam data verified that sulbactam is an effective β -lactamase inhibitor, this should not be interpreted to mean that these β -lactamases will not be efficacious in vivo. Specifically, if the pharmacokinetics for biliary excretion are different for the antibiotic and the inhibitor, then the antibiotic can be found in the small intestine in the absence of its inhibitor. For example, P1A has been shown to be efficacious in humans with piperacillin/tazobactam. The meropenem data confirmed what was expected, that the P1A, P3A, and P4A β -lactamases are penicillinases and cephalosporinases. Finally, P4A was observed to be remarkably effective at degrading ceftriaxone, better than P3A. P4A was as good for ceftriaxone as it was for ampicillin. P4 also had improved activity for several important cephalosporins with the exception of cefepime. In comparison to P1A, P4A exhibited about 10-fold or greater β -lactamase activity for ceftriaxone, cefotaxime, ceftazidime, ceftazolin, cefoperazone, and cefurixine.

Example 5

Analysis of the Antibiotic Degradation Properties of P1A, P3A, and P4A

P1A and P4A were screened for degradation of ampicillin, ceftriazone, cefotaxime, ceftazolin, cefuroxime, cefoperazone, cefepime, and ceftazidime in a microtiter plate activity assay that was designed to mimic the activity of the β -lactamases in the gut in the presence of high antibiotic concentrations. The assay was performed by mixing 10, 100 or 1000 μ g/ml of the indicated antibiotics with P1A or P4A, at concentrations of 10 or 100 ng/ml. Plates were either incubated for one hour at 37° C. after which *E. coli* (ATCC 25922) was added, or *E. coli* was added immediately after the addition of the β -lactamase enzymes. The plates were incubated overnight and the bacterial growth quantified by measuring the absorbance at 625 nm (OD_{625}) in a Spectramax 384 Plus plate reader. The analysis was performed twice for each β -lactamase and antibiotic. The β -lactamase activity of the culture supernatants was determined as positive or negative based on the appearance of bacterial growth in the individual wells. An OD_{625} of 1.0 or greater indicated maximal bacterial growth, therefore complete antibiotic degradation and high β -lactamase activity. An OD_{625} of less than 1.0 indicated low bacterial growth therefore incomplete antibiotic degradation, hence low β -lactamase activity.

Results from the analysis are shown in FIG. 8. There was no difference in the readings obtained for the plates that were preincubated with the β -lactamase and antibiotic compared to the plates that did not undergo preincubation.

For all antibiotics, except ampicillin, P4A showed improved activity relative to P1A. P1A showed no activity for ceftriaxone, cefotaxime, and ceftazidime. P4A shows greater efficacy for cefotaxime, ceftazolin, cefoperazone, cefepime, and ceftazidime.

Accordingly, modification of five (P4A) amino acids in P1A boosted cephalosporinase activity 10-1000-fold. Oral administration of P4A can therefore protect the gut flora from commonly used cephalosporins and extend the clinical utility of this prophylactic strategy to the prevention of, for example, CDI. Specifically, the assays presented herein show that, at concentrations that should be readily achievable in the small intestine, P4A can degrade cephalosporins and other antibiotics and have an improved substrate profile relative to P1A.

DEFINITIONS

The following definitions are used in connection with the invention disclosed herein. Unless defined otherwise, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood to one of skill in the art to which this invention belongs.

As used herein, "a," "an," or "the" can mean one or more than one.

Further, the term "about" when used in connection with a referenced numeric indication means the referenced numeric indication plus or minus up to 10% of that referenced numeric indication. For example, the language "about 50" covers the range of 45 to 55.

An "effective amount," when used in connection with medical uses is an amount that is effective for providing a measurable treatment, prevention, or reduction in the rate of pathogenesis of a disease of interest.

As referred to herein, all compositional percentages are by weight of the total composition, unless otherwise specified. As used herein, the word "include," and its variants, is intended to be non-limiting, such that recitation of items in a list is not to the exclusion of other like items that may also be useful in the compositions and methods of this technology. Similarly, the terms "can" and "may" and their variants are intended to be non-limiting, such that recitation that an embodiment can or may comprise certain elements or features does not exclude other embodiments of the present technology that do not contain those elements or features.

Although the open-ended term "comprising," as a synonym of terms such as including, containing, or having, is used herein to describe and claim the invention, the present invention, or embodiments thereof, may alternatively be described using alternative terms such as "consisting of" or "consisting essentially of."

As used herein, the words "preferred" and "preferably" refer to embodiments of the technology that afford certain benefits, under certain circumstances. However, other embodiments may also be preferred, under the same or other circumstances. Furthermore, the recitation of one or more preferred embodiments does not imply that other embodiments are not useful, and is not intended to exclude other embodiments from the scope of the technology.

The amount of compositions described herein needed for achieving a therapeutic effect may be determined empirically in accordance with conventional procedures for the particular purpose. Generally, for administering therapeutic agents (e.g. inventive β -lactamases and/or pharmaceutical compositions (and/or additional agents) for therapeutic purposes, the therapeutic agents are given at a pharmacologically effective dose. A "pharmacologically effective amount," "pharmacologically effective dose," "therapeutically effective amount," or

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“effective amount” refers to an amount sufficient to produce the desired physiological effect or amount capable of achieving the desired result, particularly for treating the disorder or disease. An effective amount as used herein would include an amount sufficient to, for example, delay the development of a symptom of the disorder or disease, alter the course of a symptom of the disorder or disease (e.g., slow the progression of a symptom of the disease), reduce or eliminate one or more symptoms or manifestations of the disorder or disease, and reverse a symptom of a disorder or disease. For example, administration of therapeutic agents to a patient suffering from a GI tract disorder (e.g. CDI) provides a therapeutic benefit not only when the underlying condition is eradicated or ameliorated, but also when the patient reports a decrease in the severity or duration of the symptoms associated with the disease. Therapeutic benefit also includes halting or slowing the progression of the underlying disease or disorder, regardless of whether improvement is realized.

Effective amounts, toxicity, and therapeutic efficacy can be determined by standard pharmaceutical procedures in cell cultures or experimental animals, e.g., for determining the LD50 (the dose lethal to about 50% of the population) and the ED50 (the dose therapeutically effective in about 50% of the population). The dosage can vary depending upon the dosage form employed and the route of administration utilized. The dose ratio between toxic and therapeutic effects is the therapeutic index and can be expressed as the ratio LD50/ED50. In some embodiments, compositions and methods that exhibit large therapeutic indices are preferred. A therapeutically effective dose can be estimated initially from in vitro assays, including, for example, cell culture assays. Also, a dose can be formulated in animal models to achieve a circulating plasma concentration range that includes the IC50 as determined in cell culture, or in an appropriate animal model. Levels of the described compositions in plasma can be measured, for example, by high performance liquid chromatography. The effects of any particular dosage can be monitored by a suitable bioassay. The dosage can be determined by a physician and adjusted, as necessary, to suit observed effects of the treatment.

In certain embodiments, the effect will result in a quantifiable change of at least about 10%, at least about 20%, at least

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about 30%, at least about 50%, at least about 70%, or at least about 90%. In some embodiments, the effect will result in a quantifiable change of about 10%, about 20%, about 30%, about 50%, about 70%, or even about 90% or more. In certain embodiments, the effect will result in a quantifiable change of two-fold, or three-fold, or four-fold, or five-fold, or ten-fold. Therapeutic benefit also includes halting or slowing the progression of the underlying disease or disorder or reduction in toxicity, regardless of whether improvement is realized.

EQUIVALENTS

While the invention has been described in connection with specific embodiments thereof, it will be understood that it is capable of further modifications and this application is intended to cover any variations, uses, or adaptations of the invention following, in general, the principles of the invention and including such departures from the present disclosure as come within known or customary practice within the art to which the invention pertains and as may be applied to the essential features herein set forth and as follows in the scope of the appended claims.

Those skilled in the art will recognize, or be able to ascertain, using no more than routine experimentation, numerous equivalents to the specific embodiments described specifically herein. Such equivalents are intended to be encompassed in the scope of the following claims.

INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE

All patents and publications referenced herein are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

The publications discussed herein are provided solely for their disclosure prior to the filing date of the present application. Nothing herein is to be construed as an admission that the present invention is not entitled to antedate such publication by virtue of prior invention.

As used herein, all headings are simply for organization and are not intended to limit the disclosure in any manner. The content of any individual section may be equally applicable to all sections.

SEQUENCE LISTING

<160> NUMBER OF SEQ ID NOS: 7

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<212> TYPE: PRT

<213> ORGANISM: *Bacillus licheniformis*

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20 25 30

Arg Pro Asp Glu Arg Phe Ala Phe Ala Ser Thr Ile Lys Ala Leu Thr
35 40 45

Val Gly Val Leu Leu Gln Gln Lys Ser Ile Glu Asp Leu Asn Gln Arg
50 55 60

Ile Thr Tyr Thr Arg Asp Asp Leu Val Asn Tyr Asn Pro Ile Thr Glu
65 70 75 80

Lys His Val Asp Thr Gly Met Thr Leu Lys Glu Leu Ala Asp Ala Ser

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85					90					95					
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		115					120					125			
Val	Thr	Asn	Pro	Glu	Arg	Phe	Glu	Pro	Glu	Leu	Asn	Glu	Val	Asn	Pro
		130					135					140			
Gly	Glu	Thr	Gln	Asp	Thr	Ser	Thr	Ala	Arg	Ala	Leu	Val	Thr	Ser	Leu
		145					150					155			160
Arg	Ala	Phe	Ala	Leu	Glu	Asp	Lys	Leu	Pro	Ser	Glu	Lys	Arg	Glu	Leu
			165					170						175	
Leu	Ile	Asp	Trp	Met	Lys	Arg	Asn	Thr	Thr	Gly	Asp	Ala	Leu	Ile	Arg
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Ala	Gly	Val	Pro	Asp	Gly	Trp	Glu	Val	Ala	Asp	Lys	Thr	Gly	Ala	Ala
		195					200					205			
Ser	Tyr	Gly	Thr	Arg	Asn	Asp	Ile	Ala	Ile	Ile	Trp	Pro	Pro	Lys	Gly
		210					215					220			
Asp	Pro	Val	Val	Leu	Ala	Val	Leu	Ser	Ser	Arg	Asp	Lys	Lys	Asp	Ala
		225					230					235			240
Lys	Tyr	Asp	Asp	Lys	Leu	Ile	Ala	Glu	Ala	Thr	Lys	Val	Val	Met	Lys
			245					250						255	
Ala	Leu	Asn	Met	Asn	Gly	Lys									
			260												

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<212> TYPE: DNA

<213> ORGANISM: Bacillus licheniformis

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gcttcgacga ttaagccttt aactgtaggc gtgcttttgc aacagaaatc aatagaagat      180
ctgaaccaga gaataacata tacacgtgat gatcttgtaa actacaaccc gattacggaa      240
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gaagtgaatc cgggtgaaac tcaggatacc agtacagcaa gagcacttgt cacaagcctt      480
cgagcctttg ctcttgaaaga taaacttcca agtgaaaaac gcgagctttt aatcgattgg      540
atgaaacgaa ataccactgg agacgcctta atccgtgccg gtgtgccgga cggttgggaa      600
gtggctgata aaactggagc ggcatcatat ggaacccgga atgacattgc catcatttgg      660
ccgccaaaag gagatcctgt cgttcttgca gtattatcca gcagggataa aaaggacgcc      720
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 35 40 45
 Phe Asp Ala Lys Leu Gly Ile Phe Ala Leu Asp Thr Gly Thr Asn Arg
 50 55 60
 Thr Val Ala Tyr Arg Pro Asp Glu Arg Phe Ala Phe Ala Ser Thr Ile
 65 70 75 80
 Lys Ala Leu Thr Val Gly Val Leu Leu Gln Gln Lys Ser Ile Glu Asp
 85 90 95
 Leu Asn Gln Arg Ile Thr Tyr Thr Arg Asp Asp Leu Val Asn Tyr Asn
 100 105 110
 Pro Ile Thr Glu Lys His Val Asp Thr Gly Met Thr Leu Lys Glu Leu
 115 120 125
 Ala Asp Ala Ser Leu Arg Tyr Ser Asp Asn Ala Ala Gln Asn Leu Ile
 130 135 140
 Leu Lys Gln Ile Gly Gly Pro Glu Ser Leu Lys Lys Glu Leu Arg Lys
 145 150 155 160
 Ile Gly Asp Glu Val Thr Asn Pro Glu Arg Phe Glu Pro Glu Leu Asn
 165 170 175
 Glu Val Asn Pro Gly Glu Thr Gln Asp Thr Ser Thr Ala Arg Ala Leu
 180 185 190
 Val Thr Ser Leu Arg Ala Phe Ala Leu Glu Asp Lys Leu Pro Ser Glu
 195 200 205
 Lys Arg Glu Leu Leu Ile Asp Trp Met Lys Arg Asn Thr Thr Gly Asp
 210 215 220
 Ala Leu Ile Arg Ala Gly Val Pro Asp Gly Trp Glu Val Ala Asp Lys
 225 230 235 240
 Thr Gly Ala Ala Ser Tyr Gly Thr Arg Asn Asp Ile Ala Ile Ile Trp
 245 250 255
 Pro Pro Lys Gly Asp Pro Val Val Leu Ala Val Leu Ser Ser Arg Asp
 260 265 270
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 <212> TYPE: DNA
 <213> ORGANISM: Bacillus licheniformis

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gattttgcaa aacttgagga acaatttgat gcaaaaactcg ggatctttgc attggataca	180
ggtacaaacc ggacggtagc gtatcggccg gatgagcgtt ttgcttttgc ttcgacgatt	240
aaggctttaa ctgtaggcgt gcttttgcaa cagaaatcaa tagaagatct gaaccagaga	300
ataacatata cacgtgatga tcttgtaaac tacaaccgga ttacggaaaa gcacgttgat	360
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ggtgaaactc aggataccag tacagcaaga gcacttgtca caagccttcg agcctttgct 600
cttgaagata aacttccaag tgaaaaacgc gagcttttaa tcgattggat gaaacgaaat 660
accactggag acgccttaat ccgtgccggt gtgccggacg gttgggaagt ggctgataaa 720
actggagcgg catcatatgg aacccggaat gacattgcca tcatttggcc gccaaaagga 780
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<213> ORGANISM: Artificial Sequence
<220> FEATURE:
<223> OTHER INFORMATION: Synthetic

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Arg Pro Asp Glu Arg Phe Ala Phe Ala Ser Thr Ile Lys Ala Leu Thr
35     40     45
Val Gly Val Leu Leu Gln Gln Lys Ser Ile Glu Asp Leu Asn Gln Arg
50     55     60
Ile Thr Thr Arg Asp Asp Leu Val Asn Tyr Asn Pro Ile Thr Glu Lys
65     70     75     80
His Val Asp Thr Gly Met Thr Leu Lys Glu Leu Ala Asp Ala Ser Leu
85     90     95
Arg Tyr Ser Asp Asn Ala Ala Gln Asn Leu Ile Leu Lys Gln Ile Gly
100    105    110
Gly Pro Glu Ser Leu Lys Lys Glu Leu Arg Lys Ile Gly Asp Glu Val
115    120    125
Thr Asn Pro Glu Arg Phe Glu Pro Glu Leu Asn Glu Val Asn Pro Gly
130    135    140
Glu Thr Gln Asp Thr Ser Thr Ala Arg Ala Leu Val Thr Ser Leu Arg
145    150    155    160
Ala Phe Ala Leu Glu Asp Lys Leu Pro Ser Glu Lys Arg Glu Leu Leu
165    170    175
Ile Asp Trp Met Lys Arg Asn Thr Thr Gly Asp Ala Leu Ile Arg Ala
180    185    190
Gly Val Pro Asp Gly Trp Glu Val Gly Asp Lys Thr Gly Ser Gly Asp
195    200    205
Tyr Gly Thr Arg Asn Asp Ile Ala Ile Ile Trp Pro Pro Lys Gly Asp
210    215    220
Pro Val Val Leu Ala Val Leu Ser Ser Arg Asp Lys Lys Asp Ala Lys
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<210> SEQ ID NO 6

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<211> LENGTH: 299
 <212> TYPE: PRT
 <213> ORGANISM: Artificial Sequence
 <220> FEATURE:
 <223> OTHER INFORMATION: Synthetic

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 20             25             30

Ala Ser Lys Thr Glu Met Lys Asp Asp Phe Ala Lys Leu Glu Glu Gln
 35             40             45

Phe Asp Ala Lys Leu Gly Ile Phe Ala Leu Asp Thr Gly Thr Asn Arg
 50             55             60

Thr Val Ala Tyr Arg Pro Asp Glu Arg Phe Ala Phe Ala Ser Thr Ile
 65             70             75             80

Lys Ala Leu Thr Val Gly Val Leu Leu Gln Gln Lys Ser Ile Glu Asp
 85             90             95

Leu Asn Gln Arg Ile Thr Tyr Thr Arg Asp Asp Leu Val Asn Tyr Asn
100            105            110

Pro Ile Thr Glu Lys His Val Asp Thr Gly Met Thr Leu Lys Glu Leu
115            120            125

Ala Asp Ala Ser Leu Arg Tyr Ser Asp Asn Ala Ala Gln Asn Leu Ile
130            135            140

Leu Lys Gln Ile Gly Gly Pro Glu Ser Leu Lys Lys Glu Leu Arg Lys
145            150            155            160

Ile Gly Asp Glu Val Thr Asn Pro Glu Arg Phe Glu Pro Glu Leu Asn
165            170            175

Glu Val Asn Pro Gly Glu Thr Gln Asp Thr Ser Thr Ala Arg Ala Leu
180            185            190

Val Thr Ser Leu Arg Ala Phe Ala Leu Glu Asp Lys Leu Pro Ser Glu
195            200            205

Lys Arg Glu Leu Leu Ile Asp Trp Met Lys Arg Asn Thr Thr Gly Asp
210            215            220

Ala Leu Ile Arg Ala Gly Val Pro Asp Gly Trp Glu Val Gly Asp Lys
225            230            235            240

Thr Gly Ser Gly Asp Tyr Gly Thr Arg Asn Asp Ile Ala Ile Ile Trp
245            250            255

Pro Pro Lys Gly Asp Pro Val Val Leu Ala Val Leu Ser Ser Arg Asp
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Lys Lys Asp Ala Lys Tyr Asp Asn Lys Leu Ile Ala Glu Ala Thr Lys
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Val Val Met Lys Ala Leu Asn Met Asn Gly Lys
290            295

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<210> SEQ ID NO 7
 <211> LENGTH: 900
 <212> TYPE: DNA
 <213> ORGANISM: Artificial Sequence
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 <223> OTHER INFORMATION: Synthetic

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-continued

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aaggctttaa ctgtaggcgt gcttttgcaa cagaaatcaa tagaagatct gaaccagaga	300
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cagaatctca ttcttaaca aattggcgga cctgaaagt tgaaaaagga actgaggaag	480
attggtgatg aggttacaaa tcccgaaaga ttcgaaaccag agttaaata agtgaatccg	540
ggtgaaactc aggataccag tacagcaaga gcacttgatca caagccttcg agcctttgct	600
cttgaagata aacttccaag tgaaaaacgc gagcttttaa tcgattggat gaaacgaaat	660
accactggag acgccttaat ccgtgccggt gtgccggacg gttgggaagt gggtgataaa	720
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gatcctgtcg ttcttgacgt attatccagc agggataaaa aggacgcaa gtatgataat	840
aaacttattg cagaggcaac aaaggtggta atgaaagcct taaacatgaa cggcataata	900

What is claimed is:

1. A beta-lactamase comprising an amino acid sequence having at least 90% sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 1 and having an A238T mutation according to Ambler classification.

2. The beta-lactamase of claim 1, further comprising a G156R mutation according to Ambler classification.

3. The beta-lactamase of claim 1, further comprising a D276N mutation according to Ambler classification.

4. The beta-lactamase of claim 3, further comprising a F33Y mutation according to Ambler classification.

5. The beta-lactamase of any one of claims 1-4, wherein the beta-lactamase hydrolyzes one or more of penicillins and cephalosporins.

6. The beta-lactamase of claim 5, wherein the penicillin is ampicillin.

7. The beta-lactamase of claim 5, wherein the cephalosporin is selected from ceftriaxone, cefotaxime, cefazolin, cefoperazone, cefepime, cefuroxime, and ceftazidime.

8. The beta-lactamase of any one of claims 1-4, wherein the beta-lactamase has improved enzymatic activity against a cephalosporin as compared to SEQ ID NO: 1.

9. The beta-lactamase of claim 8, wherein the cephalosporin is selected from cefotaxime, cefepime, and ceftriaxone.

10. The beta-lactamase of any one of claims 1-4, wherein the beta-lactamase has improved catalytic efficiency against a cephalosporin as compared to SEQ ID NO: 1.

11. The beta-lactamase of claim 10, wherein the beta-lactamase has about a 10-fold to about a 1000-fold improved catalytic efficiency against a cephalosporin as compared to SEQ ID NO: 1.

12. The beta-lactamase of claim 11, wherein the cephalosporin is ceftriaxone.

13. The beta-lactamase of any one of claims 1-4, wherein the beta-lactamase is active in the GI tract.

14. The beta-lactamase of claim 13, wherein the beta-lactamase is stable in the small intestine, optionally selected from one or more of the duodenum, jejunum, and ileum.

15. A polynucleotide comprising a polynucleotide sequence encoding the beta-lactamase of any one of claims 1-4.

25 16. A host cell comprising the polynucleotide of claim 15.

17. A pharmaceutical composition, comprising the beta-lactamase of any one of claims 1-4 and a pharmaceutically acceptable carrier or excipient.

30 18. The pharmaceutical composition of claim 17, wherein the composition is formulated for oral administration, optionally selected from a tablet, a multi-particulate sprinkle, and a multi-particulate capsule.

19. A method for preventing an antibiotic-induced adverse effect in the GI tract, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase to a patient in need thereof, wherein the beta-lactamase comprises an amino acid sequence having at least 90% sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 1 and having an A238T mutation according to Ambler classification.

20. The method of claim 19, wherein the beta-lactamase further comprises a G156R mutation according to Ambler classification.

21. The method of claim 19, wherein the beta-lactamase further comprises a D276N mutation according to Ambler classification.

22. The method of claim 21, wherein the beta-lactamase further comprises a F33Y mutation according to Ambler classification.

23. The method of any one of claims 19-22, wherein the subject is being administered or will be administered an antibiotic.

24. A method for treating or preventing an antibiotic induced *C. difficile* infection (CDI) and/or a *C. difficile*-associated disease, comprising administering an effective amount of a beta-lactamase to a patient in need thereof, wherein the beta-lactamase comprises an amino acid sequence having at least 90% sequence identity with SEQ ID NO: 1 and having an A238T mutation according to Ambler classification.

25. The method of claim 24, wherein the beta-lactamase further comprises a G156R mutation according to Ambler classification.

26. The method of claim 24, wherein the beta-lactamase further comprises a D276N mutation according to Ambler classification.

27. The method of claim 26, wherein the beta-lactamase further comprises a F33Y mutation according to Ambler classification.

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28. The method of any one of claims **24-27**, wherein the subject is being administered or will be administered an antibiotic.

29. The method of any one of claims **24-27**, wherein the *C. difficile*-associated disease is antibiotic-associated diarrhea. 5

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